U.S. ARMY TEST AND EVALUATION COMMAND
TEST OPERATIONS PROCEDURE

*Test Operations Procedure 01-1-011D 24 February 2026

VEHICLE TEST FACILITIES AT ABERDEEN TEST CENTER AND YUMA TEST CENTER

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*This TOP supersedes TOP 01-1-011C Vehicle Test Facilities at Aberdeen Test Center and Yuma Test Center, dated 26 March 2025.

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1. SCOPE.

a. This Test Operations Procedure (TOP) describes the vehicle test facilities of the U.S. Army Aberdeen Test Center (ATC) at Aberdeen Proving Ground (APG), Maryland, and the U.S. Army Yuma Test Center (YTC) at Yuma Proving Ground (YPG), Arizona (as outlined in Tables 1 and 2). It is designed for use in planning tests of wheeled and tracked vehicles, including vehicular weapon systems. Specific procedures for wheeled and tracked vehicle endurance testing are found in TOP 02-2-506A[1**]. This TOP does not include descriptions of the equipment and instrumentation used to obtain test data.

TABLE 1. ATC COURSE COMPOSITION/LENGTHS AND FACILITIES

TOP SECTION NO.	TEST AREA	PAGE NO.	TEST AREA TYPE	FACILITY DIMENSION	
				METRIC	ENGLISH
2.1 Churchville Test Area (CTA)	Hilly Cross-Country (Course A)	12	Severe, wooded and rocky terrain	Not Applicable (NA)	NA
	Hilly Cross-Country (Course B)	12	Native soil and stone, grades to 29%	5.8 km	3.6 mi
	Hilly Secondary Road (Course C)	13	Grades to 10%	2.4 km	1.5 mi
	Prepared Soil Slopes	14	Grades of 10, 15, 20, 25, and 60%, Side slopes of 30 and 40%	37 to 183 m	120 to 600 ft
	Harford Loop	14	Paved, rolling hills	29.8 km	18.5 mi
	Conowingo Loop	14	Paved	74.8 km	46.5 mi
2.2 Environmental Test Facilities	Multi-Purpose Environmental Chamber	15	Temperature range from -54 to 74 ºC (-65 to 165 ºF)	12.2 x 22.9 x 7.3 m	40 x 75 x 24 ft
	Mobility Test Chamber	15	Temperature range from -54 to 74 ºC (-65 to 165 ºF)	9.1 x 18.3 m	30 x 60 ft
	Firing Test Chamber	16	Temperature range from -54 to 74 ºC (-65 to 165 ºF)	12.2 x 12.2 m	40 x 40 ft
	Vibration Facility	17	Electrodynamic Vibration System	177,929 N	40,000 lb
	Climatic Simulation Facilities	17	Wind machine	161 km/hr	100 mph
			Stationary temperature – humidity chamber	2.9 x 2.4 x 2.0 m	9.5 x 7.9 x 6.4 ft
			Portable chambers	1.8 x 1.4 x 1.5 m	6.0 x 4.7 x 5.0 ft
			Solar radiation chamber	3.0 x 3.7 x 0.9 m	10 x 12 x 3 ft
			Altitude Chamber	2.4 x 3.5 x 3.0 m	8 x 11.5 x 10 ft
	Electromagnetic Interference Test Facility (EMITF)	18	Multiple chambers	28.7 x 18.3 x 8.5 m	94 x 60 x28 ft

** Superscript numbers correspond to Appendix B, References.

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TABLE 1. CONT'D

TOP SECTION NO.	TEST AREA	PAGE NO.	TEST AREA TYPE	FACILITY DIMENSION	
				METRIC	ENGLISH
2.3 Dynamometer Course	Dynamometer Course	19	Bituminous concrete	1.6 km	1 mi
2.4 Mile Loop	Mile Loop	19	Paved and gravel	1.6 km	1 mi
	Winch Test Facility	20	Concrete base	NA	NA
	Pothole-Crosstie Course	20	Concrete potholes	61 m	200 ft
		21	Wooden crossties in concrete	40 m	132 ft
	1-Inch Bump Course	22	Iron rod in concrete	67 m	220 ft
	Rain Towers	22	Two towers	9.1 m	30 ft
	Half Rounds	22	Reinforced steel pipe	NA	NA
2.5 Mountain Highway	Mountain Highway	22	Paved	64.4 km	40 mi
2.6 Munson Test Area (MTA)	Paved Road	26	Bituminous concrete	681 m	2235 ft
	Improved Gravel Road	26	Compacted gravel	3.2 km	2 mi
	Rolling Hill Course	27	Compacted stone/dust	620 m	2034 ft
	Sand Course	27	Washed beach sand	153 m	503 ft
	Rubble Pile	28	Large boulders, concrete, steel	30.5 m	100 ft
	Corrosion Facility	29	Various corrosive environments	NA	NA
	Abrasive Mud Course	30	Sand loam	73 x 290 m	240 x 950 ft
	Shallow Water Fording Basin	31	Concrete	82 m	270 ft
	Deep Water Fording Facility	33	Concrete	96 m	315 ft
	Amphibian Ramp	33	Bituminous concrete	6 x 15 m	21 x 50 ft
	Shallow Water Swimming Area	34	Channel, 3 m deep x 15 m wide (10 x 50 ft)	305 m	1000 ft
	Belgian Block Course	35	Granite blocks in concrete	1.2 km	0.75 mi
	Imbedded Rock Course	36	Granite stones in concrete	244 m	800 ft
	Side Slopes	37	Concrete: 20%	83 m	271 ft
			Concrete: 30%	220 m	723 ft
			Concrete: 40%	91 m	300 ft
	Longitudinal Grades	38	Asphalt: 5%	147 m	483 ft
			Asphalt: 10%	91 m	300 ft
			Asphalt: 15%	78 m	256 ft
			Asphalt: 20%	61 m	199 ft
			Concrete: 30%	45 m	149 ft
			Concrete: 40%	34 m	112 ft
			Concrete: 45%	18 m	59 ft
			Concrete: 50%	30 m	97 ft
			Concrete: 60%	25 m	81 ft
	Simulated Loading Ramps	40	Concrete: 20 º	12 m	38 ft
			Concrete: 15 º	6 m	20 ft
	2-Inch Washboard	41	Concrete	251 m	822 ft
	2- to 4-Inch Radial Washboard	42	Concrete	74 m	243 ft

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TABLE 1. CONT'D

TOP SECTION NO.	TEST AREA	PAGE NO.	TEST AREA TYPE	FACILITY DIMENSION	
				METRIC	ENGLISH
2.6 Munson Test Area (MTA)	3-Inch Spaced Bump	43	Concrete	233 m	764 ft
	6-Inch Washboard	44	Concrete	243 m	798 ft
	Wave Course	45	Concrete	135 m	443 ft
	Vertical Walls	46	Concrete and Wood	NA	NA
	Bridging Device	47	Steel	NA	NA
	Standard Ditch Profile	49	Concrete	7.8 m	25.5 ft
	Turning Circle	50	Concrete	76 m	250 ft
	Profile IV Course	51	Concrete	142 m	465 ft
	Marsh	52	Low soil strength, heavy vegetation	NA	NA
	Load Vibration Course	52	Concrete, gravel, and paved	2.9 km	1.8 mi
	Fuel Consumption Course	53	Gravel, paved	2.4 km	1.5 mi
	Urban Terrain Course	55	Concrete, gravel, and paved	5.6 km	3.5 mi
	Staircase Obstacle	57	Steel	6 m	20 ft
2.7 Land Vehicle Maintenance Facility	B338	58	Shop area of 45,000 square ft	4180 square m	45,000 square ft
2.8 Automotive Technology Evaluation Facility (ATEF)	High Speed Paved	59	Paved tri-oval with two lanes and a wide section.	7.2 km	4.5 mi
	High Speed Gravel	59	Bank run gravel tri-oval.	7.2 km	4.5 mi
	Vehicle Dynamics Area (VDA)	59	Vehicle performance testing pad.	122 x 244 m	400 x 800 ft
2.9 Perryman Test Area (PTA)	Perryman No. 1	62	Moderate; native loam with quarry spall/gravel	8.4 km	5.2 mi
	Perryman No. 2	62	Moderately rough; native loam with quarry spall	2.9 km	1.8 mi
	Perryman No. 3	63	Rough; native loam	5.3 km	3.3 mi
	Perryman No. 4	64	Severe; native loam with natural marsh	4 km	2.5 mi
	Perryman No. 5	65	Extremely severe; Gabion (No. 6 stone)	305 m	1000 ft
	3-Mile Straight-Away	65	Bituminous concrete (including turnarounds)	6.1 km	3.8 mi
	Mud Bypass Course	65	Native loam prepared by tilling	610 m	2000 ft
	Secondary Road A	66	Unimproved country road, sweeping turns	3.9 km	2.4 mi
	PTA Ride Quality	66	Unimproved road, level straight-away	5.1 km	3.2 mi
	Half Rounds	66	Reinforced steel pipe	NA	NA
	Figure 8	67	Native loam with gravel figure 8 course	772 m	2534 ft
	Dig Site 1	68	USCS Classification of SC-SM	482 m x 73 - 24 m	1580 ft x 240 - 80 ft
	Dig Site 2	68	USCS Classification of SM	27 – 37 m x 640 m	90 – 120 ft x 2100 ft
	Dig Site 3	68	USCS Classification of CL	165 m x 84 m	540 ft x 275 ft
	Dig Site 4	68	USCS Classification of CL-ML	366 m x 30 m	1200 ft x 100 ft

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TABLE 1. CONT'D

TOP SECTION NO.	TEST AREA	PAGE NO.	TEST AREA TYPE	FACILITY DIMENSION	
				METRIC	ENGLISH
2.10 Phillips Army Airfield (PAAF)	PAAF	68	One runway	2438 x 61 m	8000 x 200 ft
2.11 Lift and Tie-Down Facility	Lift and Tie-Down	69	54 tons (metric) (60 tons) hydraulic load system	NA	NA
2.12 Automotive Laboratory Facilities	Automotive Engineering Test Facility (B436)	69	Shop area	2,790 square m	30,000 square ft
	Tilt Table	70	Steel platform	30.5 x 4.3 m	100 x 14 ft
	Roadway Simulator Complex	72	Roadway Simulator	36,300 kg	80,000 lb
		72	Vehicle Durability Simulator	11,800 kg	26,000 lb
		73	Heavy Vehicle Durability Simulator	45,000 kg	100,000 lb
		74	Drivetrain Durability Simulator	36,300 kg	80,000 lb
		75	Tire Test Rig	NA	NA
		76	Shock Absorber Dynamometer	NA	NA
	Wheeled Vehicle Roller Brake Dynamometer	77	Brake forces up to 45 kN (10,000 lb) at axle weights up to 20,000 kg (44,000 lb)	NA	NA
	Platform Scales	78	Vehicle weight up to 90,700 kg (200,000 lb)	NA	NA
	Wheel Scales	78	Capacity of 9,072 kg (20,000 lb)	NA	NA
2.13 Fire Control Test Facilities	Fire Control Test Ranges	79	Ranges for direct fire; moving target; cross-country courses	NA	NA
	Tank Armament Test Range (Henry Field)	80	Direct fire range	3 km	1.9 mi
	Evasive Target Firing Range (TW I)	84	Evasive laser beam target	3 km	1.9 mi
	Moving Target Simulator	85	Air supported hemisphere	30.5 m radius	100 ft radius
	Multiple Target Firing Range (TW II)	86	Stationary vehicle/stationary target	3 km (DU) 5 km (other)	1.9 mi (DU) 3.1 mi (other)
2.14 Scalable Net Centric Test Area (SNCTA)	Small Unmanned Ground Vehicle (SUGV) Test Course	88	Various surfaces and obstacles	37 x 67 m	120 x 220 ft
	Large Unmanned Ground Vehicle (LUGV) Test Course (Proposed)	90	Designed for safety and performance testing of LUGVs up to 9,100 kg (20,000 lb) gross vehicle weight	NA	NA
2.15 Rail Transport Facility	Rail Transport Facility	90	Facility/equipment to ensure compliance with Military Surface Deployment and Distribution Command transportation certification requirements	NA	NA

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TABLE 1. CONT'D

TOP SECTION NO.	TEST AREA	PAGE NO.	TEST AREA TYPE	FACILITY DIMENSION	
				METRIC	ENGLISH
2.16 Amphibious Vehicle Operations Facility	Littoral Warfare Environment	90	Amphibious vehicle test facility in water basin including wave generator	122 m x 137 m	400 ft x 450 ft

Notes:
km = kilometer
°C = °Celsius
mph = miles per hour
hp = horsepower
USCS = unified soil classification system
CL = clay of low plasticity
mi = mile
°F = °Fahrenheit
hr = hour
kN = kilonewton
m = meter
N = Newton
in. = inch
TW = Trench Warfare
SC = clayey sand
ft = foot
lb = pound
SM = silty sand
ML = silt

TABLE 2. YTC COURSE COMPOSITION/LENGTHS AND FACILITIES

TOP SECTION NO.	TEST AREA	PAGE NO.	TEST AREA TYPE	FACILITY DIMENSION	
				METRIC	ENGLISH
3.1 Endurance Test Courses	Patton Level Gravel	92	Compacted gravel	5.6 km	3.5 mi
	Patton Hilly Trails	93	Sand, gravel, rock, grades to 40%	4.2 km	2.6 mi
	Patton Level Trails	94	Level Sand, undulating terrain	10.5 km	6.5 mi
	Patton Hilly Gravel	94	Sand, gravel, rock, grades to 30%	8.0 km	5.0 mi
	Kofa High Speed Gravel	95	Compacted gravel	6.7 km	4.2 mi
	Kofa Level Gravel	95	Compacted gravel	4.8 km	3.0 mi
	Laguna Level Trails, East	96	Sand, gravel	4.5 km	2.8 mi
	Laguna Level Trails, West	97	Sand, gravel	9.0 km	5.6 mi
	Laguna Hilly Trails	97	Sand, gravel, rock, grades	3.3 km	2.1 mi
	Middle East	98	Loamy sand, gravel	33.3 km	20.7 mi
	Rock Ledge	99	Sand, cobbled rock	6.3 km	3.9 mi
	Desert March	100	Sand, gravel	40.8 km	25.4 mi
	Vapor Lock Wash	101	Gravel	4.0 km	2.5 mi
	Highway 95	101	Asphalt	80 km	50 mi
	Bereznuk Track Evaluation	101	Sand, cobbled rock	2.4 km	1.5 mi
	Tire Bruise	102	Sand, cobbled rock	2.1 km	1.3 mi
	Patton Wash	103	Sand, gravel	3.7 km	2.3 mi
	Patton Off Road	104	Sand, cobbled rock	5.0 km	3.1 mi
3.2 Performance Test Courses	Longitudinal Grades	105	Concrete: 5%	37.8 m	124 ft
			Concrete: 10%	45.1 m	148 ft
			Concrete: 20%	91.4 m	300 ft
			Concrete: 30%	72.5 m	238 ft
			Concrete: 40%	47.2 m	155 ft
			Concrete: 60%	32.3 m	106 ft
	Roll On/Roll Off Ship Ramps	106	Metal: 12°	18.3 m	60 ft
			Metal: 15°	14.6 m	48 ft

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TABLE 2. CONT'D

TOP SECTION NO.	TEST AREA	PAGE NO.	TEST AREA TYPE	FACILITY DIMENSIONS	
				METRIC	ENGLISH
3.2 Performance Test Courses	Side Slopes	107	Concrete: 10%	150.9 m	495 ft
			Concrete: 15%	151.2 m	496 ft
			Concrete: 20%	150.9 m	495 ft
			Concrete: 30%	121.3 m	398 ft
	Sand Grades	107	Sand: 5%	61 m	200 ft
			Sand: 10%	30 m	100 ft
			Sand: 15%	55 m	180 ft
			Sand: 20%	37 m	120 ft
	Fording Basin	108	Concrete (L x W)	67 x 25 m	220 x 82 ft
	Kofa Dust Course	109	Sand, Dust	3.2 km	2.0 mi
	Cibola Mud Course	110	Sand, Clay	152 m	500 ft
	Dyno Mud Course	110	Sand, Clay, Silt	0.6 km	0.4 mi
	Laguna Mud Course	111	Clay	0.6 km	0.4 mi
	Sand Dynamometer	111	Sand	NA	NA
	Ride Dynamics	112	Compacted Gravel	251 to 305 m	825 to 1000 ft
	Fuel Transfer and Test Site Area	113	Concrete Pad	12 m x 37 m	40 ft x 120 ft
	Airfield Delivery Loading Ramp	113	Concrete Pad	96 by 148 m	315 by 485 ft
	Half Rounds and Curb Impact Course	114	Asphalt with interchangeable half round drums	10, 15, 20, 25, 30 cm	4, 6, 8, 10, 12 in.
	C-130 Air Transportability Test Bed	115	C-130 Hulk	NA	NA
	Urban Rubble	116	Concrete boulders	91.4 m	300 ft
	Hot Weather Test Complex	117	Asphalt	7.2 km	4.5 mi
	Laguna High Speed Paved Oval	117	Asphalt	7.2 km	4.5 mi
	Laguna Paved	118	Asphalt	3.2 km	2.0 mi
	General Motors (GM) High Speed Circle Track	119	Asphalt	5.6 km	3.5 mi
	GM Vehicle Dynamics Pad	119	Asphalt	305 x 305 m	1,000 x 1,000 ft
	GM Performance Straight Track	119	Asphalt	4.8 km	3.0 mi
	GM Engineered Ride Road	119	Asphalt and concrete	5.0 km	3.1 mi
	GM Belgian Block and Granite Block	120	Granite	76 m	250 ft
	Potholes Course	120	Steel potholes embedded in gravel	49.1 m	161 ft
	Vertical Steps	120	Concrete steps with replaceable timber edges	30, 46, 61, 76, and 91 cm	12, 18, 24, 30, and 36 in.
	"V" Ditch	121	Concrete: Direct Approach	7.6 m	25 ft
			Concrete: Angled Approach	7.0 m	23 ft

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TOP SECTION NO.	TEST AREA	PAGE NO.	TEST AREA TYPE	FACILITY DIMENSION	
				METRIC	ENGLISH
3.2 Performance Test Courses	MOUT Obstacle Course	122	Concrete Curb	4.3 m	14 ft
			Log obstacle	9.1 m	30 ft
			Washboard Terrain	6.1 m	20 ft
			9 in Half Rounds (length)	16.8 m	55 ft
			Steel Staircase (length)	6.1 m	20 ft
	Winch Test Facility	124	Concrete Deadman (max load) 578,000 N (130,000 lb)	NA	NA
	Lift/Tiedown Test Facility	124	Max Longitudinal Force 1,000,000 N (240,000 lb); Max Lateral Force 400,000 N (90,000 lb); Max Vertical Force 267,000 N (60,000 lb)	NA	NA
	Bridging Test Area	127	Sand and Gravel	NA	NA
	Tilt Table	129	Lifting Capacity 136,000 kg (300,000 lb)	3.7 m x 27 m	12 ft x 90 ft
	Boresight Slopes	129	Sand and Gravel	NA	NA
3.3 Off-Site Courses	Imperial Sand Dunes, CA	130	Loose Sand	48.3 x 64.4 km	30 x 40 mi
	Safari (Interstate 8)	131	Paved Highway, Asphalt	560 km	348 mi
	Safari (Death Valley National Monument)	132	Paved Roads, Asphalt	295 km	183 mi
	Safari (Camp Navajo)	132	High Altitude (2,900 m (9,400 ft)), Steep Grades	NA	NA
	Safari (White Mountain Research Center)	132	High Altitude (4,300 m (14,200 ft)), Steep Mountain Grades	NA	NA
3.4 Direct Fire Ranges	Combat Systems Direct Fire Range	132	Sand and Gravel	2 x 7 km	1.2 x 4.5 mi
	Moving Target Range	134	Caswell Target Max Speed 32 km/hr (20 mph). Oehler Target Max Speed 18 km/hr (11 mph)	2500 m	1.6 mi
3.5 Test Facilities	Rain Facility (Rain and Blowing Rain)	135	Chamber (W x L x H)	6.1 x 12.2 x 4.1 m	20 x 40 x 13.5 ft
			Door (W x H)	9.6 x 5.5 m	31.5 x 18 ft
	Blown Air Dust and Sand System (BADSS)	136	Max Speed	96 km/hr	60 mph
			Diameter	1.8 m	6 ft
			Material Feed Rate	9 to 18 kg/min	20 to 40 lb/min
	Environmental Chamber with Weapons Firing Capabilities	137	Dimensions (L x W x H)	13.7 x 8.8 x 4.4 m	45 x 29 x 14.5 ft
			Door (W x H)	5.2 x 4.0 m	17 x 13.2 ft
			Firing Port (W x H) Caliber: Up to 8-inch artillery	1.2 x 5.2 m	4 x 17 ft
			Temperature Range -54 to +71 ºC (-65 to +160 ºF) Humidity: 5 to 95 percent RH	NA	NA

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TOP SECTION NO.	TEST AREA	PAGE NO.	TEST AREA TYPE	FACILITY DIMENSION	
				METRIC	ENGLISH
3.5 Test Facilities	Climatic Simulation Facility (Vehicle Component Level Tests)	138	Hot/Cold with Humidity Chamber max temperature range: -57 to +82 ºC (-70 to +180 ºF)	NA	NA
			Hot with Humidity Chamber max temperature range: +4 to 82 ºC (+40 to +180 ºF)	NA	NA
			Cold without Humidity Chamber max temperature range: -57 ºC (-70 ºF)	NA	NA
			Hot/Cold without Humidity max temperature range: -54 to +63 ºC (-65 to +145 ºF)	NA	NA
			Altitude Chamber max altitude: 30,480 m (100,000 ft) max temperature range: -57 to +74 ºC (-70 to +165 ºF)	NA	NA
			Salt Fog Chamber max temperature range: +35 ºC (+95 ºF)	NA	NA
			Immersion Tank max temperature range: 113 L (4 cu ft) max temperature: +4 to +71 ºC (+40 to +160 ºF)	NA	NA
			Solar Chamber max temperature range: +4 to +82 ºC (+40 to +180 ºF)	NA	NA
	Material Analysis Laboratory	141	Building Size	650 m^2	7,000 ft^2
	Starter Test Stand	144	ST-24 Computerized Starter Tester	NA	NA
	Tire Maintenance Facility	145	Maintenance Facility	NA	NA

Notes:
cm = centimeter

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TABLE 2. CONT'D

TOP SECTION NO.	TEST AREA	PAGE NO.	TEST AREA TYPE	FACILITY DIMENSION	
				METRIC	ENGLISH
3.5 Test Facilities	Hybrid Electric Facility	145	Facility and Load Banks	250 kW max	NA
	Vibration Facility	146	Six electromagnetic vibration systems	NA	NA
	Physical Test Facility	147	Physical measurements, non-destructive measurements, material properties testing, and mass properties testing	NA	NA
	Site 3 Drop Test Facility	147	Item Capacity and Height	454 kg at 9 m	1,000 lb at 30 ft
	12 Meter Drop Test Facility	148	Item Capacity and Height	1,800 kg at 18 m	4,000 lb at 60 ft
3.6 Maintenance Facilities	Operations and Maintenance Division Complex	148	Maintenance Facility with Secure Storage yard	892 m^2	9,600 ft^2
	Main Test Maintenance Facility	148	Maintenance Facility with Lighted Storage yard	8,300 m^2	90,000 ft^2
	Ancillary Test Maintenance Facility	149	Maintenance Facility with Lighted Storage yard	2,482 m^2	26,712 ft^2
	MT Test Maintenance Facility	149	Maintenance Facility	1486 m^2	16,000 ft^2
	Welding and Metal Shop Facility	149	Maintenance Facility	5,417 m^2	58,310 ft^2

b. The test facilities at ATC contain approximately 64 km (40 mi) of automotive test courses on more than 1320 hectares (3300 acres) of land. In addition, there are water areas and firing ranges for vehicle testing. Each automotive test course and facility is designed to meet a particular military vehicle specification and many exceed commercial standards. Information regarding test course severity is located in TOP 01-1-010A[3].

c. The test facilities at YTC contain more than 100 miles of test courses. Although YTC spans over 1,300 square miles, the automotive endurance and performance courses and test facilities are situated within close proximity to each other within the southern portion of YTC, which allow for tailoring vehicle tests to any specified mission profile. Each automotive test course and facility is designed to meet a particular military vehicle specification and many exceed commercial standards. Information regarding test course severity is located in TOP 01-1-010A.

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2. ABERDEEN TEST CENTER COURSES AND FACILITIES.

2.1 Churchville Test Area (CTA).

a. Purchased in 1942, this area is north of the town of Churchville and borders the east side of Maryland Highway 136 and the south side of Deer Creek (Figures 2.1-1 and 2.1-2). It consists of 98.7 hectares (244 acres), located approximately 19 km (12 mi) from APG, and is used for endurance testing of all types of automotive vehicles. It is well suited for determining the durability and reliability of engines and power train systems.



Figure 2.1-1. Aerial view of Churchville Test Area.

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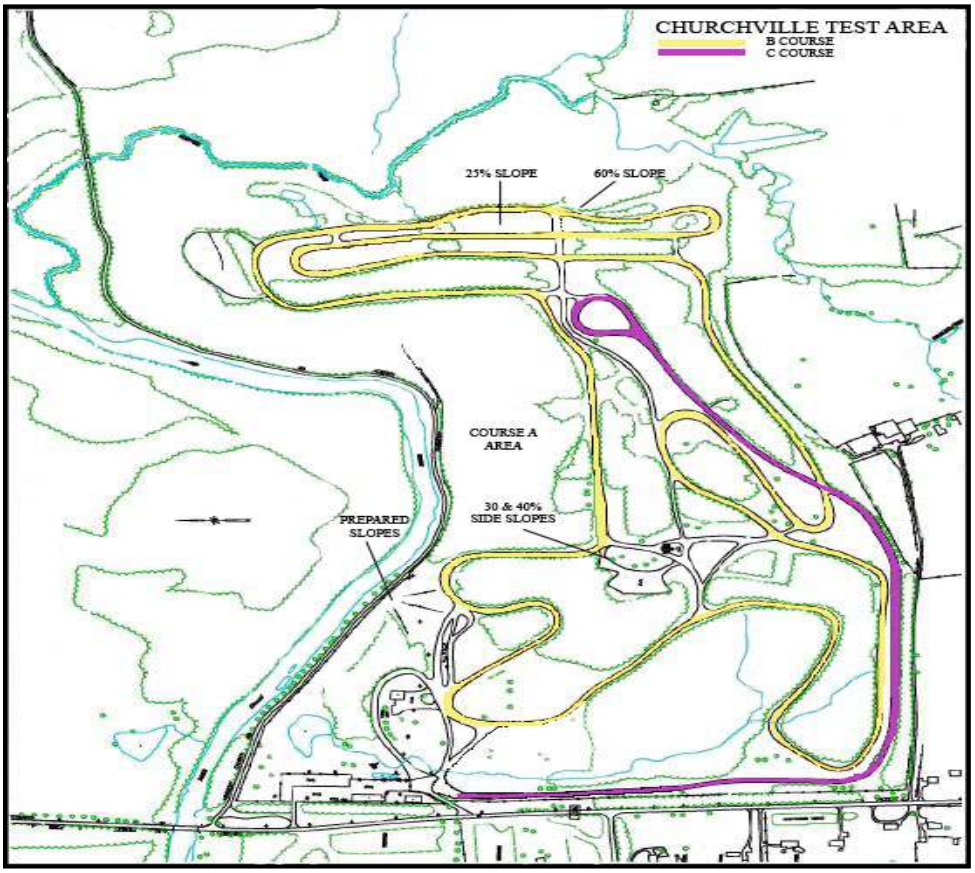


Figure 2.1-2. Topographic map of Churchville Test Area.

b. Hilly Cross-Country Courses.

(1) The entire Churchville area is characterized by a series of steep hills with grades as great as 30 percent and is heavily wooded in some parts. Test courses are in closed loops over and around the hills.

(2) Course A, more accurately identified as an area, is the most severe of the hilly cross-country courses. It is heavily wooded and includes rocky terrain, ravines, grades as steep as 30 percent, and side slopes.

(3) Course B (Figure 2.1-3 and 2.1-4) consists of grades as steep as 29 percent. The terrain is native soil topped with bank run gravel ranging from muddy to dusty, depending on the weather.

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Figure 2.1-3. Hilly Cross-Country Course B in extreme cold and muddy conditions.



Figure 2.1-4. Hilly Cross-Country Course B.

(4) Course C is a 2.4-km (1.5-mi) secondary road with maximum grades of 10 percent and a turnaround at each end, as shown in Figure 2.1-2. The course is well suited for tests of trailers and semi-trailers. Soil side slopes of 30 and 40 percent are available for mobility and stability challenges.

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c. Prepared Soil Slopes. These slopes are used for controlled tests to evaluate the tractive ability of vehicles. Five longitudinal grades: (1) 10 percent, 67 meters (220 ft), (2) 15 percent, 76 meters (250 ft), (3) 20 percent, 67 meters (220 ft), (4) 25 percent, 183 meters (600 ft), and (5) 60 percent, 37 meters (120 ft) are particularly useful for measuring mobility performance and for comparison tests of experimental and standard vehicles. Soil side slopes of 30 and 40 percent are available for mobility and stability challenges. The soil slope gradients can be reconfigured to suit specific test requirements with advanced planning. The soil type associated with the soil slopes conforms to the Unified Soil Classification System, type SC.

d. Harford Loop. This area is a paved, closed loop course comprised of local highways located north of the CTA. It is 29.8 km (18.5 mi) in length and is generally described as gentle rolling hills with grades ranging from 2 to 10 percent and includes three stop signs and one traffic light. It is driven at posted speed limits ranging between 48 and 80 km/hr (30 and 50 mph) to determine vehicle fuel consumption characteristics. A mapping of the course, outlined in blue, is presented in Figure 2.1-5.

e. Conowingo Loop. This area is a paved, closed loop course, 74.8 km (46.5 mi) in length, comprised of segments of local and federal public highways located north of the CTA of ATC. The course is designed to satisfy requirements of Society of Automotive Engineers (SAE) procedures J1264[4], J1321[5], and J1526[6], which are used to assess medium to heavy duty in-service vehicles. A mapping of the course, outlined in red, is presented in Figure 2.1-5.

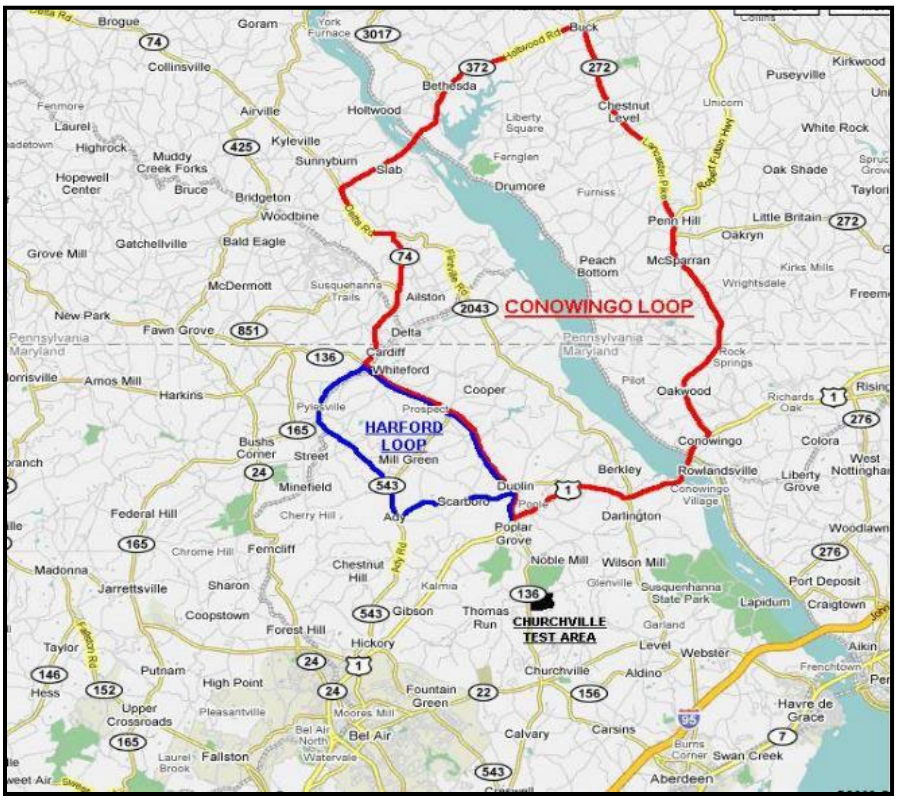


Figure 2.1-5. Harford Loop and Conowingo Loop map locations.

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2.2 Environmental Testing Facilities.

The facilities described below are used for simulated environmental testing of a variety of equipment at ATC. Some of these chambers are of the proper size and capacity to accommodate automotive vehicles and allow the firing of a variety of weapons.

a. Multi-Purpose Environmental Test Chamber. This spacious multipurpose facility provides temperature, humidity, and icing testing capabilities supporting the requirements of MIL-STD-810H CN1. The chamber is 12.2 m wide by 22.9 m long by 7.3 m high (40 ft wide by 75 ft long by 24 ft high) and is divided into two 12.2-m by 11.3-m (40-ft by 37-ft) chambers having independent climatic controls. Each chamber has a 4.9-m by 4.9-m (16-ft by 16-ft) door (Figure 2.2-1). The temperature range is -54 to 74 ºC (-65 to 165 ºF). An adjacent area is available for data acquisition and control instrumentation.



Figure 2.2-1. Multi-purpose Environmental Test Chamber.

b. Mobility Test Chamber. This chamber (Figure 2.2-2) is utilized for non-firing tests at extreme environmental conditions. The facility has two test cells each, approximately 9.1 m wide by 18.3 m long (30 ft wide by 60 ft long). Temperature conditions are variable from -54 ºC (-65 ºF) to 74 ºC (165 ºF) with 141.6 cubic meters per minute (cmm) (5,000 cubic feet per minute (cfm)) conditioned makeup air and exhaust systems. The facility also has a solar array used to simulate extreme solar environments.

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Figure 2.2-2. Mobility Test Chamber.

c. Firing Test Chamber. This chamber (Figure 2.2-3) has large and small caliber firing capability at extreme environmental conditions. Extreme conditions are variable from -54 ºC (-65 ºF) to 74 ºC (165 ºF) with 5,000 cfm conditioned makeup air and exhaust systems.



Figure 2.2-3. Firing Test Chamber.

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d. Vibration Facility. Three remotely controlled electrodynamic vibration systems capable of testing to MIL-STD-810H CN1 are available. These systems are used for shock and vibration testing of vehicle components, equipment, weapons, and ammunition (Figures 2.2-4 and 2.2-5). Laboratory vibration schedules are developed from field data. Vibration exciter force capabilities are available up to 178 kN (40,000 lb-f) in single axis, three planes. The available temperature range available is from -54 to 74 ºC (-65 to 165 ºF).



Figure 2.2-4. Vibration facility vertical exciter.



Figure 2.2-5. Vibration facility horizontal exciter.

e. Climatic Simulation Facilities. These facilities (some of which are shown in Figures 2.2-6 and 2.2-7) provide climate test support in accordance with the test methods in MIL-STD-810H CN 1. Three portable wind machines generate up to 161 km/hr (100 mph) winds. In addition, a portable wind-driven rain machine produces 10 cm/hr (4 in./hr) of rain with up to 80 km/hr (50 mph) wind. Two stationary temperature-humidity chambers 2.9 by 2.4 by 2.0 m (9.5 by 7.9 by 6.4 ft) and nine portable units 1.8 by 1.4 by 1.5 m (6.0 by 4.7 by 5.0 ft) having temperature ranges -62 to 93 ºC (-80 to 200 ºF) with humidity up to 100 percent are available. A solar radiation chamber 3.0 by 3.7 by 0.9 m (10 by 12 by 3 ft) is also available. Pressurized water up to 345 kilopascals (kPa) (50 pounds per square inch (psi)) can be provided over a 3.7 by 7.3 m (12.0 by 24.0 ft) area. Steam pressure up to 103 kPa (15 psi) and 118 ºC (245 ºF) is available in a 2.1 m diameter by 3.7 m long (7 by 12 ft) vessel. Altitude Chamber 2.4 by 3.5 by 3 m (8 by 11.5 by 10 ft) capable of simulating 1524 m (5000 ft) at ambient temperature.

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Figure 2.2-6. Solar radiation chamber.

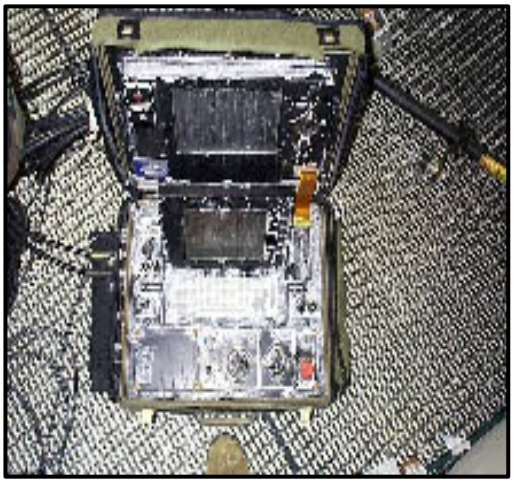


Figure 2.2-7. Salt test.

f. Electromagnetic Interference Test Facility (EMITF). The facility consists of four test chambers, the largest of which measures 21.3 m long by 18.3 m wide by 6.1 m high (70 by 60 by 20 ft), making it large enough for combat vehicles, tactical trucks, large caliber weapons systems, and helicopters (Figure 2.2-8). In addition, the largest chamber contains an E3-hardened dynamometer on a turntable, capable of supporting up to four-axled wheeled vehicles of up to 76,000lbs. Testing is available through the frequency range of 16 Hertz (Hz) to 40 Gigahertz (GHz), with susceptibility levels up to 1000 volts per meter (V/m). Testing can be accomplished in accordance with Military, SAE, Comite International Special de Perturbations Radioectriques (CISPR), and Federal Communications Commission (FCC) standards. The shielded enclosure has magnetic field attenuation of 40 decibels (dB), 14 Kilohertz (kHz) to 1 Megahertz (MHz), electric field attenuation of 100 dB, 14 kHz to 18 GHz.



Figure 2.2-8. Electromagnetic Interference Test Facility with E3-Hardened dynamometer/turntable.

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2.3 Dynamometer Course.

a. This course, in the Michaelsville area of ATC, is constructed of reinforced concrete, with a hot mixed bituminous surface making it suitable for operations of the heaviest tracked vehicles. The course has a total gradient of less than 0.1 percent in its 1.6 km (1 mi) length, and turnarounds are provided at each end. It is used for closely controlled engineering tests such as drawbar pull (Figure 2.3-1), tractive resistance measurements, coast-down, braking, and fuel consumption. These tests are conducted at low to moderate speeds.



Figure 2.3-1. Drawbar pull test conducted on Dynamometer Course.

b. A gravel connector between the straight portions of the Perryman No. 1 course and Secondary Road A (Section 2.8) is referred to as the Dirt Dynamometer Course. It provides an approximately 2.4 km (1.5 mi) straight, level, dirt surface to allow dynamometer testing of steel-tracked vehicles which could damage paved surfaces.

2.4 Mile Loop.

a. This oval-shaped facility was originally constructed in 1933 as a level concrete course for continuous high-speed operating tests of vehicles (Figure 2.4-1). The Mile Loop consists of two straight sections, each 0.4 km (0.25 mi) long, joined at each end by 0.4-km sections of regular curvature to form an oval totaling 1.6 km (1 mi) in circumference. The curves are slightly banked at a gradient of 4 percent.

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Figure 2.4-1. Aerial view of the Mile Loop.

b. The course has been modified by covering and maintaining the surface with hot mixed bituminous concrete and by adding a gravel surface parallel to and outside the oval. Located within the Mile Loop are additional facilities, as described below.

(1) Winch Test Facility. This device has a restraining capability of 445 kN (100,000 lb) and is used mainly as an anchor during winch performance and endurance testing.

(2) Pothole-Crosstie Course. This oval facility is situated on a concrete pad within the mile loop and consists of a series of concrete potholes on one straight side of the oval, a series of wooden crossties on the opposite straight side, and two 10.7-m (35-ft) radius gravel ends connecting the two straight sections.

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(a) The pothole section consists of eight concrete potholes 5 m (17 ft) apart (8 m (25 ft) center to center) (Figure 2.4-2). Each pothole is l.8 m (6.0 ft) wide, 2.4 m (8.0 ft) long, and 30.5 cm (12.0 in.) deep, sunk below the concrete surface. The sides of each pothole are sloped 45 percent (24.2 degrees), and the ends are sloped 100 percent (45 degrees). The total length of this segment of the course is 61 m (200 ft).

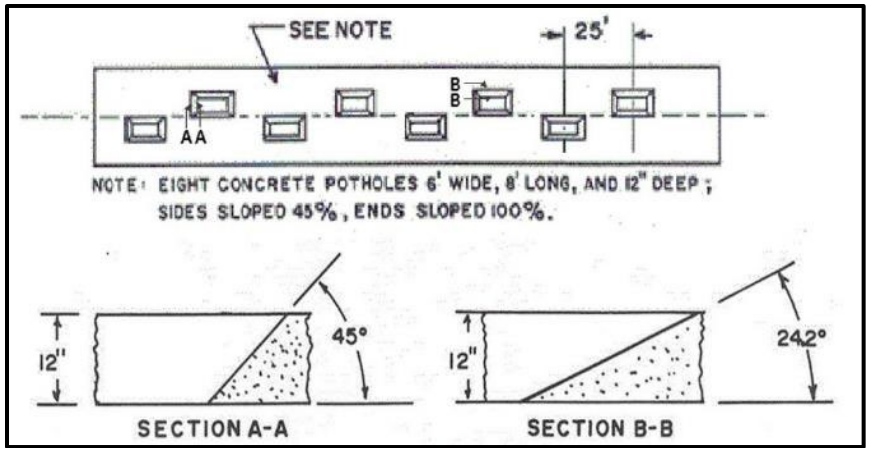


Figure 2.4-2. Pothole section of Pothole-Crosstie Course.

(b) The crosstie section of the course consists of 11 crossties, 1.8 m (5.9 ft) long, 15.2 cm (6.0 in.) high, and 15.2 cm (6.0 in.) wide, mounted to the concrete surface by means of 7.6 cm (3.0 in.) angle iron. The ties are spaced at 3.7 m (12.0 ft) intervals (center to center) at alternate right and left sides of the course. The total length of this segment is 40.2 m (132 ft). Figure 2.4-3 shows a vehicle negotiating the Pothole-Crosstie Course.



Figure 2.4-3. Vehicle negotiating Pothole Test Course.

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(3) 1-Inch Bump Course. The 2.5 cm (1 in.) bumps are iron rods, 4.3 m (14 ft) long, 5 cm (2 in.) wide and 2.5 cm high, mounted on the flat concrete surface in the center of the pothole-crosstie course. A total of 39 1-inch bumps is spaced at random 1.5-m and 1.8-m (5-ft and 6-ft) intervals perpendicular to the direction of travel. The course length is 67 m (220 ft).

(4) Rain Towers. The rain towers at ATC offer a dynamic rain course where personnel perform simulated combat activities. The course consists of two 9.1 m (30 ft) high towers that accommodate items up to 9.1 by 15.2 m (30 by 50 ft) in area and up to 7.6 m (25 ft) tall. The rain towers produce simulated free-falling rain of intensities up to 10.2 cm (4 in.) per hour. The rain course accommodates the evaluation of associated shelter support/restraint systems (stakes, guy lines, etc.), generators, environmental control units, and all other wheeled and tracked vehicles. Figure 2.4-4 shows the Rain Towers at ATC.



Figure 2.4-4. Rain Towers at Mile Loop.

(5) Half Rounds. These obstacles are reinforced steel pipes cut in half longitudinally of 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, and 41 cm (4, 6, 8, 10, 12, and 16 in.) radii affixed to a steel and concrete base. They are used to address the shock portion of ride quality testing. There are currently two locations of Half Rounds at the Mile Loop, spaced 0.5 mile apart, both residing on a level straight section of the paved course.

2.5 Mountain Highway.

This is a 64 km (40 mi) mountainous section of U.S. Route 30 in the vicinity of Jennerstown, Pennsylvania. Considered one of the most severe areas in the region for brake fade testing, it is used by ATC and the brake-manufacturing industry for brake fade testing. With grades as steep as 11 percent and at various elevations (Figure 2.5-1), this section of public highway is

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admirably suited for testing military wheeled vehicle brakes (test procedures are described in TOP 02-2-608[7]). Standard test conditions are obtained by controlling speed, brake line pressure, and deceleration. Brake temperatures and pressures, and vehicle road speed and stopping distances are measured throughout the test. Figure 2.5-2 shows a test vehicle descending a mountain during the mountain brake endurance test.

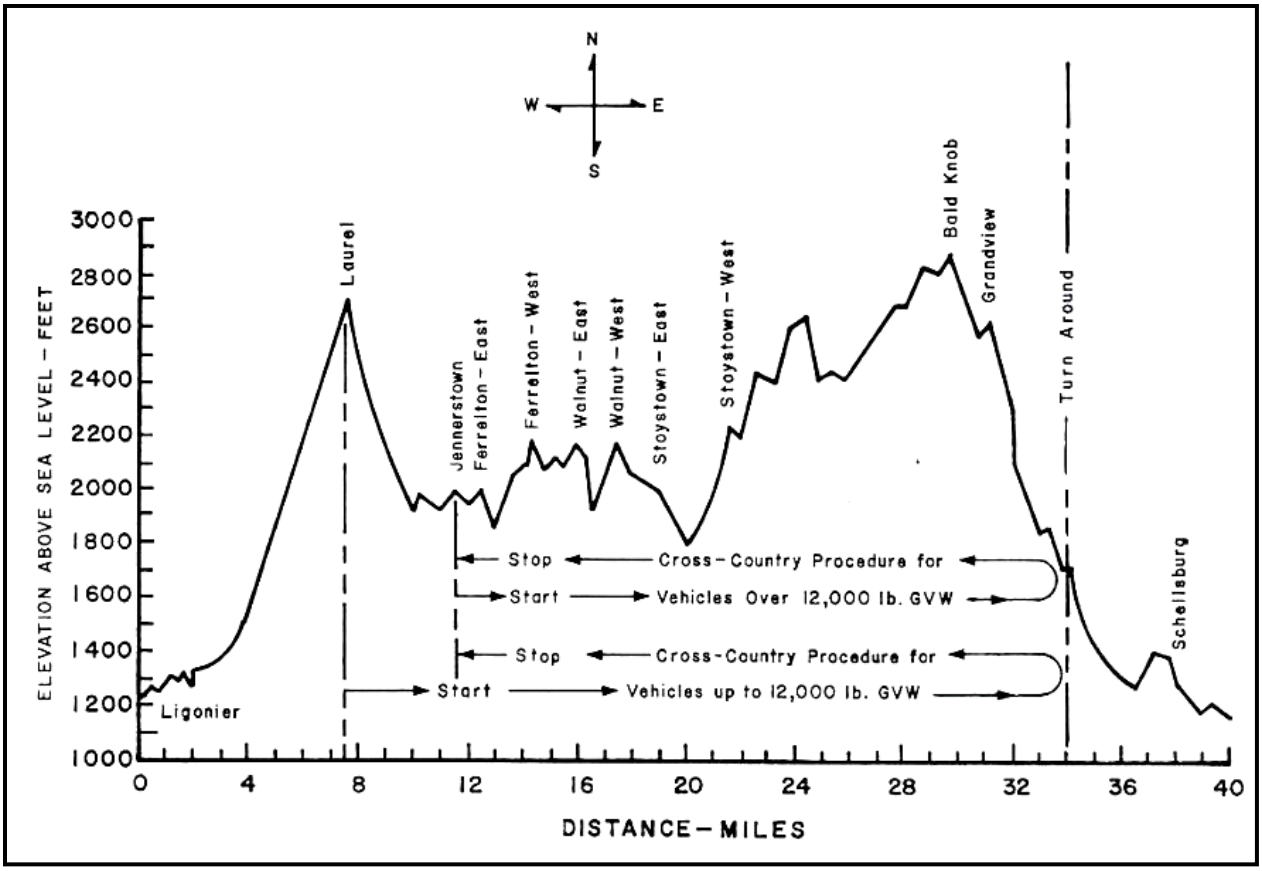


Figure 2.5-1. Profile of Mountain Test Course.

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Figure 2.5-2. Test vehicle and data van / safety escort vehicle descending mountain.

2.6 Munson Test Area (MTA).

a. Located near the eastern boundary of APG and bordering the shores of the Spesutie Island Narrows portion of the Chesapeake Bay, the MTA encompasses about 60 hectares (150 acres) of land. The facility is named in honor of Lieutenant Max Munson who lost his life in 1941 while testing an experimental vehicle.

b. The test courses are designed for making specific measurements and determinations of vehicle performance in the field. All special obstacles and test roads were permanently constructed, and are maintained, according to specifications. The courses and network of connecting roads total 14.5 km (9 mi). Figure 2.6-1 shows relative locations of the courses, and Figure 2.6-2 is an aerial view.

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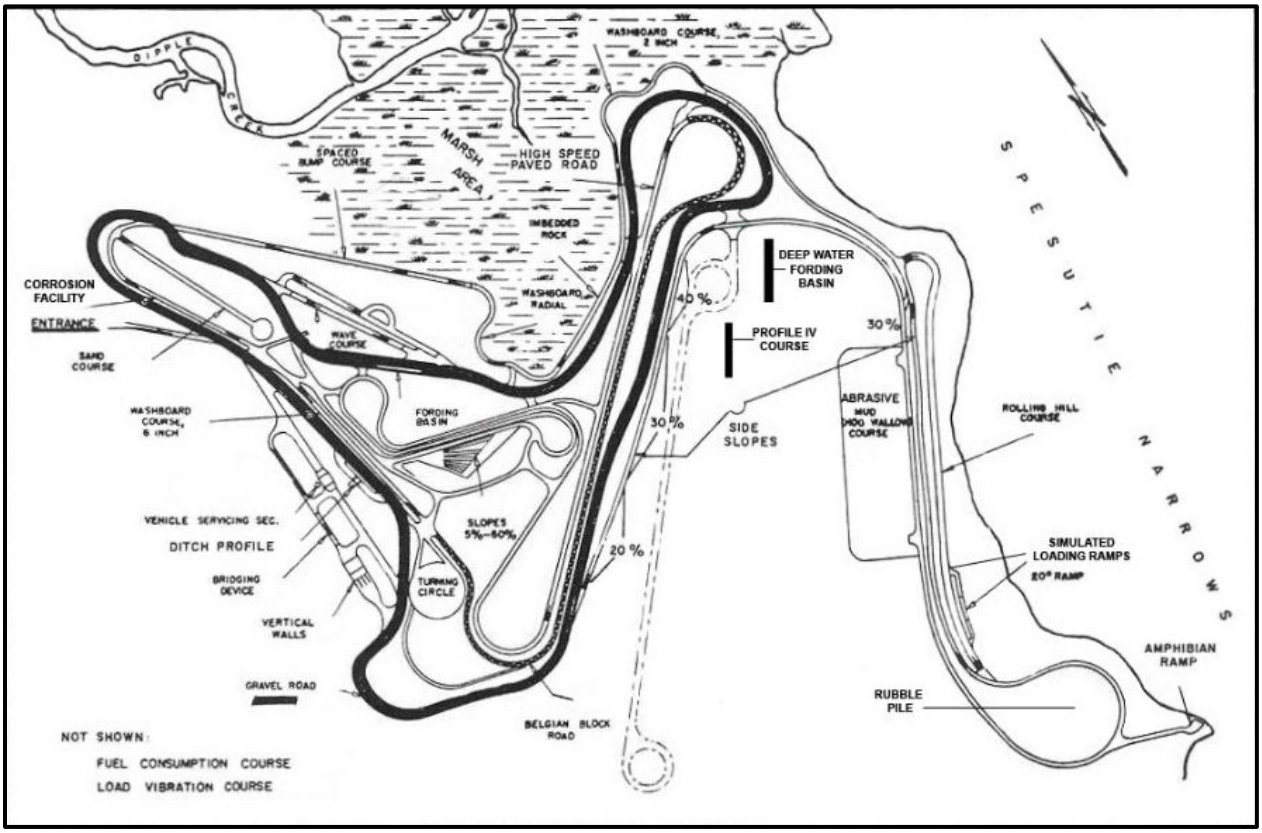


Figure 2.6-1. Munson Test Area.



Figure 2.6-2. Aerial view of Munson Test Area.

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2.6.1 Paved Road.

This is a level road (Figure 2.6-3) that permits the operation of most military vehicles at high speed. It provides a sharp contrast in operating conditions when used as part of a loop including the Belgian Block Course.

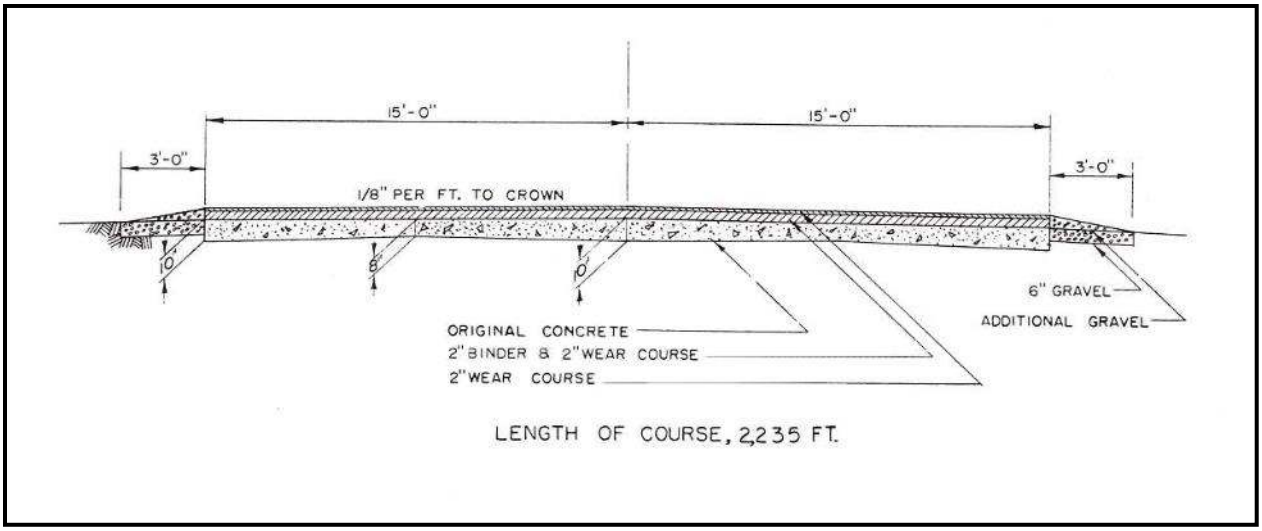


Figure 2.6-3. Cross section of Paved Road.

2.6.2 Improved Gravel Road.

This is a loop of about 3.2 km (2 mi) with left and right curves; the surface is compacted gravel maintained by grading (Figure 2.6-4). This gravel road (along with other test courses) is used for endurance testing.

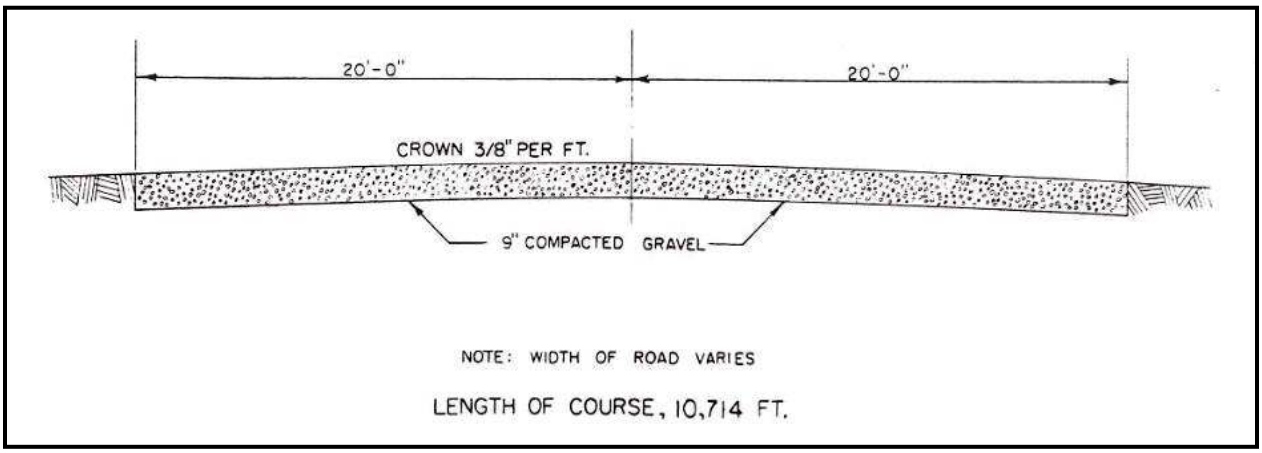


Figure 2.6-4. Cross-section of Improved Gravel Road.

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2.6.3 Rolling Hill Course.

This was designed to provide short, closely spaced grades. As a vehicle alternates between up- and down-grades on this course (Figure 2.6-5), the engine and power train are subjected to rapid variations in loading. The surface consists of crushed stone compacted with stone dust binder.

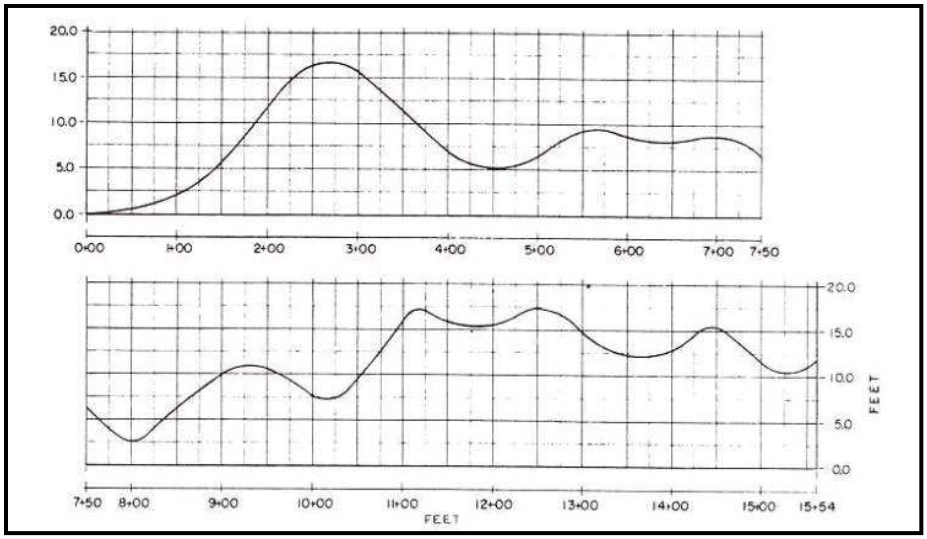


Figure 2.6-5. Profile of Rolling Hill Course.

2.6.4 Sand Course.

This course provides a standard for evaluating drawbar pull of wheeled and track-laying vehicles under controlled conditions. The coarse grained sand, conforming to the Unified Soil Classification soil type SP (poorly graded sand), is contained in a concrete bin that facilitates tilling and drainage, and prevents contamination from the surrounding soil (Figure 2.6-6). The straight portion of the course has sufficient length to produce stabilized data for a given load and/or speed condition. The circular bed at the end of the course is useful for evaluating the ability of vehicles to steer in sand, and for determining track-throwing tendencies and the effect of sand accumulation in suspension systems. Figure 2.6-7 shows drawbar pull testing conducted on the Sand Course.

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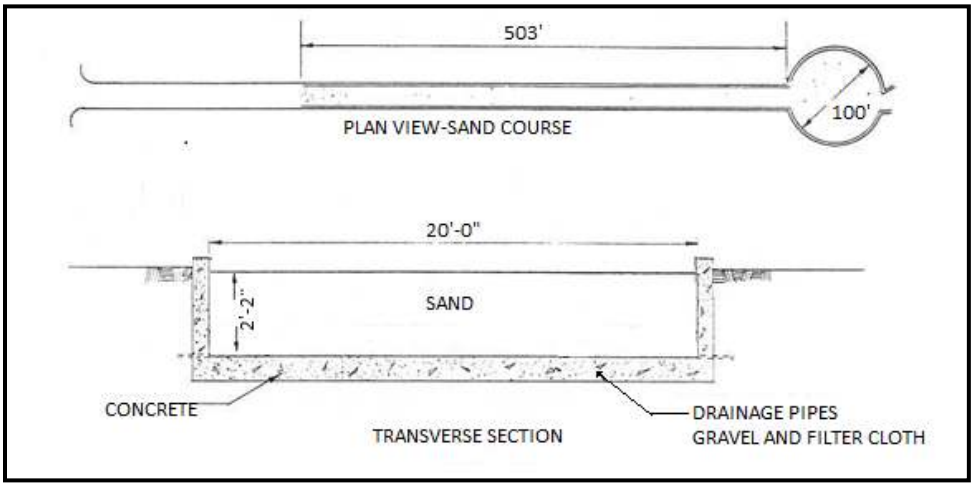


Figure 2.6-6. Plan view and transverse section of Sand Course.



Figure 2.6-7. Drawbar pull testing in Sand Course.

2.6.5 Rubble Pile.

The Rubble Pile course is approximately 30.5 m (100 ft) in length, consisting of large boulders and pieces of concrete and steel (Figure 2.6-8). A test on this course is conducted to determine a vehicle's ability to negotiate this type of obstacle.

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Figure 2.6-8. Rubble Pile at MTA.

2.6.6 Corrosion Facility.

a. This facility provides aggressive controlled exposure of corrosive conditions to land systems to hasten their weathering process and determine susceptibility to the environments. Fifteen test cycles replicate one year of field corrosion; a 22-year corrosion assessment can be implemented in 200+ days.

b. Each test cycle includes a series of individual corrosive environments (Figure 2.6-9): Splash Trough – 22.9 m long by 6.1 m wide (75 ft long by 20 ft wide), solution depth up to 5 cm (2 in.) subjected to undercarriage; Mist Booth – 18.3 m long by 4.6 m wide by 4.6 m high (60 ft long by 15 ft wide by 15 ft high) up to 3-minute mist applied to top and vertical surfaces; Grit Trough – 22.9 m long by 4.3 m wide (75 ft long by 14 ft wide), slurry depth up to 0.2 m (8 in.) subjected to undercarriage; High Heat / High Humidity Chamber – 12.2 m long by 6.1 m wide by 6.1 m high (40 ft long by 20 ft wide by 20 ft high), up to 74 ºC (165 ºF), 1 to 2 milliliter per hour (mL/hr) condensate; Deep Water Fording Basin – 57.9 m long by 6.7 m wide (190 ft long by 22 ft wide) with adjustable water depth up to 2.1 m (84 in.), and a 3-percent sodium chloride (NaCl) solution which replicates ocean environment. Facilities instrumentation and equipment are used to provide identification, analysis, and documentation of corrosion to the test item.

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Figure 2.6-9. Accelerated Corrosion Complex.

2.6.7 Abrasive Mud Course.

Also known as the hog wallow, this facility (Figure 2.6-10) has an independent piped water supply that provides the means for maintaining muddy conditions, regardless of the season. The soil is sandy, with some clay and silt, making it particularly useful for evaluating the effects of abrasion on seals, brakes, and other components, as well as the effectiveness of seals. The ability to control the moisture content in dry periods makes it possible to adjust the course conditions and soil strength profile (within limits) to suit test requirements of any particular vehicle. The soil conforms to the Unified Soil Classification System soil type SM. The course can be tilled to various depths to a maximum of 0.8 m (2.8 ft). The course is 73 by 290 m (240 by 950 ft). Figure 2.6-11 shows a vehicle undergoing crossing velocity testing on the Abrasive Mud Course. Figure 2.6-12 shows a draw bar pull test in Abrasive Mud Course.

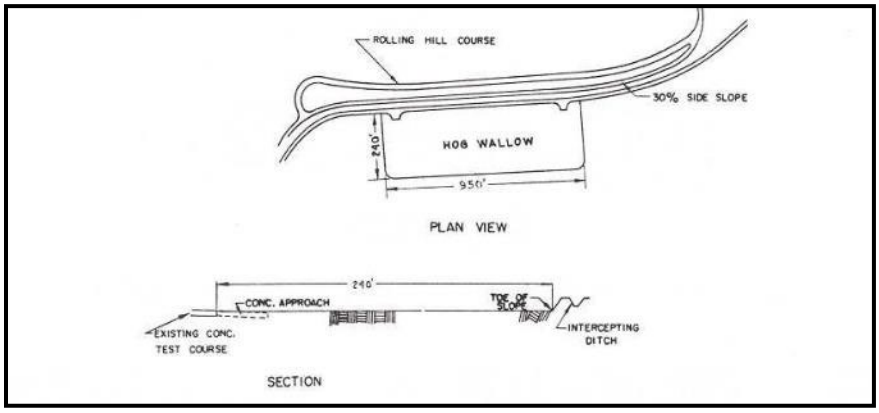


Figure 2.6-10. Plan view and section, Abrasive Mud Course.

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Figure 2.6-11. Crossing velocity test over the Abrasive Mud Course.



Figure 2.6-12. Drawbar pull test over the Abrasive Mud Course.

2.6.8 Shallow Water Fording Basin.

Also known as the bathtub, this concrete facility was designed to provide still water at controlled depths to 1.5 m (5.0 ft) (Figures 2.6-13 and 2.6-14). Ramps at both ends permit gradual immersion if desired. Length and width of the basin are sufficient for running preliminary flotation tests on some amphibious vehicles. The main uses of the basin are for determining fording characteristics of non-floating vehicles and for studying the effects of water on running

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gear components such as brakes, seals, and universal joints. The length of this course is 82 m (270 ft).

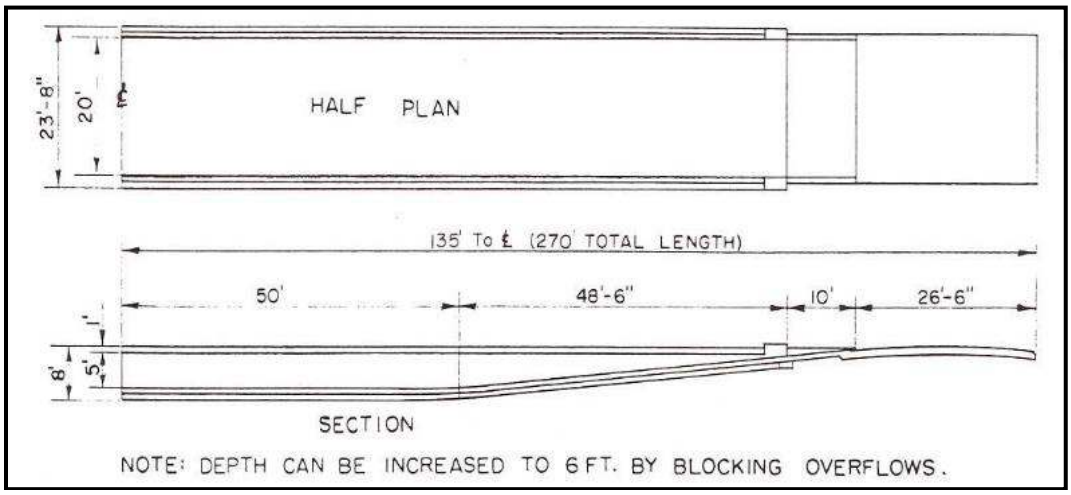


Figure 2.6-13. Half plan and section views, Shallow Water Fording Basin.



Figure 2.6-14. Vehicle fording 152-cm (60-in), Shallow Water Fording Basin.

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2.6.9 Deep Water Fording Facility.

Some vehicles can neutralize water obstacles by submerging. Vehicle effectiveness while submerged is tested in this concrete facility (Figure 2.6-15), in which water depths can be adjusted to 6.1 m (20 ft). Performance and safety of operations are evaluated under water and on the 40- and 50-percent entrance and exit slopes. The length of this facility is 96 m (315 ft).

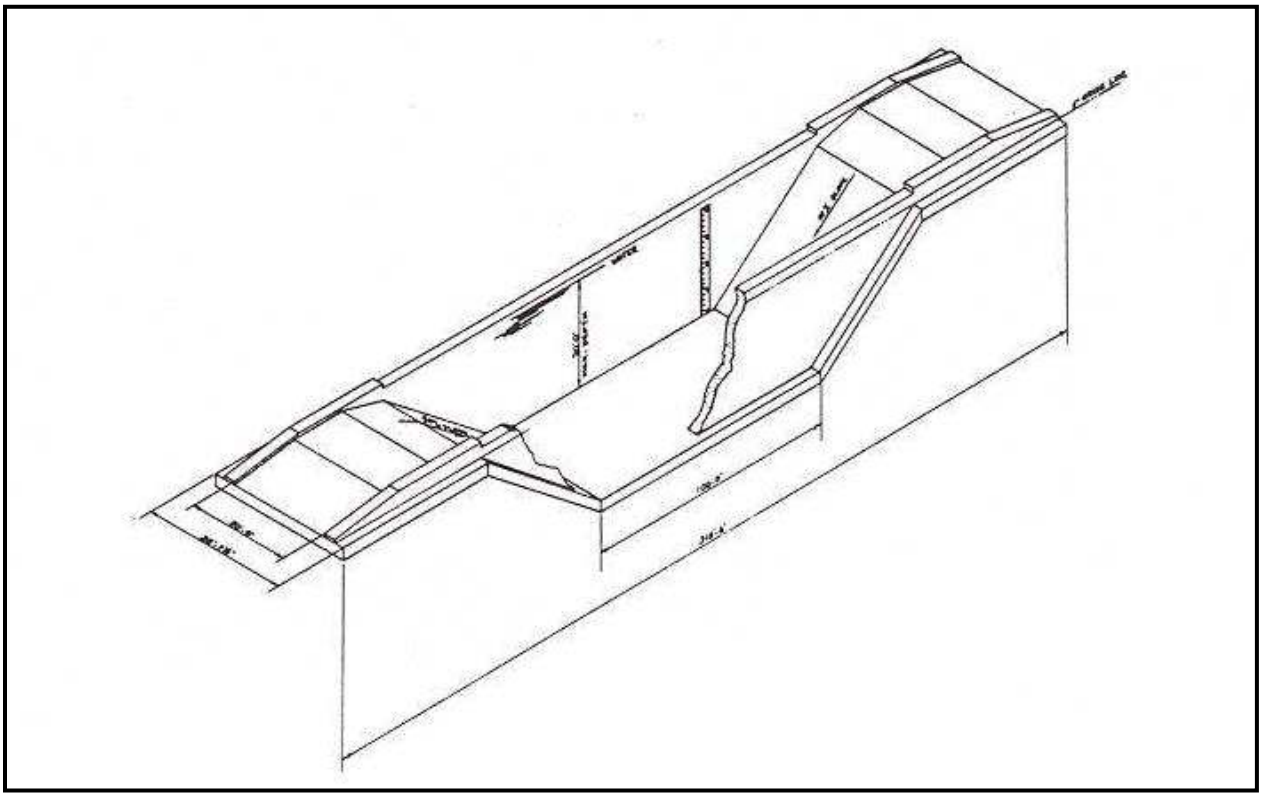


Figure 2.6-15. Deep Water Fording Facility.

2.6.10 Amphibian Ramp.

This is used for evaluating the ability of vehicles to enter and leave a natural body of water by means of an articulated concrete mat which is composed of concrete blocks and cables. It is anchored in place, and the blocks are filled with aggregate (Figure 2.6-16). The moderately sloped ramp extends into the water sufficiently to permit the safe launching of test vehicles whose flotation characteristics are known. The ramp is an ideal location for conducting bollard pull for marine vehicles and amphibians (Figure 2.6-17). For water entrance and exit interface tests, earthen slopes are constructed by grading. The ramp is 15 m (50 ft) wide and 6 m (21 ft) long.

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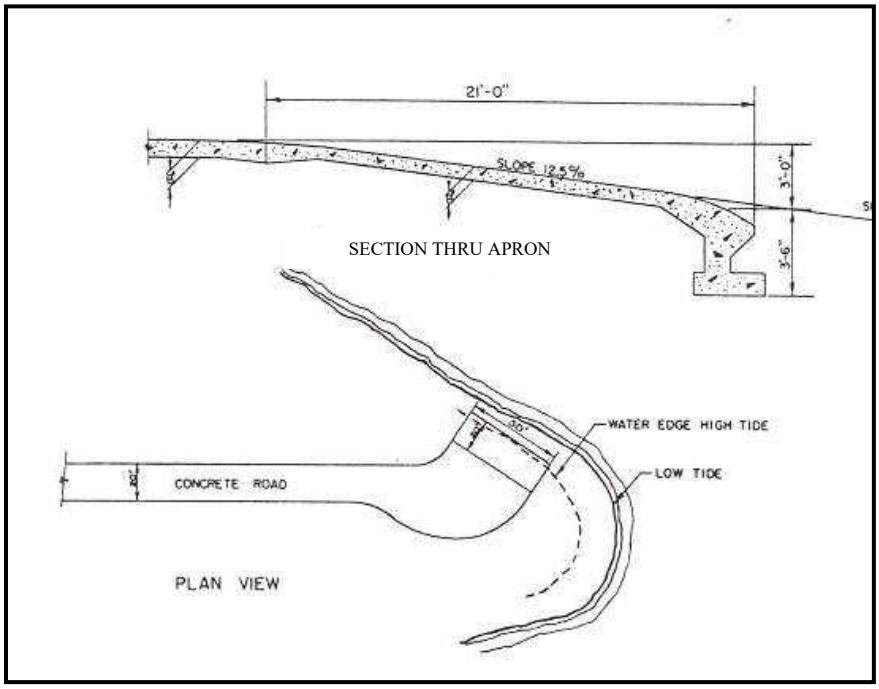


Figure 2.6-16. Plan view and section, Amphibian Ramp.



Figure 2.6-17. Bollard pull testing using mobile field dynamometer at Amphibian Ramp.

2.6.11 Shallow Water Swimming Area.

The Spesutie Island Narrows has a 305 m (1000 ft) channel typically 3 m (10 ft) deep and 15 m (50 ft) wide suitable for evaluating the swimming and floating capabilities of amphibious

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vehicles in still water (Figure 2.6-18). Fuel consumption and speed tests, as well as tests to evaluate floating bridges and rafts, are conducted here. Entrance to the Spesutie Narrows is by way of the amphibian ramp. The Spesutie Narrows leads to deeper waters of the Chesapeake Bay where additional testing may be conducted if necessary. Rather large vessels, such as landing craft, can gain access to the MTA through the Chesapeake Bay and the Spesutie channel.



Figure 2.6-18. Testing at Shallow Water Swimming Area.

2.6.12 Belgian Block Course.

This facility is paved with unevenly laid granite blocks forming an undulating surface (Figures 2.6-19 and 2.6-20). It duplicates the rough cobblestone road found in many parts of the world. About 1.2 km (0.75 mi) long, the course is useful as a standard rough road for accelerated tests of wheeled vehicles and is generally included in cycles of courses used for vibration studies. The motion imparted to a vehicle is a random combination of roll and pitch and high-frequency vibrations imparted by the granite paving blocks. Belgian Block course is not a closed loop and must be paired with either MTA Paved or MTA Improved Gravel Road.

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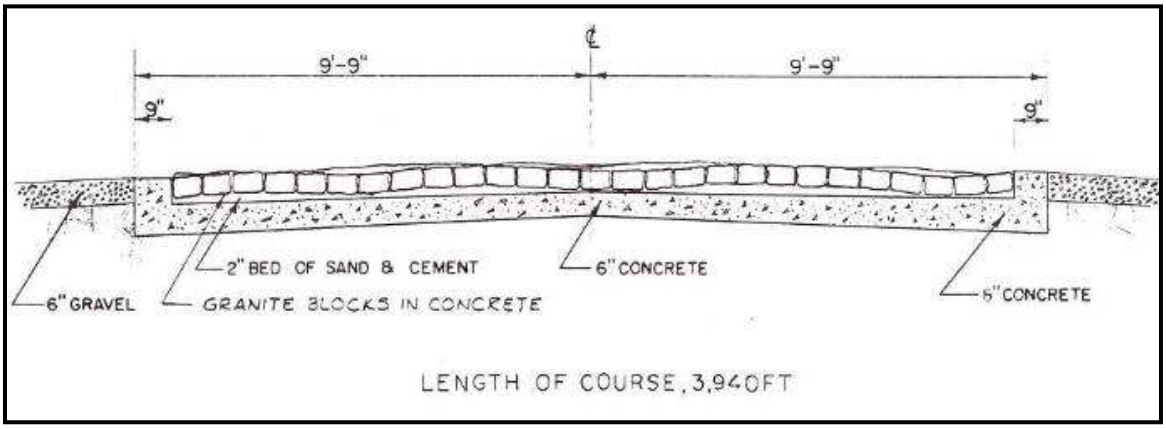


Figure 2.6-19. Transverse section, Belgian Block Course.



Figure 2.6-20. Belgian Block Course.

2.6.13 Imbedded Rock Course.

This course provides an extremely rough surface for testing wheeled vehicles (Figure 2.6-21). It not only has an irregular surface suitable for evaluating suspensions but is also a severe test for pneumatic tires (Figure 2.6-22).

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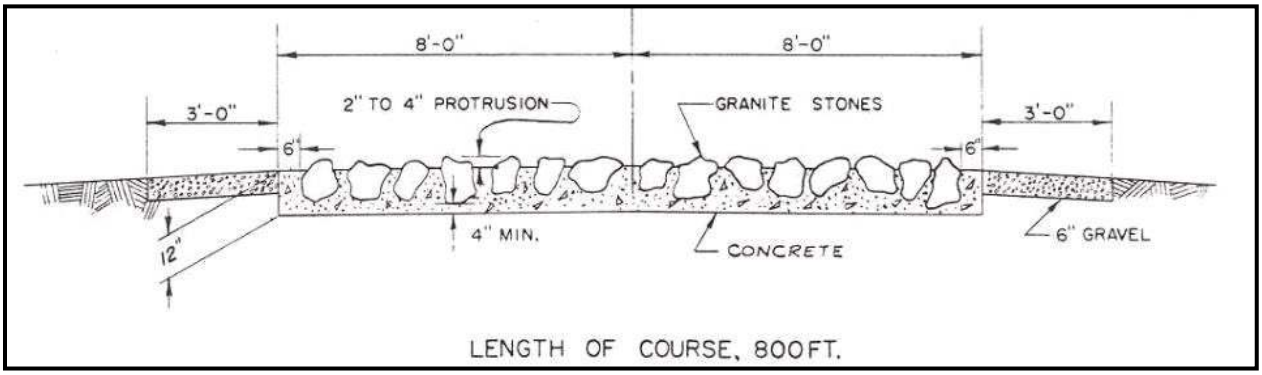


Figure 2.6-21. Transverse section of Imbedded Rock Course.



Figure 2.6-22. Endurance testing using Imbedded Rock Course.

2.6.14 Side Slopes.

Side slopes of 20, 30, and 40 percent are used as standards for testing the stability and controllability of tactical vehicles (Figures 2.6-23 and 2.6-24). In addition to being used in engineering tests to measure steering efforts and lateral loading effects, the courses are sufficiently long to be incorporated in endurance tests involving other types of operation. A 1.8 m (5.9 ft) level gravel shoulder adjoining the slopes permits operation at gradients less than those of the actual slopes. When required for specific tests, side slopes with other gradients are constructed with a grader. The course lengths are shown in Table 1.

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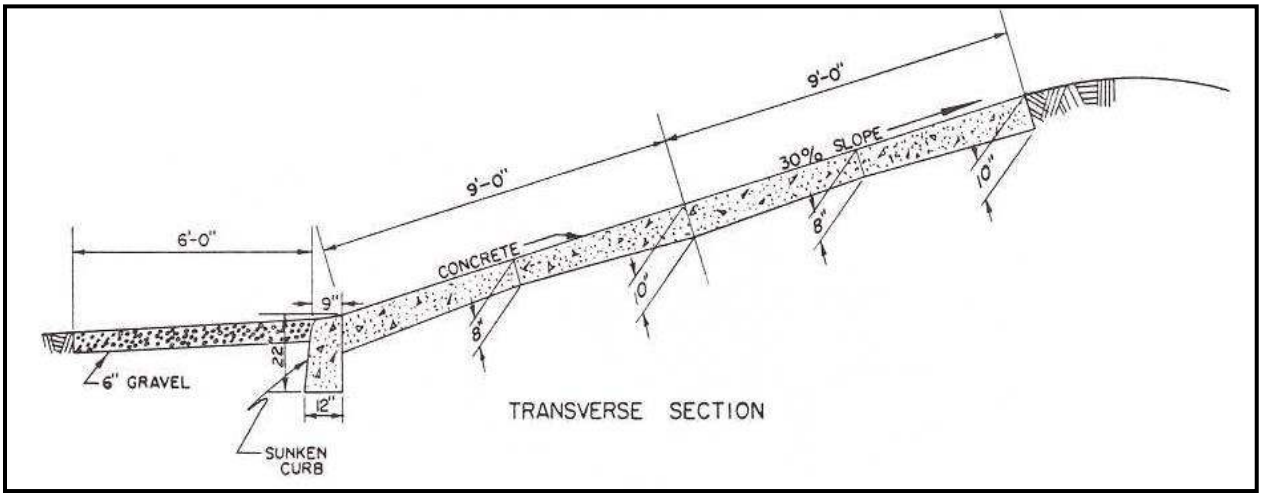


Figure 2.6-23. Transverse section of 30-percent side slope.



Figure 2.6-24. Vehicle negotiating the 30-percent side slope.

2.6.15 Longitudinal Grades.

Gradeability of vehicles is a basic characteristic usually given in design specifications of military vehicles. The MTA longitudinal grades (Figures 2.6-25 and 2.6-26) cover a range of 5 to 60 percent. They are used to determine optimum drive ratios and maximum attainable speeds on

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each grade, as well as brake-holding ability and adequacy of angles of approach and departure. With the test vehicle in ascending and descending attitudes, functions such as lubrication, fuel flow, and fuel system performance are investigated. The effect of imbalance on turret-traversing efforts and functioning of turret drive systems may also be studied on the grades. The 5-, 10-, 15-, and 20-percent grades, about 4.3 m (14 ft) wide, are paved with asphalt; the 30-, 40-, 45-, 50-, and 60-percent slopes with concrete. The grade lengths are shown in Table 1.

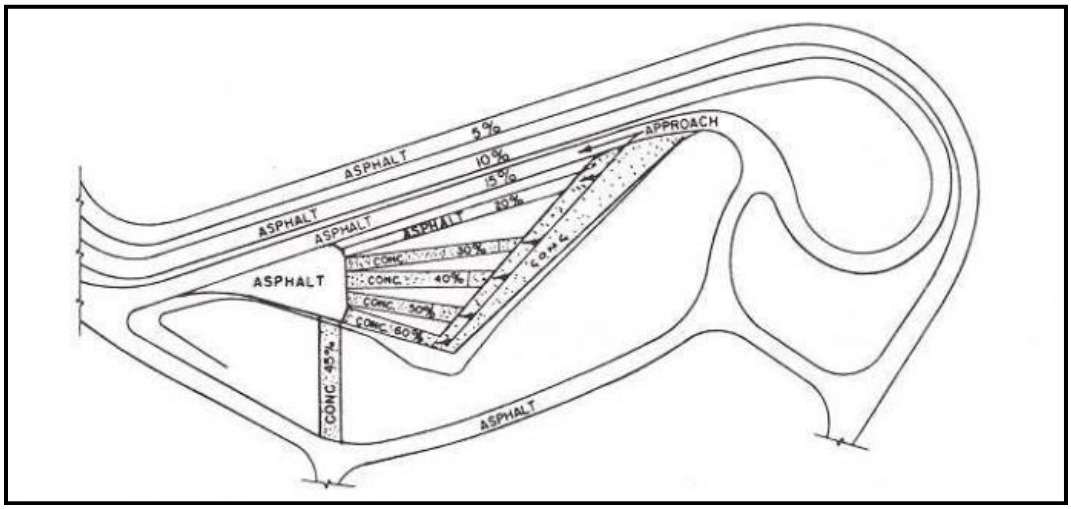


Figure 2.6-25. Plan view of Longitudinal Grades.



Figure 2.6-26. Vehicle ascending 60-percent longitudinal grade.

2.6.16 Simulated Loading Ramps.

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Tactical vehicles designed for transportation by either aircraft or ramp-equipped landing craft must be capable of entering and leaving the transporting vehicle by means of an inclined surface or ramp. Two concrete simulated loading ramps, one with a 20-degree incline, 12 m (38 ft) long (Figure 2.6-27) and the second, with a 15-degree incline, 6 m (20 ft) long (Figure 2.6-28), enable vehicles to be tested not only for adequacy of approach and departure angles, but also for adequate ground clearance and freedom from interference at the point of articulation between towing and towed vehicles (Figure 2.6-29).

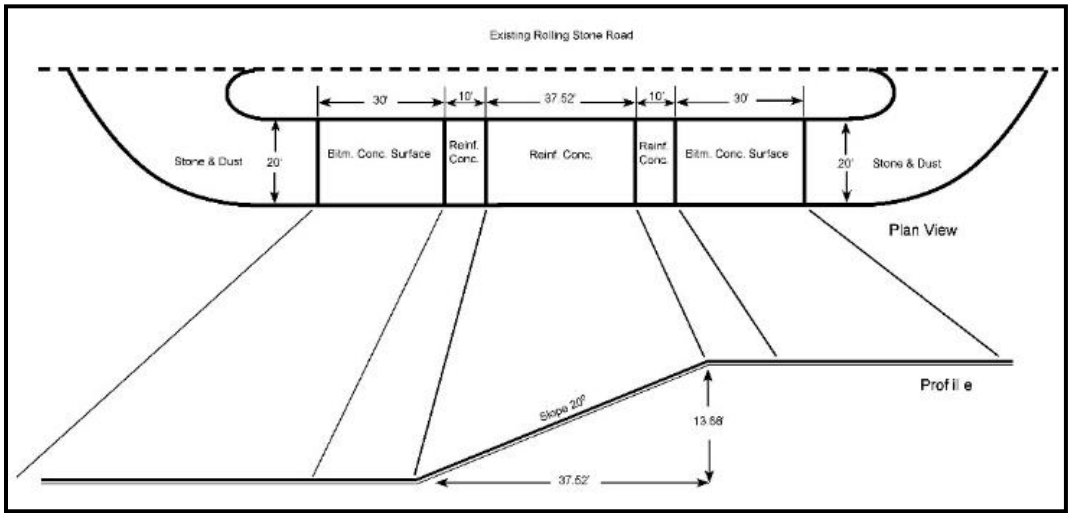


Figure 2.6-27. Plan view and section of 20-degree simulated loading ramp.



Figure 2.6-28. Vehicle on 15-degree simulated loading ramp.

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Figure 2.6-29. Vehicle on 20-degree simulated loading ramp.

2.6.17 2-Inch Washboard.

The test course (Figure 2.6-30) is comprised of regular undulations with a wavelength of 0.6 m (2.0 ft) and provides a regular series of periodic humps with a crest to trough height of 5.1 cm (2 in.) for testing wheeled vehicle suspensions (Figure 2.6-31). It can be used for one phase of endurance tests involving other courses in the area. Shocks imposed on the vehicle are influenced by design factors such as axle spacing and wheel size.

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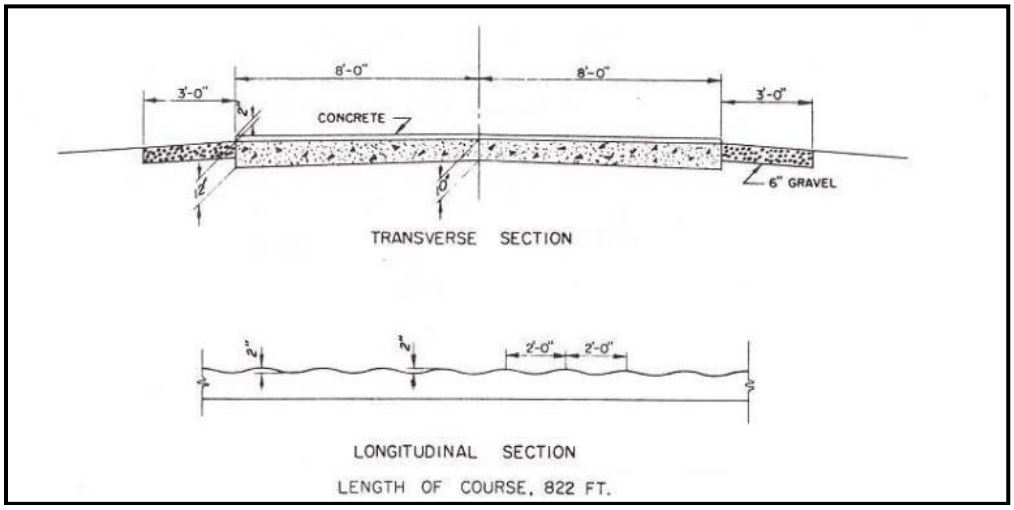


Figure 2.6-30. Sections of 2-Inch Washboard.



Figure 2.6-31. Testing wheeled vehicle suspension on 2-Inch Washboard Course.

2.6.18 2- to 4-Inch Radial Washboard.

This course is constructed using reverse curves in such a manner that the wheels of a test vehicle are subjected to impacts at varied frequencies for any given speed (Figure 2.6-32). The course is useful for evaluating wheel fight and tendencies toward front-wheel shimmy (Figure 2.6-33).

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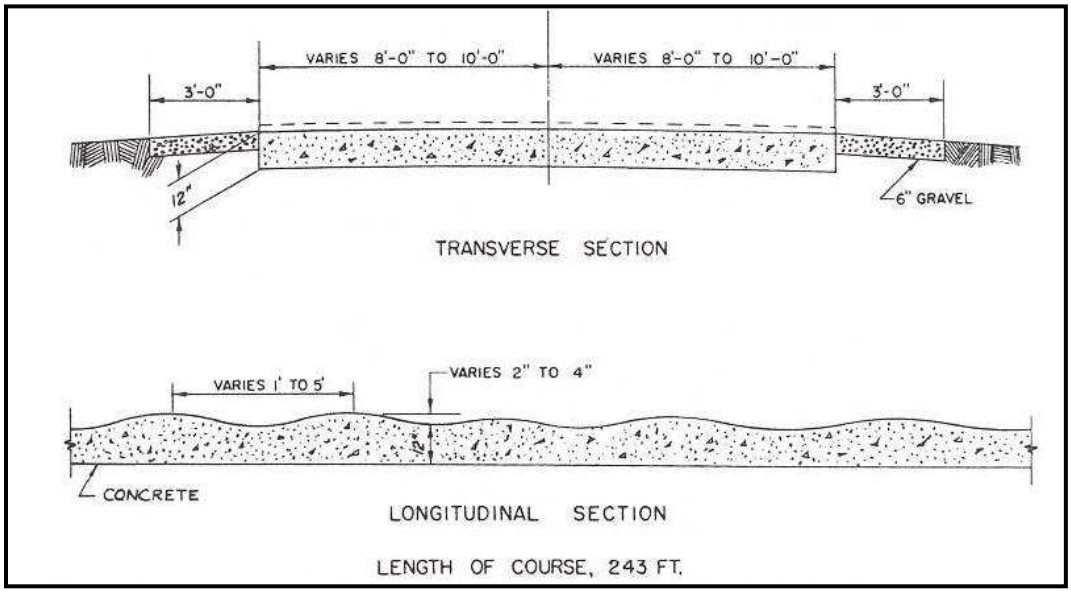


Figure 2.6-32. Sections of Radial Washboard.



Figure 2.6-33. Vehicle testing on the 2- to 4-Inch Radial Washboard Course.

2.6.19 3-Inch Spaced Bump.

This course gives a vehicle an irregular jolt by means of 7.6 cm (3 in.) rounded sections that cross the road surface at various angles (Figure 2.6-34). The spacing allows the suspension to settle down between jolts. This course is used mainly to impose shock and vibration stress on wheeled vehicle suspensions.

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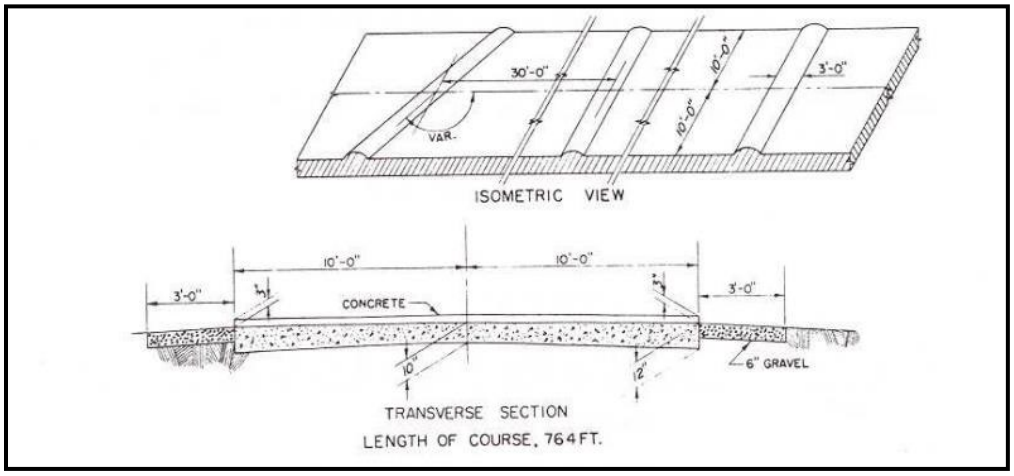


Figure 2.6-34. Isometric view and section of 3-Inch Spaced Bump.

2.6.20 6-Inch Washboard.

This course is the most severe of the regular washboard courses and is designed to evaluate vehicle pitching characteristics (Figure 2.6-35). The pitching is induced at various speeds. The relatively large radius of the wave configuration and the 1.8 m (6 ft) intervals ensure that the larger wheels and track pitches ordinarily do not bridge the depressions as shown in Figure 2.6-36.

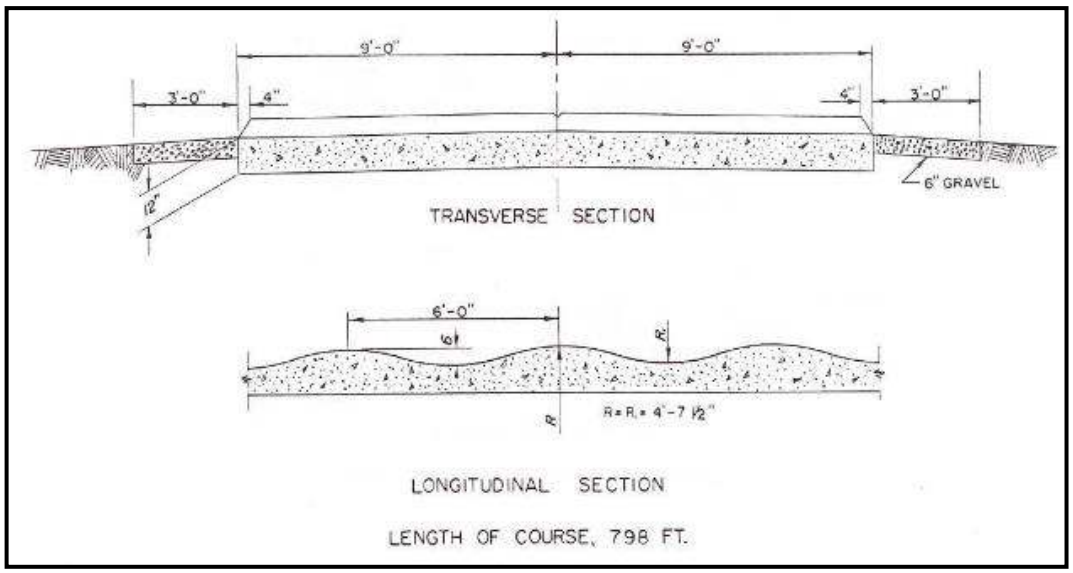


Figure 2.6-35. Sections of 6-Inch Washboard.

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Figure 2.6-36. Vehicle testing on the 6-Inch Washboard.

2.6.21 Wave Course.

Also known as the frame twister, this concrete course (Figures 2.6-37 and 2.6-38) is designed to deflect the opposite wheels of a vehicle in alternately contrary directions. Articulation of the suspension increases with tread width. The course provides a severe test of differentials and universal joints, as well as suspensions. Distortion of vehicle bodies is checked by operating doors, dump bodies, engine hoods, etc., after stopping the vehicle with the suspension at extremes of vertical travel.

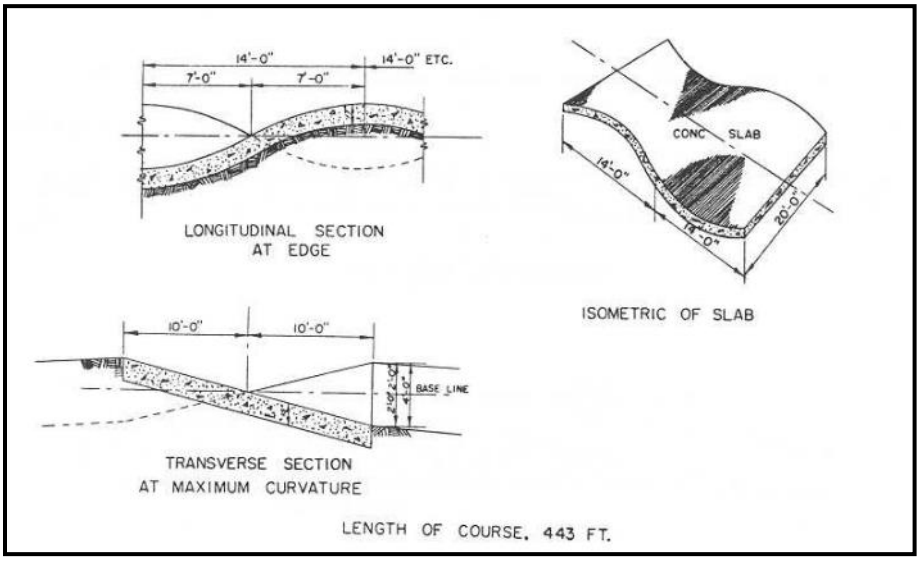


Figure 2.6-37. Sections of Wave Course.

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Figure 2.6-38. Vehicle negotiating the Wave Course.

2.6.22 Vertical Walls.

Wall-climbing ability is a characteristic that is measured for all tactical vehicles. Maximum capability may be limited by projections from the vehicle that extend beyond the wheels or tracks. The vertical wall (Figures 2.6-39 and 2.6-40) is equipped with replaceable timbers at the top so that the wall may be maintained in a standard condition following damage from tests.

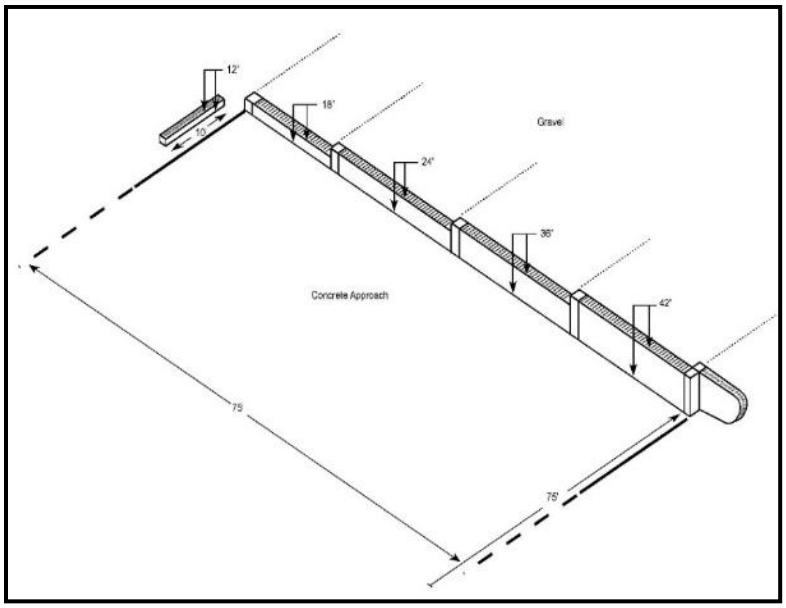


Figure 2.6-39. Isometric view of Vertical Walls.

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Figure 2.6-40. Vehicle ascending the 24-inch Vertical Wall.

2.6.23 Bridging Device.

The bridging requirement for various types of tracked vehicles is usually specified in the technical characteristics or design specifications. The steel bridging device provides an adjustable gap for measuring the maximum opening that the vehicle can cross unsupported (Figures 2.6-41 and 2.6-42). The maximum gap is 5.5 m (18 ft).

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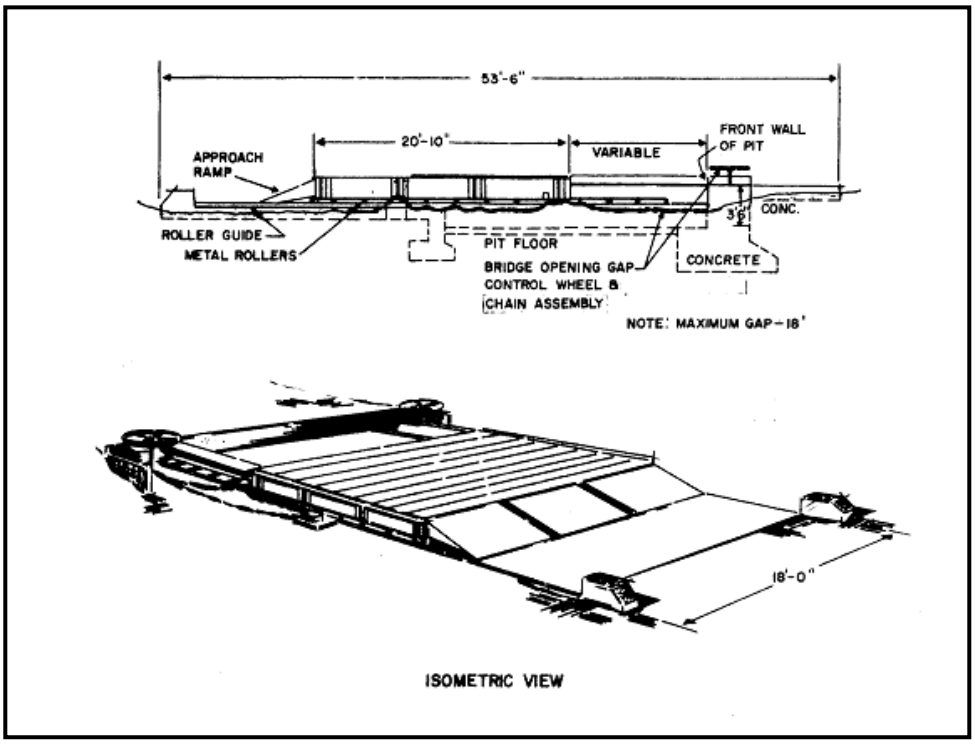


Figure 2.6-41. Plan and isometric view of the Bridging Device.



Figure 2.6-42. Vehicle negotiating the Bridging Device.

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2.6.24 Standard Ditch Profile.

The standard concrete ditch is used to check the adequacy of the angles of approach and departure of tactical vehicles (Figures 2.6-43 and 2.6-44). Tracklayers usually require rubber tracks for sufficient traction for pulling out of the ditch. The ditch has a 36.5-percent gradient for both ingress and egress.

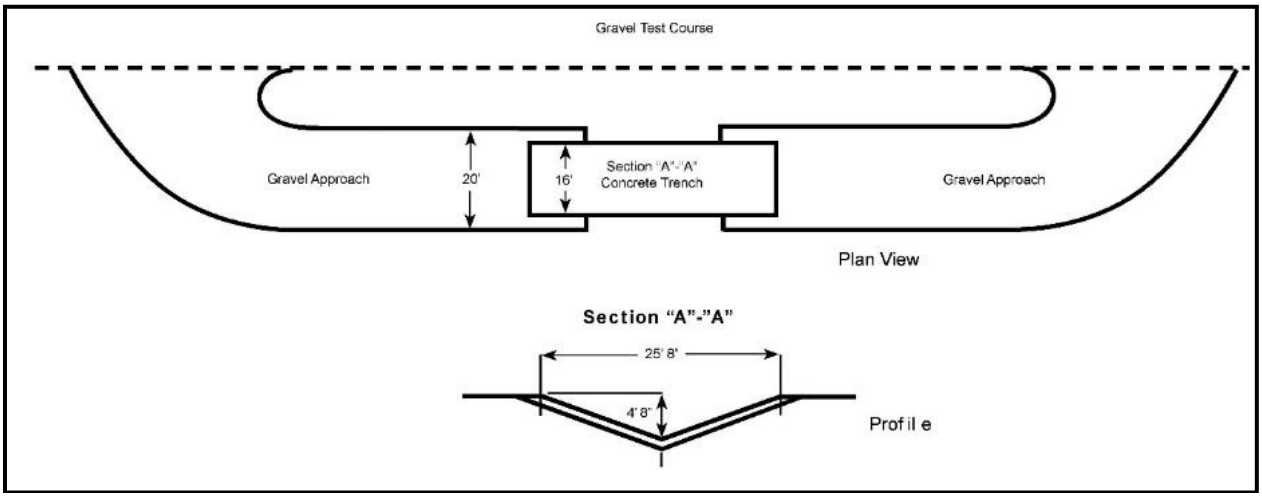


Figure 2.6-43. Plan and section view of standard ditch.



Figure 2.6-44. Vehicle negotiating the standard ditch.

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2.6.25 Turning Circle.

This course is used for measuring vehicle turning diameters on a hard surface. It is large enough, at a diameter of 76 m (250 ft), as shown in Figure 2.6-45, to permit figure-8 turns by the largest vehicles and for plotting limits of vision. It is also used for other activities like negotiating intersections that require a large and essentially flat concrete surface (Figure 2.6-46).

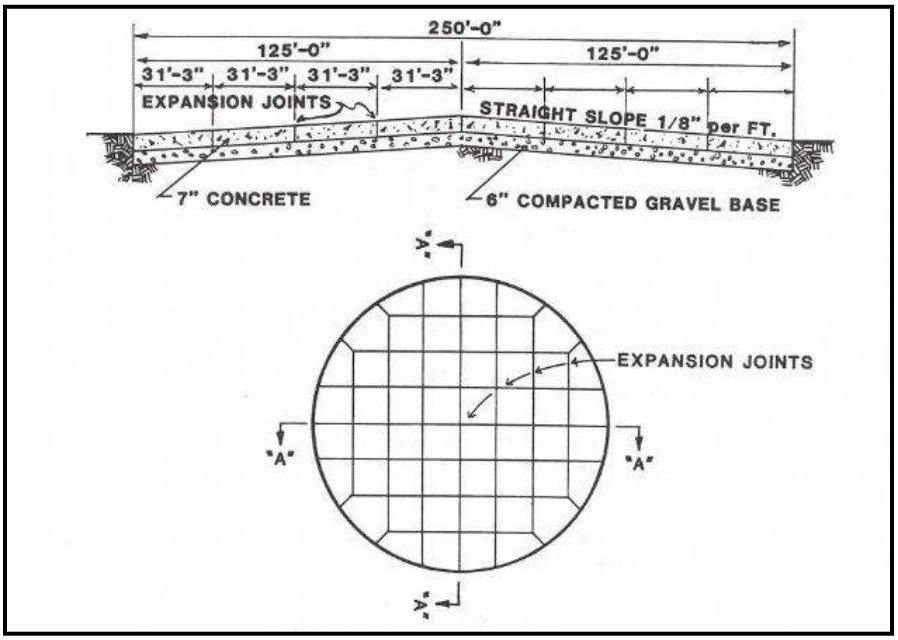


Figure 2.6-45. Section and plan view of Turning Circle.



Figure 2.6-46. Vehicle negotiating a 24-ft by 24-ft intersection on the MTA Turning Circle.

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2.6.26 Profile IV Course.

The Profile IV Course consists of a series of eleven different types of bumps (some of which are repeated) distributed over a 142 m (465 ft) long concrete course. The height (displacement) of each of the bumps was computed for each inch of longitudinal travel. The course layout is shown in Figure 2.6-47. An M1 Abrams tank traversing the MTA Profile IV Course is shown in Figure 2.6-48.

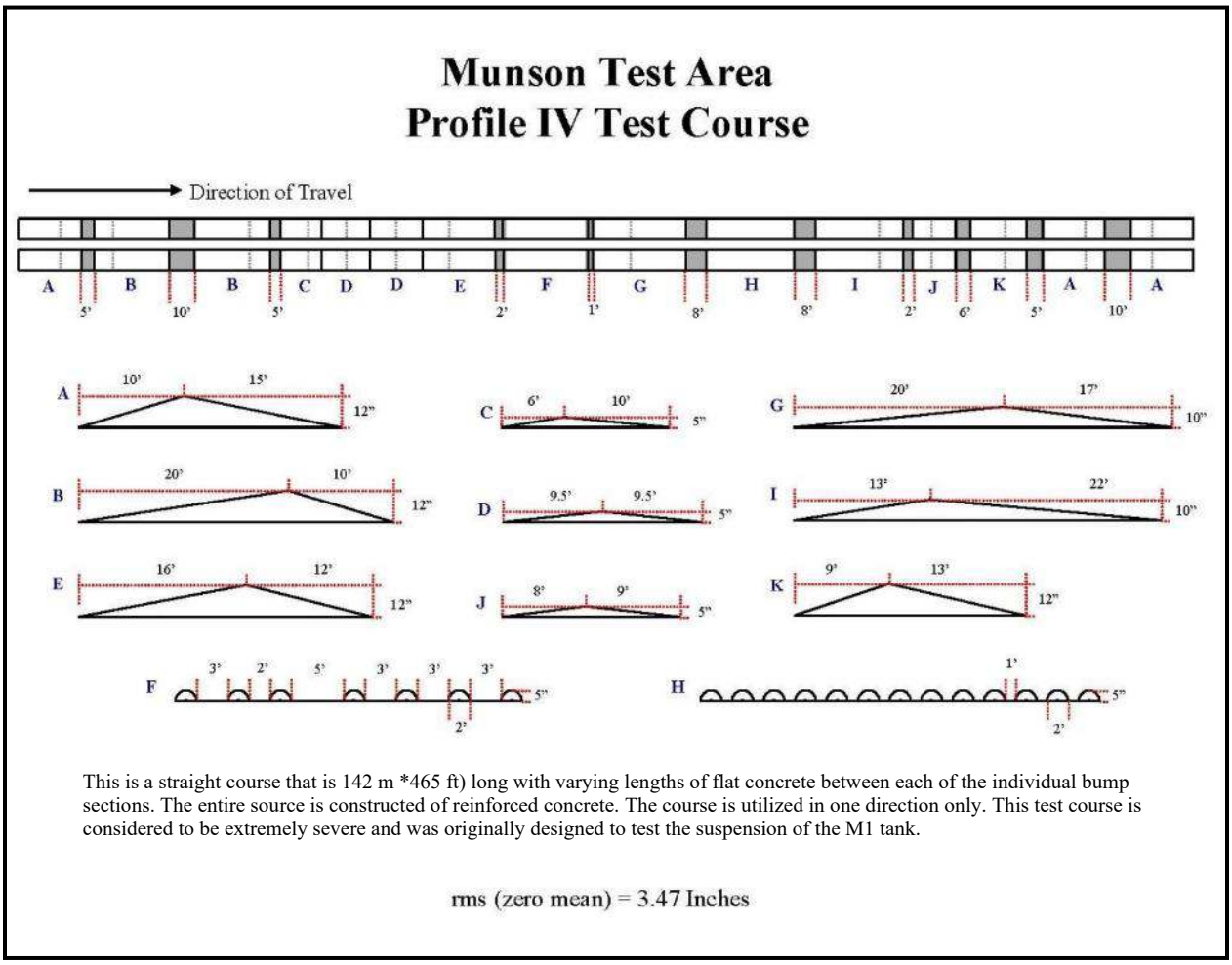


Figure 2.6-47. MTA Profile IV Test Course layout.

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Figure 2.6-48. M1 Abrams tank traversing the MTA Profile IV Test Course.

2.6.27 Marsh.

a. Between the Munson area and Dipple Creek (Figure 2.6-1 and 2.6-2) is a marsh with marginal soil strength that represents adverse conditions for mobility testing. The marsh has a heavy growth of vegetation, much of which is periodically flooded by tidal action. The area is ideally suited for single pass vehicle cone index tests and is a significant mobility challenge for conventional and marginal terrain vehicles. The soil type is classified as conforming to the USCS soil type MH (silt of high plasticity).

b. Around the edge of the marsh, a water filled simulated jungle trail has been cut into a woody area by vehicular traffic. It passes through heavy vegetation consisting of vines, swamp grass, and matted roots.

2.6.28 Load Vibration Course.

a. This comprises nearly 2.9 km (1.8 mi) of MTA courses (Figure 2.6-1) selected to subject electronic equipment and other sensitive loads in wheeled vehicles to various vehicle reactions. The course is arranged to accommodate the standard load vibration test developed in cooperation with the former Signal Corps Laboratories at Fort Monmouth, New Jersey as a means for determining the ability of electronic units to withstand shock and vibration in specified vehicles. The course layout of the Standard Load Vibration test is outlined in Figure 2.6-49.

b. The course is also used for evaluating the portability of other special military loads, including those of the Navy and Air Force.

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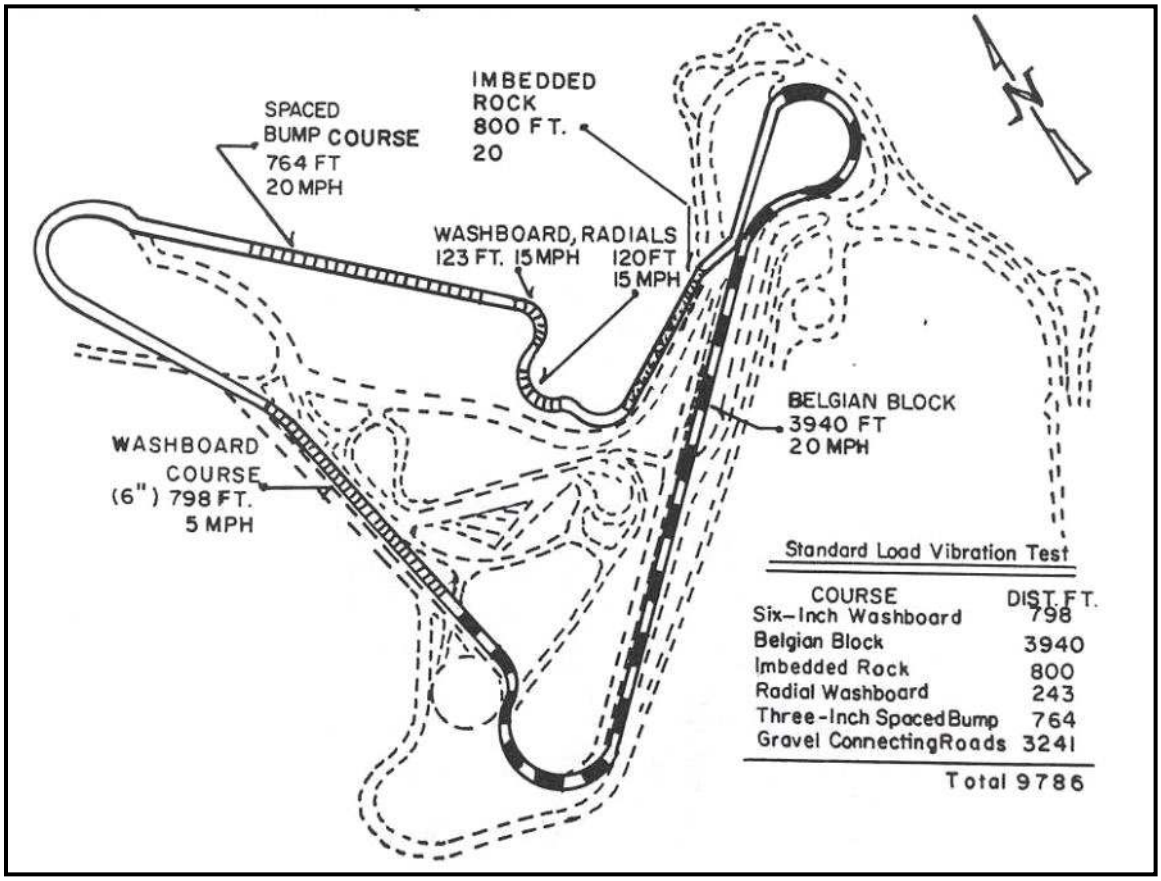


Figure 2.6-49. Load Vibration Course.

2.6.29 Fuel Consumption Course.

This course is a loop of gravel and paved road surfaces with longitudinal grades totaling 2.4 km (1.5 mi). The course is used for a specific standard test (TOP 02-2-603B[8]), in which the vehicle is operated around the loop a specific number of times in both clockwise and counterclockwise directions (Figure 2.6-50). Fuel consumption data are recorded and used for evaluating vehicle design, vehicle comparison, and determining the fuel consumption rate that might be expected under field conditions. The course layout of the Fuel Consumption Course is described in Table 3.

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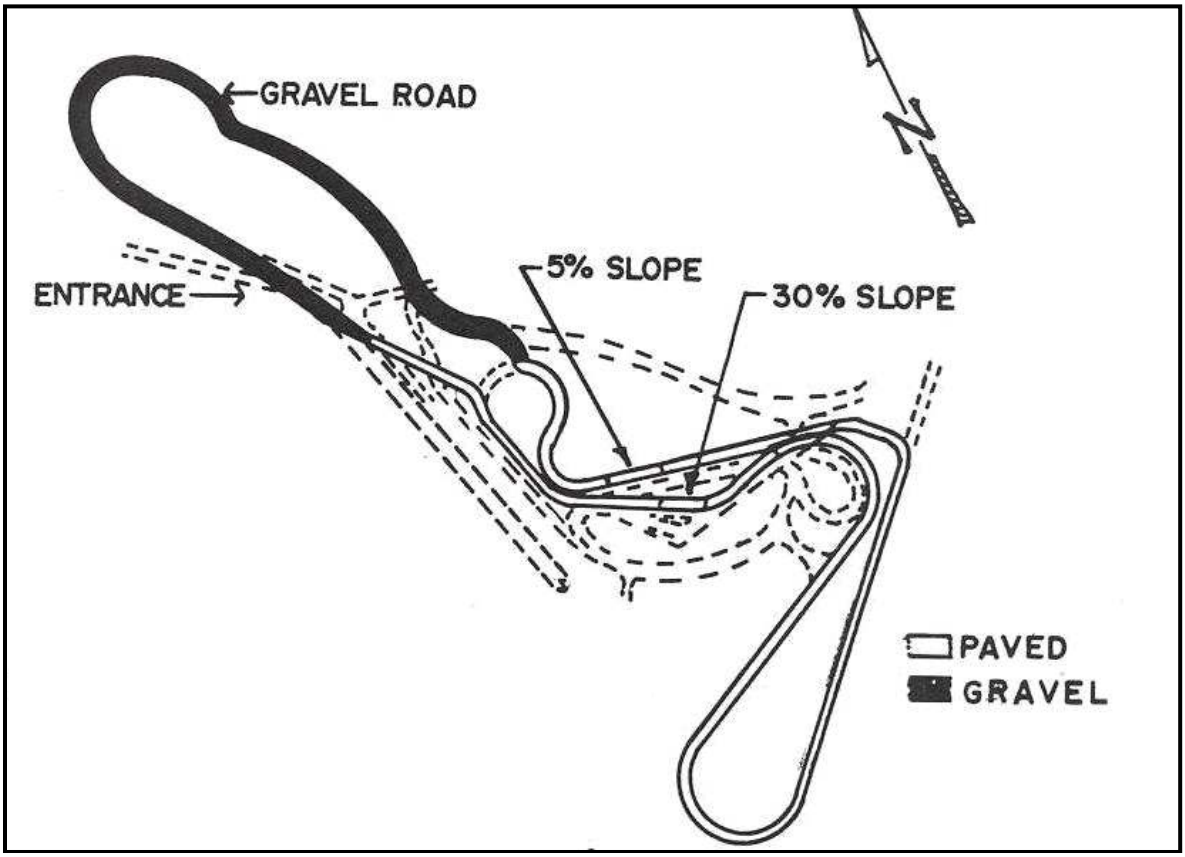


Figure 2.6-50. Fuel Consumption Course.

TABLE 3. FUEL CONSUMPTION COURSE

SURFACE	GRADE, %	OPERATING DISTANCE[a]			
		CLOCKWISE		COUNTERCLOCKWISE	
		METERS	FEET	METERS	FEET
Gravel	Less than 1	828	2718	828	2718
Bituminous concrete	Less than 1	1198	3930	1198	3930
	1 to 5	142 up	467 up	142 down	467 down
	5	147 down	483 down	147 up	483 up
	15	78 down	256 down	78 up	256 up
Concrete	30	45 up	149 up	45 down	149 down
Total		2439	8003	2439	8003

Note a: Included are short lengths of approach roads in addition to the centerline dimensions of individual test course.

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2.6.30 Urban Terrain Course.

This course is a loop of graded gravel- and concrete-paved roads totaling 5.6 km (3.5 mi) (Figure 2.6-51). The concrete-paved road is 3.5 km (2.2 mi) or 65 percent of the total profile. The test vehicle is operated in clockwise and counterclockwise directions, with stop and go, maneuverability, and obstacle negotiation challenges. The layout of the Urban Terrain Course is described in Table 4.

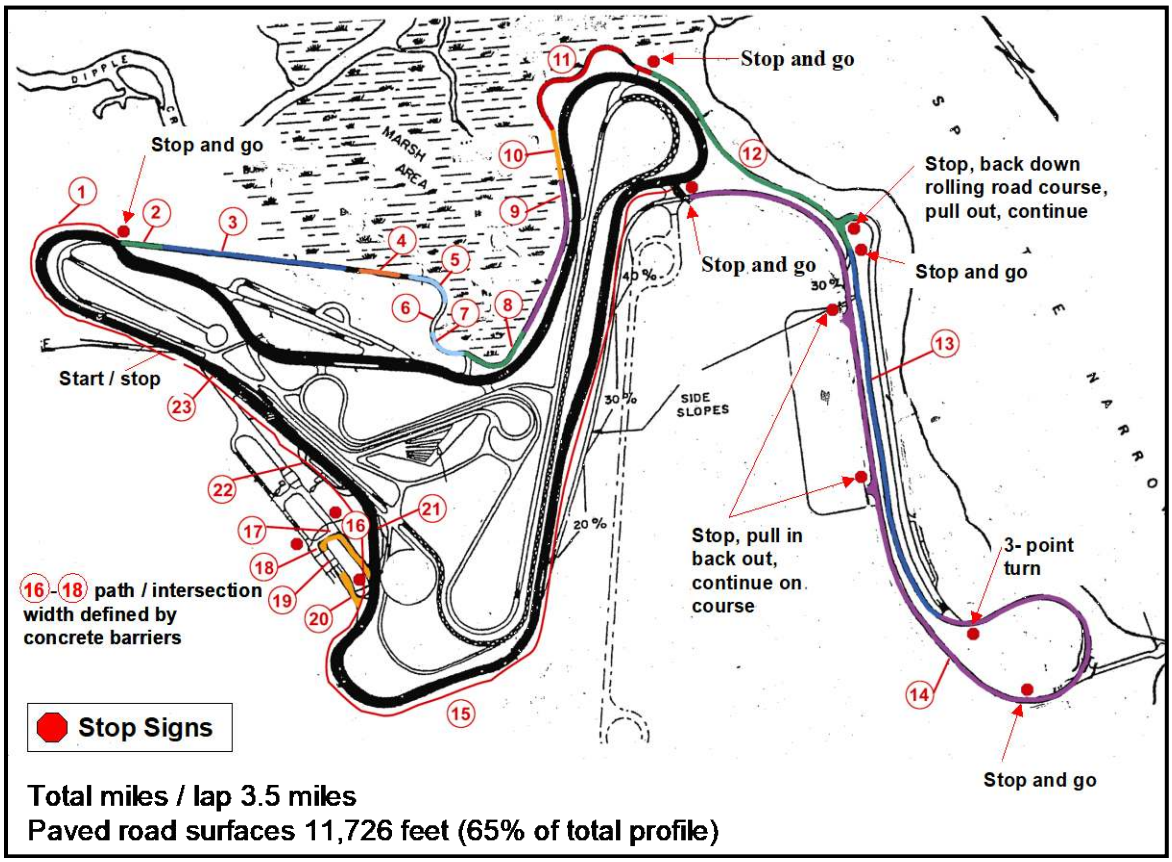


Figure 2.6-51. Urban Terrain Course.

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TABLE 4. URBAN TERRAIN COURSE

COURSE SEGMENT	CONSTRUCTION	ATTRIBUTE/VEHICLE CHALLENGE	LENGTH		TOTAL	
			meters	feet	meters	feet
1	Compacted gravel	Acceleration, steering, braking	322	1056	322	1056
2	Bituminous concrete	Corduroy road surface (approach to spaced bumps)	***110***	***360***	432	1416
3	Concrete 3-inch spaced bump	Vibration, suspension exercise	***229***	***750***	660	2166
4	Rough concrete	Mild vibration	***73***	***240***	733	2406
5	Concrete radial washboard	Vibration, steering and suspension exercise	***37***	***120***	770	2526
6	Smooth concrete	Allows suspension to settle	***35***	***115***	805	2641
7	Concrete radial washboard	Vibration, steering and suspension exercise	***37***	***120***	842	2761
8	Concrete serpentine path	Steering	***148***	***485***	989	3246
9	Imbedded rock	Tire performance, steering, vibration	***244***	***800***	1233	4046
10	Brushed smooth concrete	Allows suspension to settle	***30***	***100***	1264	4146
11	Concrete 2-inch washboard	Suspension, steering, vibration	***251***	***822***	1514	4968
12	Bituminous concrete	Moderate speed, sweeping turns, slight grade	***402***	***1320***	1917	6288
13	Rough concrete sideslope 30%	Stability, steering performance, lateral loading of suspension, tires, etc	***515***	***1690***	2431	7978
14	Bituminous concrete loop (poorly maintained primary road)	Moderate speed, steering, acceleration, braking	***1400***	***4594***	3832	12,572
15	Compacted gravel	Moderate speed, steering, acceleration, braking	1013	3325	4845	15,897
16	Loose gravel	Maneuverability (low speed w/90° steer required)	79	260	4925	16,157
17	Deteriorated concrete/gravel	Maneuverability (low speed w/90° steer required)	***24***	***80***	4949	16,237
18	Rough concrete	Maneuverability (low speed w/90° steer required)	***40***	***130***	4989	16,367
19	18-inch vertical step	Obstacle negotiation/maneuverability, tire performance	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
20	Loose gravel (return to Munson gravel)	Hard steer (>135°) to return to Munson gravel	102	335	5090	16,702
21	Compacted gravel	Acceleration, steering	108	355	5199	17,057
22	Gravel and concrete (V-ditch)	Obstacle negotiation/maneuverability, tire performance, power	83	270	5281	17,327
23	Compacted gravel to starting point	Acceleration, braking	198	650	5479	17,977

Note: Bold italic font denotes concrete road surfaces totaling 3,574 m (11,726 ft) (65% of total profile) in length.

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2.6.31 Staircase Obstacle.

Obstacle of stairs with mount and dismount aprons, wide enough for vehicle traffic. Stair risers are 15 cm (6 in.) high and stair treads are 38 cm (15 in.) wide as shown in Figure 2.6-52. A vehicle negotiating the Staircase Obstacle is shown in Figure 2.6-53.

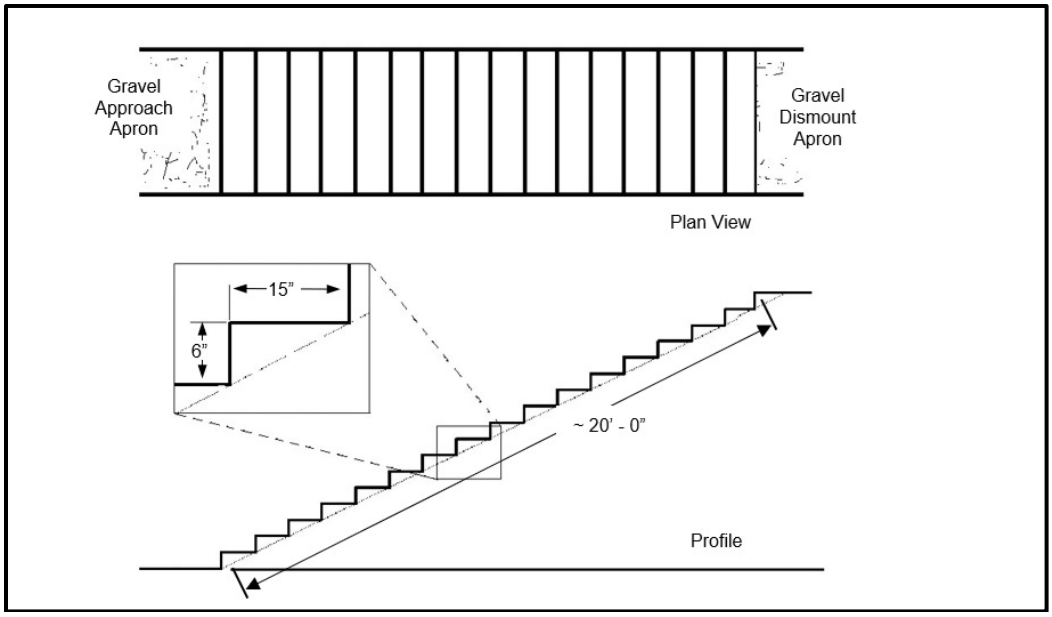


Figure 2.6-52. Staircase Obstacle.



Figure 2.6-53. Vehicle negotiating the Staircase Obstacle.

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2.7 Land Vehicle Maintenance Facility.

a. This facility (Figure 2.7-1) is comprised of 4,180 square meters (45,000 square feet) of interior bay space that includes 13 maintenance bays, an electric/battery shop, an engine test cell, and a closed-loop steam cleaning facility.

b. The shop facility provides maintenance/diagnostic analysis to direct support/general support level for prototype, standard/production, and foreign systems and rebuild capability for electrical components/systems, hull/chassis assemblies, and power train components.



Figure 2.7-1. Land Vehicle Maintenance Facility.

2.8 Automotive Technology Evaluation Facility (ATEF).

ATEF (Figure 2.8-1) was engineered as a concentric multi-surface, paved and gravel high-speed test track. The flat, 7.2 km (4.5 mi) long and 61 m (200 ft) wide tri-oval includes generous safety run-off areas and wireless monitoring of every test vehicle for real-time data capture. The military specific roadbed will support vehicle weights in excess of 109 tons metric (120 tons). ATEF enables the Department of Defense (DOD) to effectively, efficiently, and safely conduct high-performance, endurance, and reliability testing on all wheeled and tracked vehicles, of both manned and un-manned ground platforms.

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Figure 2.8-1. Automotive Technology Evaluation Facility.

2.8.1 High Speed Paved.

This is a 7.2 km (4.5 mi) long and 8 m (27 ft) wide high-speed loop. There are two lanes to allow multiple vehicles to operate at different speeds. There is a 427 m (1400 ft) long by 37 m (120 ft) wide section of High Speed Paved which is utilized for vehicle performance testing (e.g., brake testing, lane change, etc).

2.8.2 High Speed Gravel.

This is a 7.2 km (4.5 mi) long 9 m (30 ft) wide high-speed loop composed of bank run gravel. There is a 427 m (1400 ft) long by 12 m (40 ft) wide area parallel to the High-Speed Paved brake test evaluation area.

2.8.3 Vehicle Dynamics Area (VDA).

This is a 122 m (400 ft) by 244 m (800 ft) pad with acceleration ramps from ATEF High Speed Paved designed for vehicle performance testing (e.g., skid pad, J-turn, etc.).

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2.9 Perryman Test Area (PTA).

a. The PTA adjoins the northwestern boundary of APG and includes about 800 hectares (2000 acres) (Figure 2.9-1). Originally devoted to farming, the area is now used mainly for cross-country testing of vehicles for endurance, durability and reliability. Facilities for other tests are also in the area. A detailed mapping of the various courses located at the PTA is shown in Figure 2.9-2.



Figure 2.9-1. Aerial view of Perryman Test Area.

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Figure 2.9-2. Detailed map of test courses located at PTA.

b. Although surface variations due to weather are a desirable feature of most PTA courses, course geometry is assessed periodically by a test course profilometer that provides appropriate data to maintain the courses to the same severity. Details of the procedure are provided in TOP 01-1-010A. Test course area supervisors also make daily inspections and maintain an on-site log of climatic and course conditions.

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2.9.1 Perryman Off-Road Courses.

Five off-road courses graduated in severity are within the PTA.

a. Perryman No. 1 is moderate with a substantial roadbed composed primarily of quarry spall and bank gravel (Figure 2.9-3). The loop includes sharp and sweeping curves, and the surface ranges from smooth to rough (roughness being due to potholes, washboard, and rutting). Potholes and other sharp depressions are usually limited to a depth of 15 cm (6 in.) by filling with crushed stone. During wet weather, the whole course is characterized by light mud which affects wheeled vehicles mainly by splash. The course is 8.4 km (5.2 mi) long. The average root mean square (rms) roughness is 0.89 cm (0.35 in.).



Figure 2.9-3. Perryman No. 1 roadbed characteristics.

b. Perryman No. 2 is laid out in a loop of moderately irregular terrain. The native soil includes Sassafras loam, a silty loam with 17.3-percent clay content, and Sassafras silt loam, a silty loam with less than 15-percent clay. Surfaces range from smooth to rough, and there are sweeping turns. Under wet conditions, the course is extremely muddy (Figure 2.9-4); when dry, it is dusty (Figure 2.9-5). One area of the course used for testing earthmoving equipment includes earthen side slopes, a cut-and-fill area, and a figure-8 course. The course is 2.9 km (1.8 mi) long. The average rms roughness is 2.3 cm (0.9 in.).

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Figure 2.9-4. Perryman No. 2 under muddy conditions.



Figure 2.9-5. Perryman No. 2 under dusty conditions.

c. Perryman No. 3 is rougher still and is composed of native soil similar to that of Perryman No. 2. Mud ranges from light (with free water) to cohesive. Although dust is severe when the course is dry, there is always mud in some areas (Figure 2.9-6). Much of the course is rough due to many years of testing tank-type vehicles. The course is 5.3 km (3.3 mi) long. The average rms roughness is 7.4 cm (2.9 in.).

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Figure 2.9-6. Vehicle negotiating Perryman No. 3.

d. Perryman No. 4 is a tract of extremely rough terrain including marshy areas with swamp-type vegetation (Figure 2.9-7). The drier areas are characterized by a succession of depressions that develop after intensive operation of heavy tracked vehicles. The difference in the slopes is attributed to the fact that vehicles have generally been run in one direction. The soil of the course is native soil as described under Perryman No. 2. The course is 4 km (2.5 mi) long.



Figure 2.9-7. Vehicle negotiating Perryman No. 4.

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e. Perryman No. 5 is constructed of Gabion (No. 6 stone) and is approximately 305 m (1000 ft) long (Figure 2.9-8). This course is designed to be extremely severe; the average rms roughness is 9.7 cm (3.8 in.).



Figure 2.9-8. View of Perryman No. 5 Course.

2.9.2 3-Mile Straight-Away.

This is a 6.1-km (3.8-mi) level straight-away with banked turnaround loops at each end for tests requiring uninterrupted operation such as cooling tests. This course is made of bituminous concrete (including turnarounds). A 305 m long by 15 m wide (1000 ft by 50 ft) section of bituminous concrete is located midway between the turnarounds and is suited for conducting brake testing, and evasive handling maneuvers. A portion of the travel lane is treated with a sealer that when wet down provides a low coefficient of friction road surface used for testing traction control and anti-lock brake features.

2.9.3 Mud Bypass Course.

This is a 610 m (2000 ft) bypass off of Perryman No. 1. It is most useful in periods of dry weather for exposing vehicles to muddy conditions to evaluate seals, brakes, or other mud-sensitive components during endurance operations. The course is prepared by tilling and pumping water onto it from a local renewable water source using irrigation piping and sprinklers (Figure 2.9-9).

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Figure 2.9-9. Mud Bypass Course with sprinklers operating.

2.9.4 Secondary Road A.

Secondary Road A is a closed loop course 3.9 km (2.4 mi) in length with long, sharp, sweeping turns typical of unimproved country roads. The course surface is about 10.7 m (35 ft) wide, maintained by grading and filling with native soil. The average rms roughness is 0.84 cm (0.33 in.).

2.9.5 PTA Ride Quality.

a. PTA ride quality course is a 5.1 km (3.2 mi) long, level straight course. The four ride quality sections were constructed on the former PTA Secondary Road B. The four sections are straight and do not abut each other. Space between courses is provided for vehicles to achieve desired test speeds. The four ride quality sections vary in different levels of roughness. All four sections are composed of compacted gravel with the wear surface held together by a binding agent. The four sections from least rough to most rough are labeled as B, C, A, and D. Section B is 610 m (2000 ft) long. Section C is 366 m (1200 ft) long. Section A is 351 m (1150 ft) long. Section D is 290 m (950 ft) long.

b. Half Rounds. These obstacles are reinforced steel pipes cut in half longitudinally of 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, and 41 cm (4, 6, 8, 10, 12, and 16 in.) radii affixed to a steel and concrete base. They are used to address the shock portion of ride quality testing. There are currently two locations of Half Rounds at PTA, both residing in the wide section of the 3-Mile Straight-Away.

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One set is located on the south side of the wide section (Figure 2.9-10) and another located towards the center of the wide section. A photograph of a vehicle traversing the Half Rounds is shown in Figure 2.9-11.



Figure 2.9-10. Half Rounds located at south side of wide section of 3 Mile Straight-Away.



Figure 2.9-11. Track vehicle traversing the Half Rounds.

2.9.6 Figure 8 Test Course.

PTA Figure 8 test course is a 772 m (2534 ft) figure "8" course composed of native soil and gravel. The course is primarily used for unmanned ground vehicles.

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2.9.7 PTA Dig Sites.

PTA has four dig site areas. The dig sites have permanent sediment and erosion controls. Dig sites are used for simulated vehicle recovery, excavation testing activities, etc. If unused, the areas tend to grass over and are periodically reopened using an offset disc. After each test program the disturbed area is leveled until the next use. Dig site 1 has large trapezoidal shape and is 482 m (1580 ft) in length while the width changes from 73 m (240 ft) to 24 m (80 ft) at its narrowest point. The soil is classified as SC-SM by the USCS. Dig site 2 is a long relatively narrow area having a width of 27 to 37 m (90 to 120 ft) and a length of 640 m (2100 ft). The soil is classified as SM by USCS. Dig site 3 is an area that is 165 m (540 ft) long and 84 m (275 ft) wide. The soil is classified as CL by USCS. Dig site 4 has a length of 366 m (1200 ft) and a width of 30 m (100 ft) and is classified as CL-ML by USCS.

2.10 Phillips Army Airfield (PAAF).

a. The airfield (Figure 2.10-1) utilizes a hard surface runway that measures 2,438 by 61 m (8,000 by 200 ft). Automotive testing performed on this runway includes sine-with-dwell and J-turn steering maneuvers required to assess a vehicle's electronic stability control system.



Figure 2.10-1. Phillips Army Airfield.

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2.11 Lift and Tie-Down Facility.

This facility is used to test the lifting and tie-down capability of military vehicles in accordance with MIL-STD-913A[9] and MIL-STD-209K[10]. The facility has a 50-ton metric (55-ton) overhead chain hoist with a remotely controlled 54-ton metric (60-ton) hydraulic load application system (Figure 2.11-1). In addition, it has two hydraulically operated bridge cranes of 45- and 136-ton metric (50- and 150-ton) capacities.



Figure 2.11-1. Lift and Tie-Down Facility.

2.12 Automotive Laboratory Facilities.

2.12.1 Automotive Engineering Test Facility (B436).

a. This facility (Figure 2.12-1) supports engineering tests addressing performance and reliability, availability and maintainability (RAM) analysis for the areas of Automotive, Fire Control and Live-Fire/Vulnerability, Road Shock and Vibration, Transportability, and Environmental Conditions.

b. Provided are the resources to design, plan, and conduct testing, and for the acquisition, processing, analysis, and reporting of test data. It includes nearly $50 million of state-of-the-art

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instrumentation, over 2,800 square meters (30,000 square feet) of laboratory and shop space, on-site instrumentation and hardware fabrication facilities.



Figure 2.12-1. Automotive Engineering Test Facility

c. Also provided are specialized off-site data transfer capabilities that include fiber optic and bi-directional microwave telemetry links that provide high speed data transfer and real-time test control, and secure, single source data access from any location in the world via the internet.

2.12.2 Tilt Table Facility.

The tilt table facility is located adjacent to the Automotive Engineering Test Facility. This steel table is used to determine the static rollover threshold, and in turn, the propensity of a test vehicle to roll over when operating on a side slope or during steady-state cornering. Six hydraulic cylinders are employed to raise and lower the table. The table platform is accessible from each end and at its center (Figure 2.12-2). The tilt table is 4.3 m (14 ft) wide at each end with a center width area of 7.6 m (25 ft) for additional maneuverability for rough terrain forklift testing. The overall table length is 30.5 m (100 ft), with a lift capacity of 127 tons metric per 6.1 m (140 tons per 20 ft) of length, for a total theoretical capacity of 635 tons metric (700 tons). The table's maximum tilt angle is 40 degrees (83.9 percent). Tilt table testing is performed in accordance with SAE J2180[11]. The test vehicle is typically tilted about its roll axis until the uphill tires lift off the platform, at which point safety cables restrain the vehicle from an actual rollover (Figure 2.12-3).

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Figure 2.12-2. Tilt Table Facility.



Figure 2.12-3. Tilt table testing at vehicle rollover threshold.

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2.12.3 Roadway Simulator Complex.

a. Roadway Simulator. This facility provides a dynamic hardware-in-the-loop simulation for conducting engineering level automotive performance tests under strictly defined and controlled conditions. It supports vehicles ranging from 2,270 kg (5,000 lb) 2-axle light trucks to 36,300 kg (80,000 lb) tractor trailers (Figure 2.12-4). It was designed to perform vehicle dynamics, power train performance, and shock and vibration testing in a laboratory environment. The test vehicle is adaptively constrained in the longitudinal, lateral, and yaw directions through its center of gravity, and is free to move in the vertical, roll and pitch directions. A robotic autopilot drives the truck on a series of treadmills, while vehicle body forces are measured in the constrained degrees of freedom. The motion of the treadmills is coordinated to provide a coherent roadway over various terrain profiles.

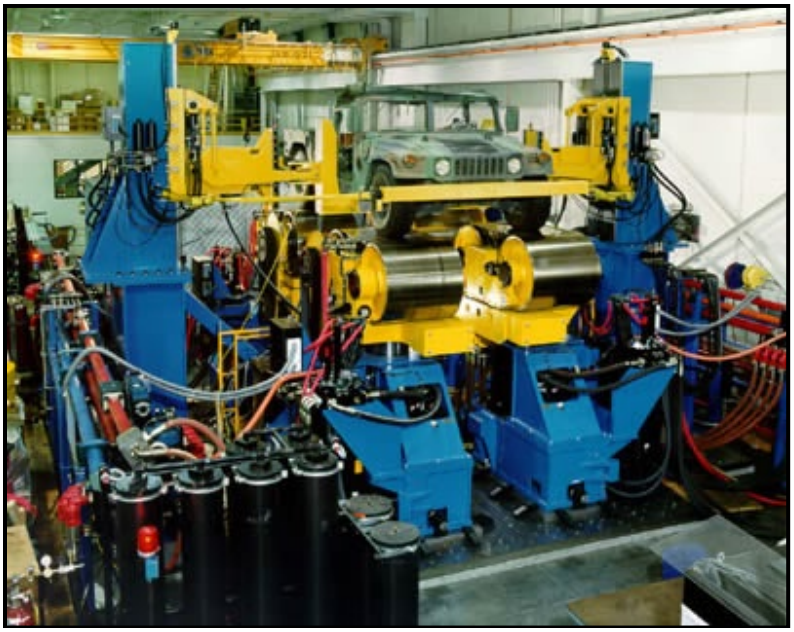


Figure 2.12-4. Roadway Simulator.

b. Vehicle Durability Simulator (VDS).

(1) The VDS is a spindle-coupled MTS 329LT test rig*** (Figure 2.12-5), consisting of four 6-degrees-of-freedom wheel ends. The facility provides laboratory-based simulation for off- and on-road shock and vibration testing. Structural components and subsystems on 2-axle trucks up to 11,800 kg (26,000 lb) can be tested 24 hr per day with precise control of the test scenario. Drive files are produced to replicate field data using the remote parameter control (RPC) process, using feedback from wheel force transducers and other sensors. The simulator can also be used as a kinematics and compliance measurement system to support vehicle modeling initiatives.

***The use of brand names does not constitute endorsement by the Army or any other agency of the Federal Government, nor does it imply that it is best suited for its intended application.

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Figure 2.12-5. Vehicle Durability Simulator.

(2) The strengths of the VDS are:

(a) Accelerated reliability testing for lighter vehicle chassis, suspension, and connected components (shocks, springs, ball joints, bushings, fasteners, panels, wiring, and plumbing).

(b) Troubleshooting and diagnosing component fatigue failures.

(c) Vehicle and component model development.

c. Heavy Vehicle Durability Simulator (HVDS).

(1) The HVDS is a spindle-coupled MTS 329HT test rig*** (Figure 2.12-6), consisting of ten 5-degrees-of-freedom wheel ends. As with the VDS, the facility provides laboratory-based simulation for off- and on-road shock and vibration testing of structural components and subsystems. The system can be used for 2-axle, 3-axle, 4-axle, and 5-axle trucks as well as multi-axle trailers. The system can run two tests independently, meaning a 2-axle truck could be tested while the other six wheel ends are testing another truck or trailer. The individual axles are rated up to 11,000 kg (24,000 lb) while the total system can support 5 axle trucks up to 45,000 kg (100,000 lb). Drive files are produced to replicate field data using the RPC process using feedback from wheel force transducers and other sensors. Drive files can be arranged in an arbitrary order for testing 24 hr per day.

***The use of brand names does not constitute endorsement by the Army or any other agency of the Federal Government, nor does it imply that it is best suited for its intended application.

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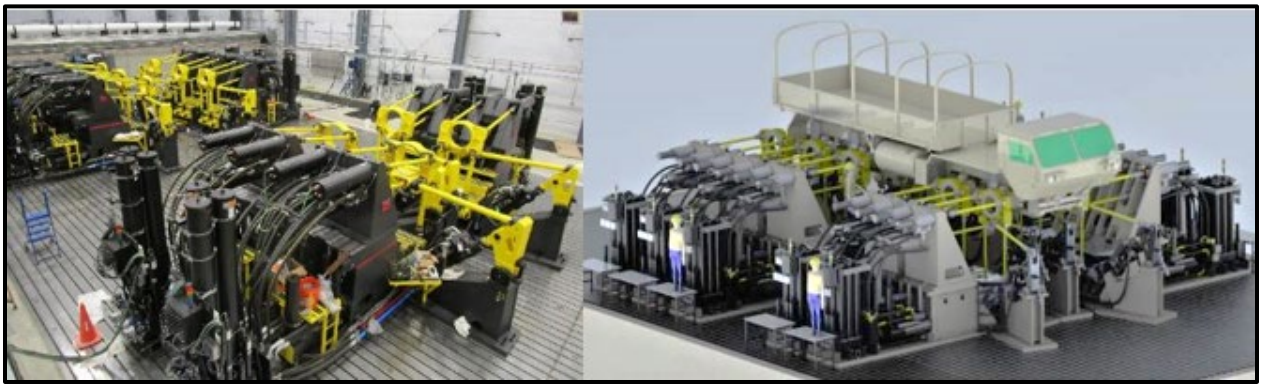


Figure 2.12-6. Heavy Vehicle Durability Simulator.

(2) The strengths of the HVDS are:

(a) Accelerated reliability testing for trailers and heavy vehicle chassis, suspension, and connected components (shocks, springs, ball joints, bushings, fasteners, panels, wiring, and plumbing).

(b) Troubleshooting and diagnosing component fatigue failures.

(c) Vehicle and component model development.

d. Drivetrain Durability Simulator (DDS).

(1) The DDS is a spindle-coupled AVL test rig*** (Figure 2.12-7), consisting of eight spinning dynos. The facility provides laboratory-based simulation for testing of heavy vehicle powertrains and drivetrain components. The system can be used for 2-axle, 3-axle and 4-axle trucks weighing up to 36,000 kg (80,000 lb). The system can either be used for endurance testing, just as with the VDS and HVDS, or the performance tests. For endurance tests, drive files commanding throttle, speed and/or torque are produced to replicate field data using the RPC process using feedback from wheel force transducers and other sensors. For performance tests the system uses test sequences of throttle and speed or simulated grade to apply powertrain loading.

***The use of brand names does not constitute endorsement by the Army or any other agency of the Federal Government, nor does it imply that it is best suited for its intended application.

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Figure 2.12-7. Drivetrain Durability Simulator.

(2) The strengths of the DDS are:

(a) Accelerated reliability testing for heavy vehicle powertrains, subsystems and components: engine, shafts, differentials, half-shafts, wheel ends, U-joints, CV shafts, bearings.

(b) Troubleshooting and diagnosing component fatigue failures.

(c) Vehicle and component model development.

(d) Performance tests such as fuel consumption tests, shift mapping, engine mapping and acceleration tests.

e. Tire Test Rig. This facility (Figure 2.12-8) is used for measuring tire performance parameters at various axle loads, slip conditions, tire pressures, and speeds. The rig consists of an MTS Systems Flat-Trac rolling ground plane positioned beneath a structural beam and spindle. The tire is mounted to the spindle with an MTS Systems SWIFT wheel force transducer that measures the three forces and three moments applied to the tire. The tire can be cambered up to 8 degrees, and vertical loads can exceed 6,800 kg (15,000 lb), depending on the camber condition. Ground speeds can reach 260 km/hr (160 mph) and slip angle can exceed 15 degrees. Typical tests include lateral force measurement (versus vertical load and slip), vertical stiffness (static and dynamic), and tire durability assessments. Advantages of the ATC tire test rig include the ability to test at high axle weights and large tire diameters frequently encountered with military vehicles. High slip rates are also achievable.

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Figure 2.12-8. Tire Test Rig.

f. Shock Absorber Dynamometer. The Shock Absorber Dynamometer (Figure 2.12-9) is used to characterize damper and spring performance that simulates off-road conditions of performance and durability testing at loads up to 890 kN (200,000 lb) and rates up to 3.8 m/s (150 inch/second). The shocks are driven using a hydraulic actuator, with a bell crank for speeds exceeding 2.0 m/s (80 inch/second). Drive cycles can be simulated for durability and cooling tests, within a 50-Hz frequency range.

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Figure 2.12-9. Shock Absorber Dynamometer.

2.12.4 Wheeled Vehicle Roller Brake Dynamometer.

The roller brake dynamometer is capable of dynamically testing brakes and anti-lock brake systems (ABS). It can also test automatic traction control and electronic stability control (ESC) components and functions that are controlled by the ABS electronic control unit (ECU). Testing of the brakes, ABS, automatic traction control, and ESC are performed in an automated, closed loop manner. The ABS test checks the function of individual wheel speed sensors, ABS valves, automatic traction control valves, ABS and automatic traction control warning lights and wiring harnesses. Tests also confirm proper communication between the ABS ECU and the engine ECU. The brake dynamometer is capable of measuring and recording brake forces of up to 45 kN (10,000 lb.) per wheel and weights at each axle of up to 20,000 kg (44,000 lb.) with an accuracy of within 2.5 % on both measurements.

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Figure 2.12-10. Wheeled Vehicle Roller Brake Dynamometer

2.12.5 Platform Scale.

The 90,700 kg (200,000 lb.) capacity platform scale measures 9.1 m in length and 4.6 m wide (30 by 15 ft). There are 30.5 m (100 ft) level concrete approach and departure lanes provided so that accurate weight distributions can be conducted. Figure 2.12-11 shows vehicles undergoing weight, and center of gravity measurements on the platform scale.



Figure 2.12-11. Vehicles on platform scales.

2.12.6 Wheel Scales.

Wheel scales with a capacity of 9072 kg (20,000 lb.) and a resolution of 1 kg (2 lb.) are located at the same site as the platform scale, as shown above in Figure 2.12-10.

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2.13 Fire Control Test Facilities.

The testing and evaluation of tank armament is conducted on unique firing ranges at the Gunpowder Neck (Figure 2.13-1) and Trench Warfare (TW) areas. Tracking data is collected by video processing software with input from a video camera boresighted with the tank gun (to collect lead angle and super elevation), and another video feed from the sighting system (to collect lay error). This software constantly monitors and outputs the target's azimuth and elevation deflections in the field-of-view of the video signals. The target's position may be merged with other data recorded directly from the fire control system. Video recorders capture the tracking data and monitors allow the test director real time monitoring of the video data.

2.13.1 Tank Armament Test Range (Henry Field).

a. This is a direct fire; multi-range, test area used for evaluating tank armament systems under moving and stationary tank and target scenarios and is located at the Henry Field area of Gunpowder Neck (Figures 2.13-1 and 2.13-2). The direct-fire ranges are arranged with wide-angle safety fans with line-of-sight targets as far away as 3 km (1.9 mi). Special firing slopes (15-percent up, 30-percent down, and various combination slopes up to 20 percent) permit firing at maximum gun elevation and depression, as well as over a variety of vehicle attitudes. Supporting facilities include a four-bay maintenance shop with adjoining offices and briefing room, range control/instrumentation shelters, ammunition magazines, meteorological instrumentation, and communications and other equipment. The H-Field Firing Range was renamed in honor of Mark Henry who lost his life on 21 May 2009 while conducting firing trials.

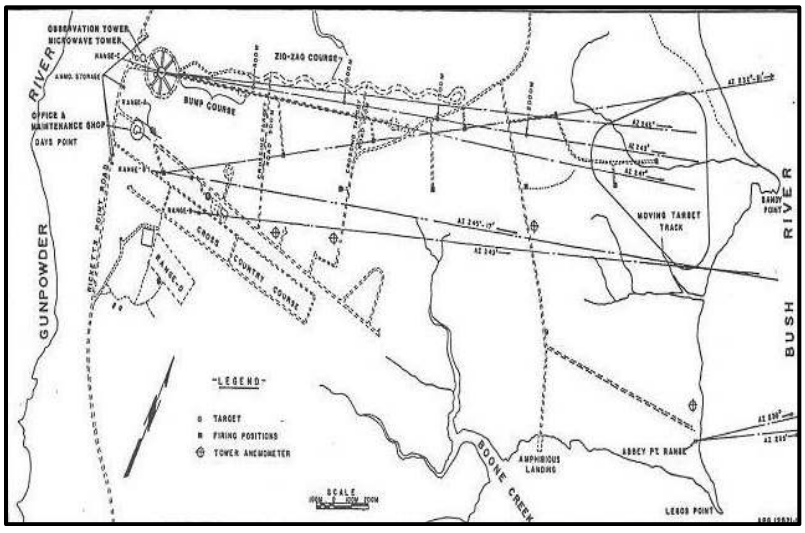


Figure 2.13-1. Henry Field at Gunpowder Neck.

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Figure 2.13-2. Aerial view of Henry Field at Gunpowder Neck.

b. Various terrain courses that include gravel, bump, serpentine, and natural earth are available for comparative performance testing of stabilized fire control systems. Two standardized configurations of the Bump Course are: (1) Elevation Stabilization Bump Course (Figure 2.13-3), and (2) RRC-9 Bump Course (Figure 2.13-4). These courses use two types of bumps: (1) Type A Bump (Figure 2.13-5), and (2) Type B Bump (Figure 2.13-6).

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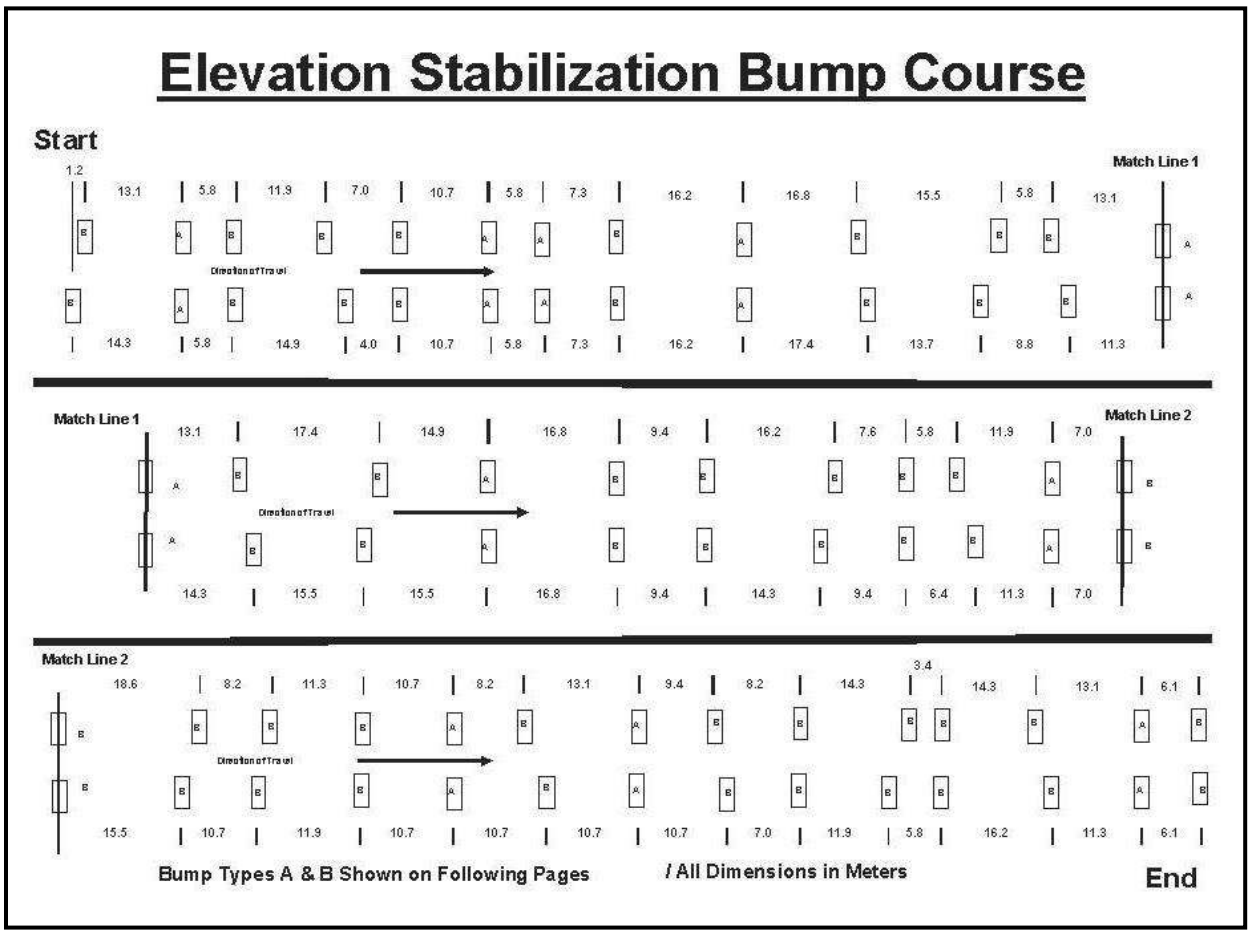


Figure 2.13-3. Elevation Stabilization Bump Course.

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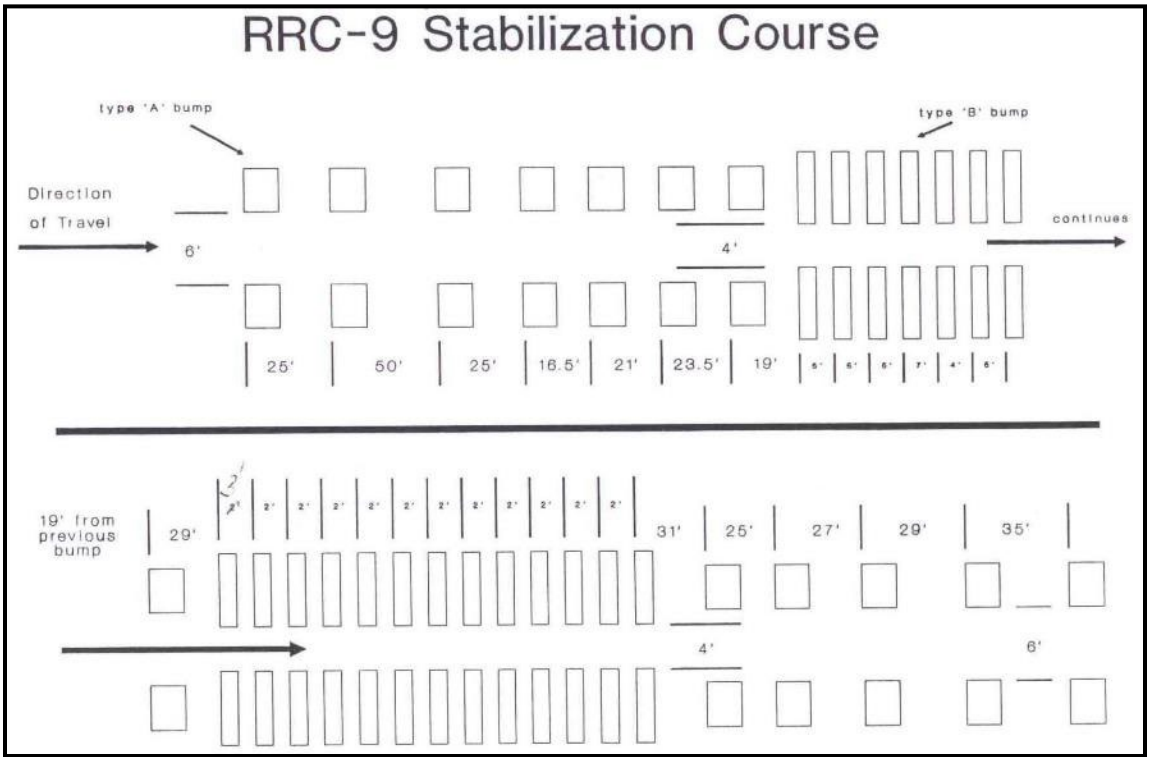


Figure 2.13-4. RRC-9 Stabilization Course.

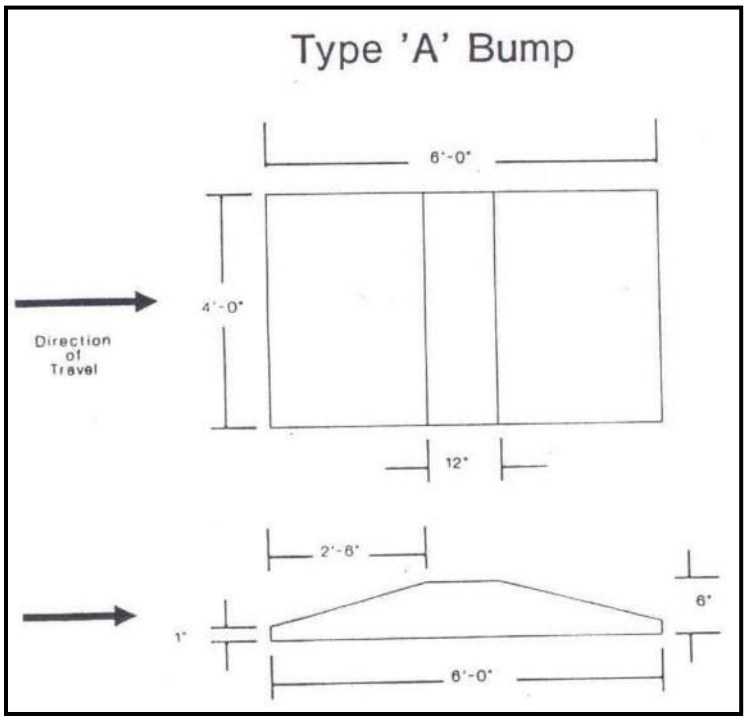


Figure 2.13-5. Type A Bump.

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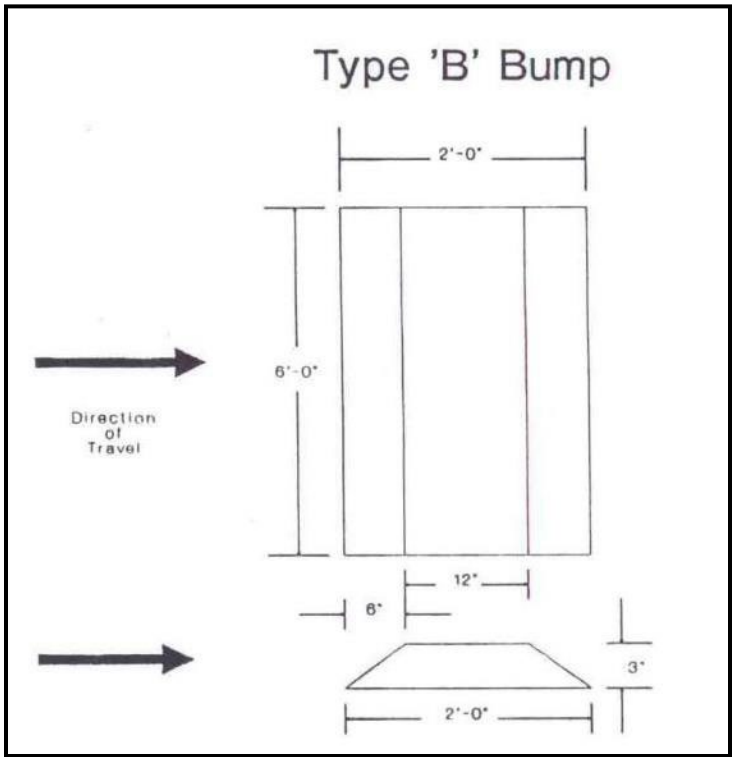


Figure 2.13-6. Type B Bump.

c. Henry Field can be configured with a 6 by 6 m (20 by 20 ft) moving target assembly that can achieve speeds as high as 56 km/hr (35 mph). The moving target is remotely controlled around a 2 km (1.25 mi) triangular railroad pathway. The moving target can be fired upon from a maximum range of 3 km by a stationary vehicle, or a moving vehicle while traversing gravel, bump, or serpentine courses. The moving target is used to measure accuracy of fire for tank turrets, including those equipped with hyper-velocity guns or guided missiles.

d. In addition, the Henry Field ranges are equipped with acoustic or video scoring instrumentation to remotely record target impacts. Down-range meteorological data is obtained by fully automated meteorological stations. Other telemetry and data-processing instruments are available to record and reduce data obtained from monitoring on-board vehicular equipment such as gun sight optics, ballistics computer outputs, rangefinder readings, and main gun aimpoint.

e. Testing capabilities at the principal ranges of Henry Field are summarized in Table 5.

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TABLE 5. HENRY FIELD TANK GUNNERY RANGE TEST CAPABILITY

MAXIMUM DISTANCE FOR DIRECT FIRE (METERS 0 TO)	FACILITIES	TYPE OF TEST
3000	Targets and bombproofs; slopes for firing in 15% reverse, 30% forward position, or other vehicle attitudes to 20%.	Miscellaneous.
3000	Remotely controlled moving target 0 to 56 km/hr (0 to 35 mph) controllable to ±3.2 km/hr (±2 mph).	Accuracy firing or tracking of moving targets, including light armor plate structures.
3000	Stabilization courses: gravel, stabilization bump course, RRC-9 bump course, and serpentine.	Effectiveness of stabilizers, functioning of traversing mechanisms.
500 and 1100	Crossing target roads.	Tracking and laying tests.
3000	Targets and bombproofs.	Width-angle accuracy firing.

2.13.2 Evasive Target Firing Range (TW I).

a. The Trench Warfare I (TW I) range (Figure 2.13-7) is a direct fire range for assessing tank fire control systems under stationary and moving test item/target scenarios. Maximum distance for stationary targets is 3 km (1.9 mi). A moving target is installed 2.4 km (1.5 mi) downrange from the firing pad. This rail-mounted target, which can move at speeds up to 24 km/hr (15 mph), provides the capability of moving-vehicle, moving-target engagements. Gravel, bump, and natural earth courses are available for fire-on-the-move exercises. Automated data acquisition capabilities for target scoring, projectile velocity, meteorological, thru-site and weapon pointing video, data bus activity and system performance are provided.



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Figure 2.13-7. Evasive Target Firing Range (TW I).

b. The TW I range is also used for longer distance non-firing target surveillance and observation exercises to evaluate combat vehicle night sights. Its large open area with undulating terrain can accommodate targets as far as 3 km (1.9 mi) from the viewing vehicle.

2.13.3 Moving Target Simulator (MTS).

The Moving Target Simulator (MTS) facility provides a laboratory environment for assessing weapon control systems such as laying, tracking, and fire control system accuracy/performance tests to determine hit probability (Figure 2.13-8). It uses a 30.5 m (100 ft) radius air-supported hemisphere. Inside the hemisphere a computer-controlled laser beam generates repeatable stationary vehicle versus moving target test scenarios. The simulated moving target is projected on the interior of the hemisphere. The computer-generated stationary, moving and evasive ground and aerial targets are produced by the laser beam steering system. Instrumentation acquires data such as video scoring, weapon and through-sight video, data bus activity, weapon system/component performance, and target position.

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Figure 2.13-8. Moving Target Simulator.

2.13.4 Multiple Target Firing Range (TW II).

This highly instrumented, stationary vehicle/stationary target direct-firing range is designed to determine interactions of the fire control system, weapon, ammunition, and weapon mount (Figure 2.13-9). Two lines of fire are available to accommodate depleted uranium and live high-explosive projectiles. Multiple targets are available at ranges up to 3 km (1.9 mi) for depleted uranium projectiles. Targets are available at ranges up to 5 km (3.1 mi) for all other projectiles. For both lines, continuous velocity profile of the projectile is provided by Doppler radar. Jump, dispersion, projectile miss distance, boresight retention, trajectory mismatch, aim error, and weapon system implementation error are measured in real time. This data can be combined with non-firing tracking test data to estimate hit probability. Available instrumentation includes weapon and thru-sight video, target scoring, projectile velocity, data bus acquisition, weapon system/component measurements, and meteorological data.

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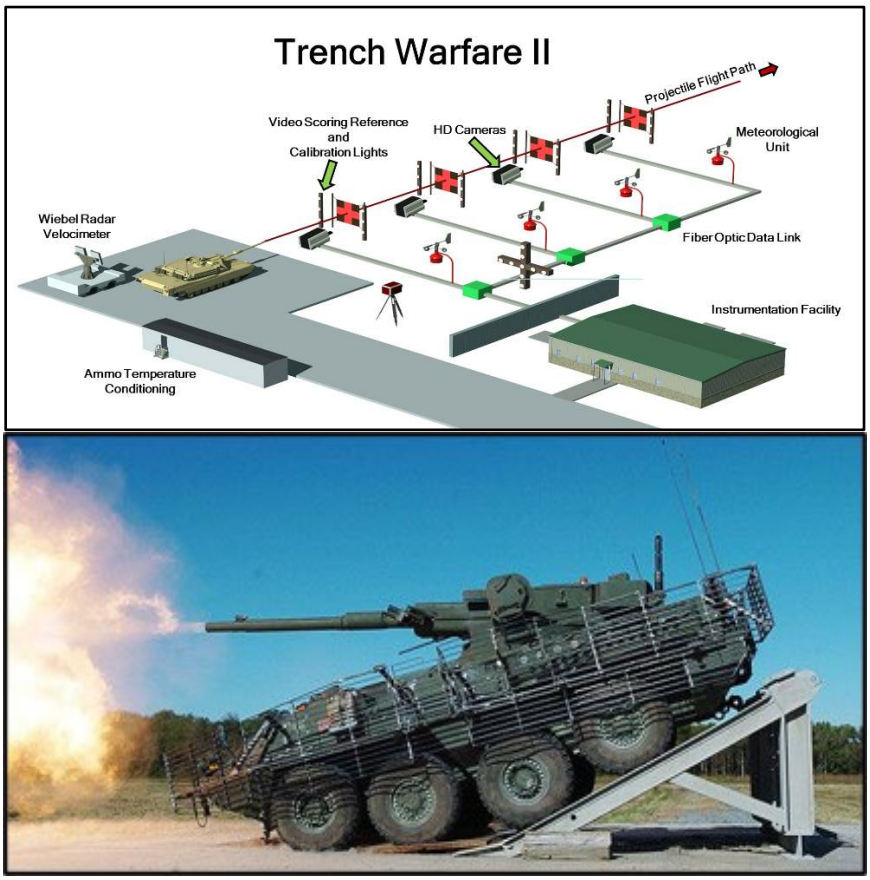


Figure 2.13-9. Multiple Target Firing Range (TW II).

2.14 Scalable Net Centric Test Area (SNCTA).

The SNCTA consists of two test courses, the Small Unmanned Ground Vehicle (SUGV) test course and the Large Unmanned Ground Vehicle (LUGV) test course. All elements of the SNCTA are being designed to provide real-world challenges to the sensor and safety systems being engineered into unmanned ground vehicles (UGVs).

2.14.1 Small Unmanned Ground Vehicle (SUGV) Test Course.

The SUGV Test Course has several test stations that allow an operator to evaluate a broad range of vehicle capabilities. A top view sketch of the course is shown in Figure 2.14-1, and photographs of the course are shown in Figure 2.14-2. The test course is nominally 37 m by 67 m (120 ft by 220 ft). Two test loops, each measuring 1.5 m (5 ft) wide, enclose a 24 m by 46 m (80 ft by 150 ft) open land grass area, which is the location of the course operator. Adjacent to the course is a wooded area marked off to provide a small course used to test vehicle mobility through grass, leaves, and low undergrowth.

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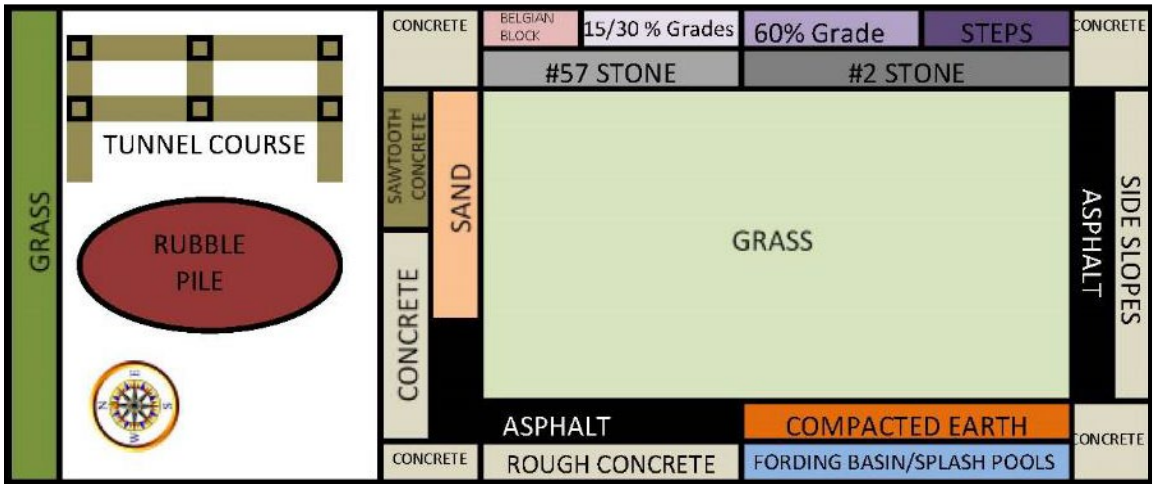


Figure 2.14-1. The SUGV Test Course Layout.



Figure 2.14-2. The SUGV Test Course Obstacles.

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Figure 2.14-3. The SUGV Test Course Aerial.

2.14.2 Large Unmanned Ground Vehicle (LUGV) Test Course (Proposed).

This course is geared for safety and performance testing of LUGVs up to 9,100 kg (20,000 lb) gross vehicle weight. The eventual goal is to operate UGVs on standardized automotive test courses in order to adequately evaluate system performance and reliability. However, because this will require the UGVs to operate in the vicinity of manned vehicles and personnel, it's critical that extensive safety and performance testing be conducted prior to these operations. This course will be used to evaluate these safety and performance characteristics, specifically vehicles equipped with autonomous navigation systems. The course will replicate operational conditions that will be encountered by these systems and assess their ability to negotiate obstacles and terrain expected to be encountered during UGV operations.

2.15 Rail Transport Facility.

The facility is designed to ensure compliance of materiel transported by rail with Military Surface Deployment and Distribution Command transportation certification requirements in accordance with MIL-STD-810H CN1. The facility is fully instrumented to record velocity and shock levels, and includes still photography, video, and high-speed video. The site features a

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covered railcar loading/unloading and tie-down facility with stocked supplies of rigging materials, tools, and wood-working machinery for producing required chocks and cribbage. On-site locomotive and standard railcar equipment are available, and the determination of tunnel clearance of loaded railcars is also available.

2.16 Amphibious Vehicle Operations Facility.

This facility consists of the Littoral Warfare Environment (LWE), a large pond with two distinct areas (Figure 2.16-1). The first area is the wave channel that has a width of 30.5 m (100 ft) and a length of 91.4 m (300 ft). The depth of the channel is approximately 7.6 m (25 ft) and gradually decreases to a beachhead that is 45.7 m (150 ft) in length (Figure 2.16-2). The wave channel is equipped with a programmable wave machine which can produce waves as high as 6 ft, which is equivalent to various levels of sea state depending on the scale utilized (i.e. 5 on the Beaufort scale, 4 on Douglas scale, 4 on the NATO scale for open ocean, etc.). The second area is a 91.4-m (300-ft) long by 91.4-m (300-ft) wide pond with a maximum depth of 11.3 m (37 ft) in the center.



Figure 2.16-1. Littoral Warfare Environment (LWE).

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Figure 2.16-2. The beachhead at the end of the wave channel at the LWE.

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3. YUMA TEST CENTER COURSES AND FACILITIES

Figure 3 shows the layout of the over 160 km (100 miles) of vehicle test courses and test facilities available at YTC, situated within the desert terrain of Southwest Arizona. Although YTC spans over 3300 square km (1300 square miles), the automotive endurance and performance courses and test facilities are situated within close proximity to each other within the southern portion of YTC, which allow for tailoring vehicle tests to any specified mission profile.

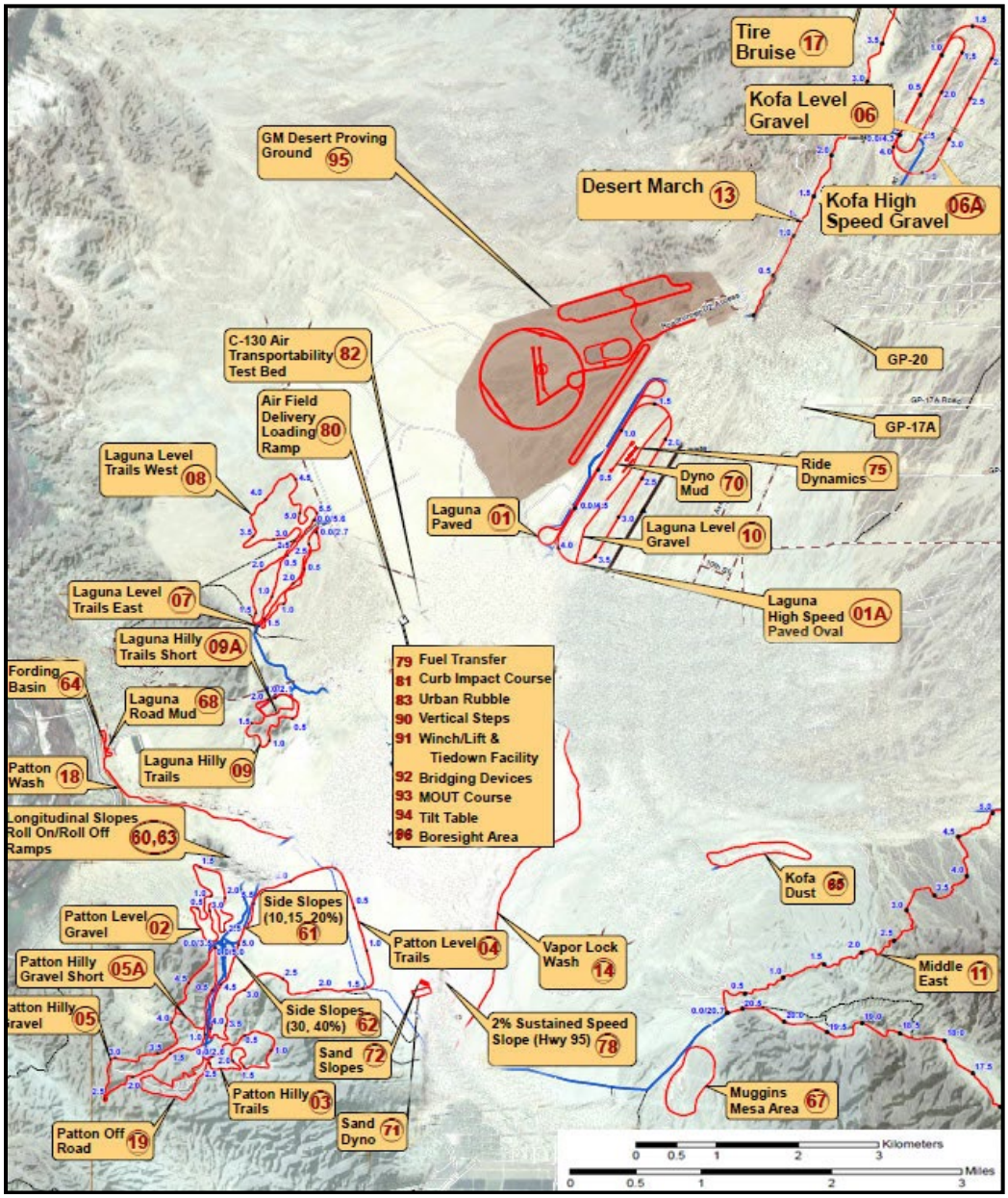


Figure 3. YTC Courses.

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3.1 Endurance Courses.

a. Patton Level Gravel. The site is a 5.6 km (3.5 mi) secondary course where the terrain is basically Limey Upland, Deep and is composed of the River-bend Family- Carrizo Family Complex which are comprised of extremely gravely-coarse soils. Figure 3.1-1 shows the typical terrain of the course and a course map. The course is designed in a loop configuration consisting of short straight sections, and curves of various radii. The course provides an excellent surface for evaluating steering performance, track durability, and vehicle operations at medium speeds. The average rms is 1.19 cm (0.47 in.).

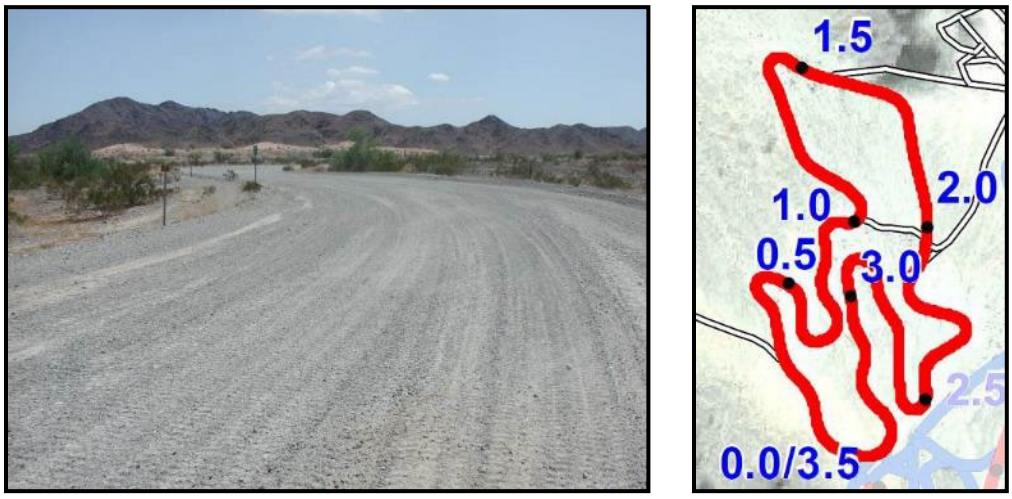


Figure 3.1-1. Typical terrain of Patton Level Gravel Course (left) and course map (right).

b. Patton Hilly Trails. This site is a 4.2 km (2.6 mi) loop course situated on a basalt hill range site which is located on a series of relic beach terraces. The course begins on the edge of a heavily dissected beach terrace complex and climbs up the side slope of the terrace and then proceeds down the opposite side of the terrace down into the wash bottom, repeating this pattern numerous times. Several of the grades on the course are as steep as 32 percent, with the average grade being 11%. The design of the course allows testing the full function of the transmission, braking, steering, suspension, and track systems. The average rms is 4.32 cm (1.70 in.). Figure 3.1-2 shows the typical terrain of the course and a course map.

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Figure 3.1-2. Typical terrain of Patton Hilly Trails Course (left) and course map (right).

c. Patton Level Trails. This course is a 10.5 km (6.5 mi) trails course that traverses a wide range of terrain types including alluvial landforms with various dust contents, sand dunes and badlands. Bedrock is not present on this course. The average grade over the terrain is generally less than 5%, though the largest grade reaches 16 percent. The level sandy terrain is interspersed with many bumps to provide a severe test of vehicle suspensions with moderate loads on the drive train. The sandy to dusty conditions found within the course are typical of cross-country operations on dry soil. Figure 3.1-3 shows the typical terrain of the course and a course map. The average rms is 2.59 cm (1.02 in.).



Figure 3.1-3. Typical terrain of Patton Level Trails Course (left) and course map (right).

d. Patton Hilly Gravel. This course is an 8.0 km (5.0 mi) long automotive course with grades up to 26 percent, each grade several hundred feet in length (average grade is 8%). The course is built into the slopes of the Laguna Mountains and consists primarily of stretches of very cobbled surface interspersed with rock outcrops and bedrock. The course terrain is basalt hills with some volcanic hills inclusions. Climbing the long grades places prolonged high torque demands on the transmission which results in lower gear ratios and increased engine speed, placing a greater demand upon the cooling system. The downgrades have the opposite effect of

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the climbing scenarios with higher gear ratios, less engine speed, but with increased braking demands being placed on the service brake system. The average rms value is 1.30 cm (0.51 in.). Patton Hilly gravel also has a shorter loop that is available for track vehicle use. Figure 3.1-4 is a characteristic photograph of the terrain and a course map.

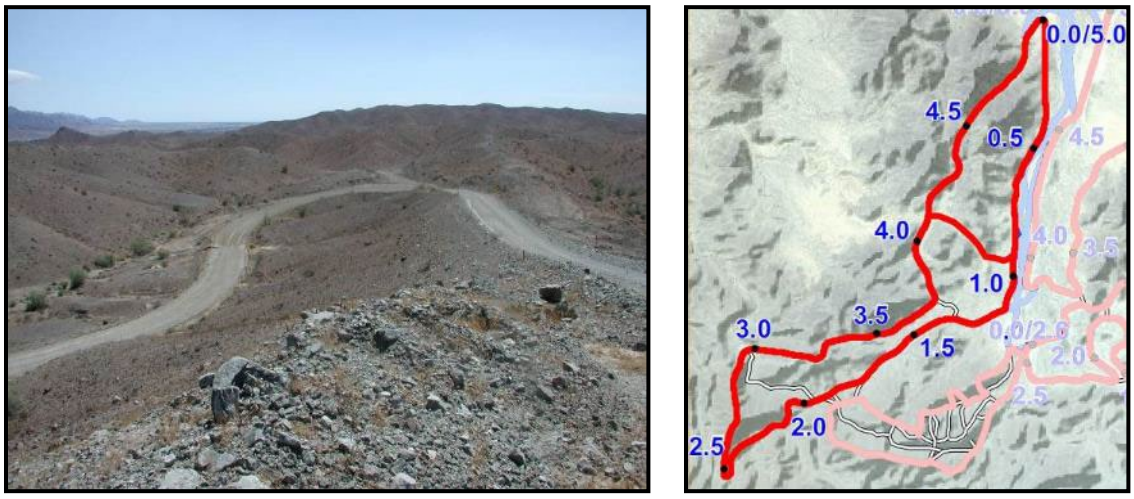


Figure 3.1-4. Typical terrain of Patton Hilly Gravel (left) and course map (right).

e. Kofa High Speed Gravel. This course is a 6.7 km (4.2 mi) oval loop that circles around the Kofa Level Gravel loop, as shown in Figure 3.1-5. The course is composed of quarried road construction grade gravel that has been compacted and graded. Compared to Kofa Level Gravel, the course is maintained to be smoother, with fewer washboards. The larger size and the larger turns allow vehicles to maintain higher sustained course speeds. The average rms is 0.28 cm (0.11 in), and the gradient averages 1.0%.

f. Kofa Level Gravel Course. This improved secondary gravel road is a nearly level oval loop 4.8 km (3.0 mi) long and 12 meters (40 ft) wide. The course is composed of quarried road construction grade gravel that has been compacted and is regularly graded. Mild to heavy washboarding is allowed to naturally accumulate on the course between grading cycles. The average rms for the course is 0.43 cm (0.17 in.), and the gradient averages 1.0%. Figure 3.1-6 shows a vehicle on the course and a course map.

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Figure 3.1-5. Aerial view of Kofa Level Gravel and Kofa High Speed Gravel.



Figure 3.1-6. Vehicle on Kofa Level Gravel (left) and a course map (right).

g. Laguna Level Trails East. This course is a 4.5 km (2.8 mi) loop constructed on a relic lake floor and is mostly level with the exception of gentle grades (max grades less than 10%) associated with desert wash bottoms and is suitable for testing commercial trucks. The course terrain features are best described as Limey Upland Deep and provide an excellent example of

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the unimproved roadways of the Middle East. The course is composed of the Gilman Family, Harqua Family, Glenbar Family Complex soils. These soils compact easily and provide a hard surface which is susceptible to erosion by the winds. The eroding of the surfaces produces mild wash boards which add to overall effects of the course. The average rms for the course is 1.04 cm (0.41 in). Figure 3.1-7 shows the typical terrain of the course and a course map.

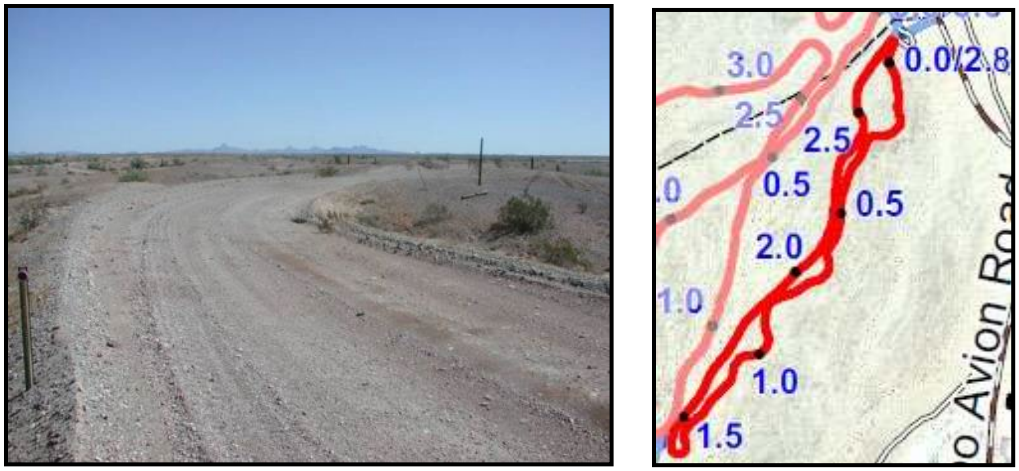


Figure 3.1-7. Typical terrain of Laguna Level Trails East (left) and course map (right).

h. Laguna Level Trails West. This trail is 9.0 km (5.6 mi) in length loop course. The loop crosses surfaces composed mostly of sand and gravel. The Laguna Level Trails West has more gravel and sand washes than the East Loop. The course is nearly level except for gentle embankments where alluvial washes are crossed (max grades less than 10%). The four landforms that the Laguna Level Trails West course crosses are dissected fan, alluvial fan and terrace, and wash. The surface cover of the upper 5 cm (2 in.) of these landforms is mostly sub-rounded to angular gravel that range from poorly graded gravel with either silt, sand or clay to well-graded gravel with sand. The average rms is 1.8 cm (0.70 in.). Figure 3.1-8 shows the typical terrain of the course and a course map.

i. Laguna Hilly Trails. This trail is a 3.3 km (2.1 mi) loop course that traverses hilly terrain composed of loose rock, gravel, and sand with grades up to 30% with lengths up to 30 meters (100 ft). The four landforms that the Laguna Hilly Trails course crosses are bedrock, dissected fan, alluvial terrace, and alluvial wash. The surface cover of the upper 5 cm (2 in.) of these landforms is mostly sub-rounded to angular gravel that range from poorly graded gravel with either silt, sand or clay to well-graded gravel with sand. The average rms is 1.32 cm (0.52 in.). Figure 3.1-9 shows the typical terrain and a course map.

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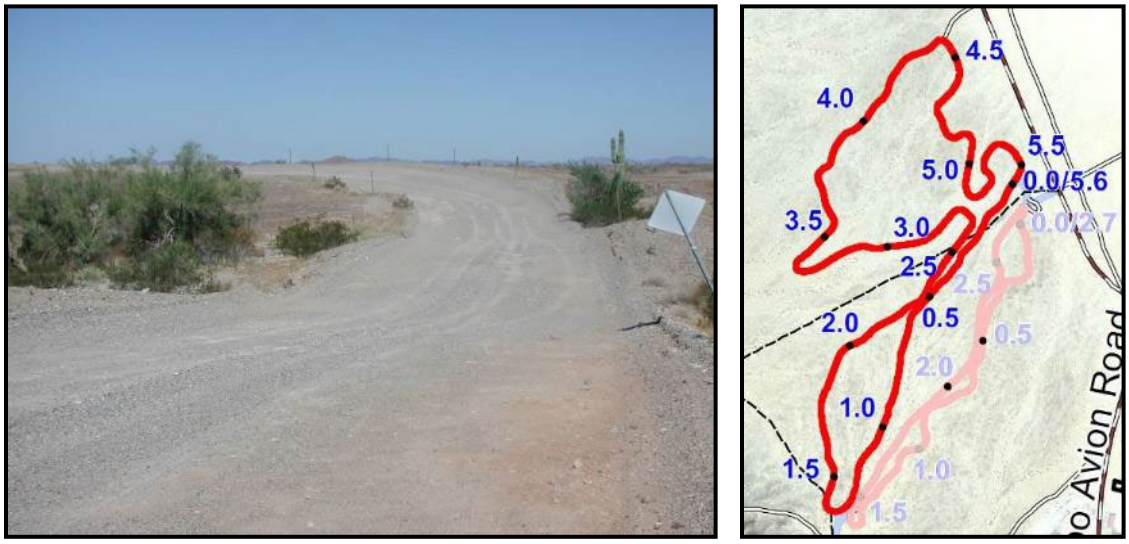


Figure 3.1-8. Typical terrain of Laguna Level Trails West (left) and a course map (right).

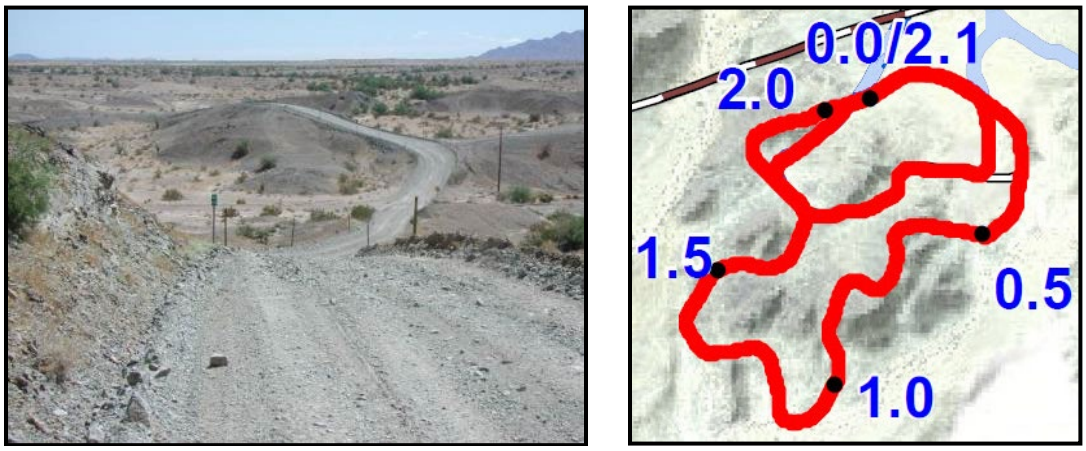


Figure 3.1-9. Typical terrain of Laguna Hilly Trails (left) and a course map (right).

j. Middle East Course. The site is a 33.3 km (20.7 mi) composite course operating on the lower reaches of the Muggins Mountains, with terrain representative of comparable operations in the deserts of the Middle East. The course takes advantage of wash bottoms for concealment, terrace side slopes for speed, terrace tops for orientation, and basin floors for speed and concealment. Some of the 9 soil complexes found at YTC are encountered around the course. The varied landforms and terrain features found on this course provide an excellent composite of desert conditions to test the vehicle endurance and performance parameters. The average rms for this course is 5.11 cm (2.01 in.). The maximum grade encountered on the course is 31%, and the average grade is around 5%. Figure 3.1-10 shows examples of the typical terrain on the course and Figure 3.1-11 is a course map.

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Figure 3.1-10. Rough, rocky wash (left) and vehicle on course (right).

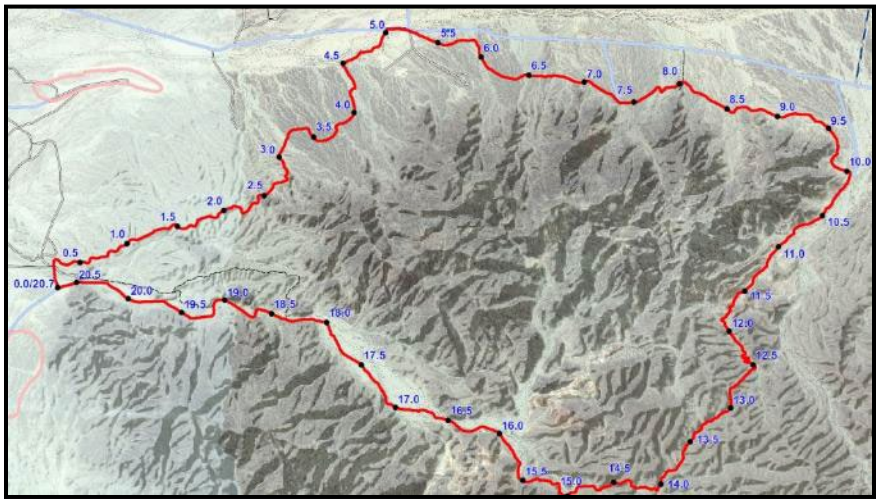


Figure 3.1-11. Middle East Course map.

k. Rock Ledge Course. This course is 6.3 km (3.9 mi) long, is located between two vertical rock outcroppings, and is traversed with several exposed rock ledges. The course follows a natural water course through the mini canyon. The terrain is classified as basalt hills, and volcanic hills. The surface of the trail is primarily composed of Riverbend Family-Carrizo Family Complex soils which are very coarse sands which are very heavily cobbled. The second soil class is the Lithic and Typic Torriorthents complex. These soils are composed of fragmented bedrock, vertical rock outcrops and very thin soil layers. They are usually strewn with large stones up to 76 cm (30 in.) in diameter that have spalled off the vertical ledges. In many sections there is no soil, just rocks of various sizes. The average rms is 3.96 cm (1.56 in). Grades are relatively mild, and the maximum grade is 15%. A characteristic photograph of the terrain and an overall course map is presented in Figure 3.1-12.

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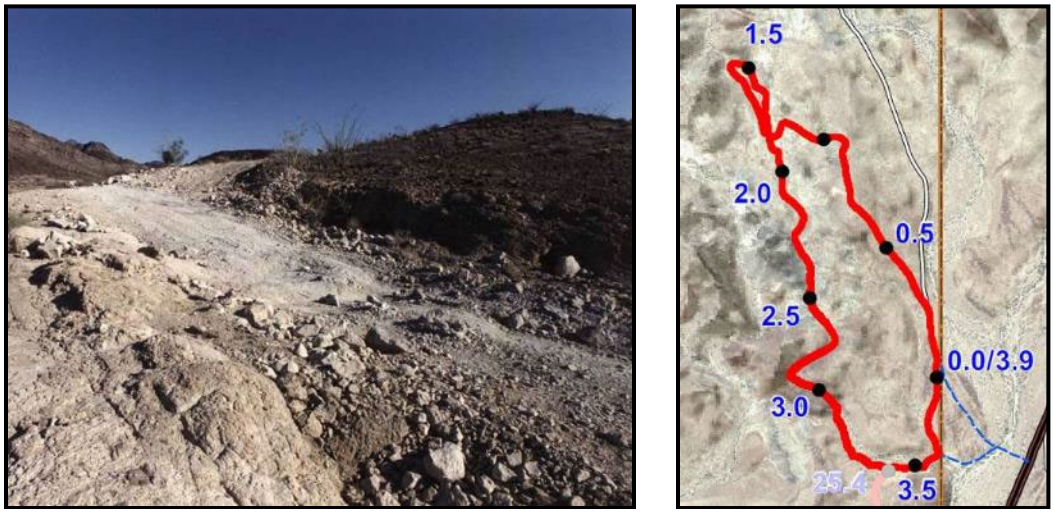


Figure 3.1-12. Typical terrain of Rock Ledge (left) and course map (right).

l. Desert March Course. The site is a 40.8 km (25.4 mi) course through a variety of desert terrain features including limey fans, limey fan sandy, sandy uplands, sandy bottoms, and gravely and rocky hills. The route exposes a test vehicle to a rigorous test condition which exercises the suspension system, braking systems and the transmission with repeated shifting due to the torque requirements needed to traverse the varied terrain. The average rms is 2.87 cm (1.13 in.). Grades are generally mild (average grade 3%), but several hills push the steepest grade to 24%. Figure 3.1-13 shows the typical terrain and a course map.



Figure 3.1-13. Typical terrain of Desert March (left) and course map (right).

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m. Vapor Lock Wash. The site is a course located along the bottom of a watercourse at the foot of an ancient beach terrace, and is classified as sandy bottom, deep. The course follows the natural wash bottom for approximately 4.0 km (2.5 mi). The course provides deep sand and consists of twists and turns along its course. The course was previously used to test for vapor locking of fuel feed systems. Presently it is used for vehicle maneuverability and handling in deep sand conditions, as well as to present a large stress on vehicle cooling systems. The grades are essentially flat, and roughness descriptions are not provided due to the sandy nature of the terrain. Figure 3.1-14 shows the typical terrain and a course map.



Figure 3.1-14. Typical terrain of Vapor Lock Wash (left) and course map (right).

n. Highway 95. YTC has use of an 80 km (50 mi) stretch of U.S. Highway 95 spanning from the intersection with Imperial Dam Road (mile marker 44) north almost to Quartzite AZ at mile marker 105. The asphalt highway is used to conduct endurance operations over primary terrain at speeds up to the 105 km/hr (65 mph) speed limit for vehicles that can attain a permit to operate on U.S. highways. A stretch of U.S. Highway Route 95 running through YTC is shown in Figure 3.1-15.

o. Bereznuk Track Evaluation. This site is an approximately 2.4 km (1.5 mi) course over relatively undisturbed rocky terrain. Tracked vehicles are tested on this course to evaluate the durability characteristics of track systems over rocky terrain. Figure 3.1-16 shows the course map.

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Figure 3.1-15. Aerial view of Highway 95.

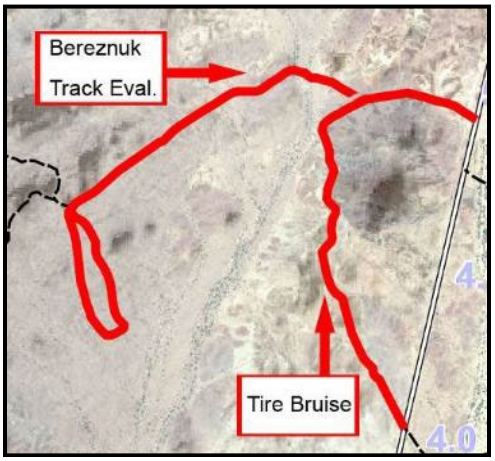


Figure 3.1-16. Course map for the Bereznuk Track Evaluation and Tire Bruise.

p. Tire Bruise. This course is approximately 2.1 km (1.3 mi) in length and is used primarily for evaluating tire durability and exercising suspension components. The surface of the course contains many 10 to 20 cm (4 to 8 in.) diameter rocks.

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q. Patton Wash. This test course is located within a gravel and sand wash that runs approximately parallel to the Imperial Dam road. One end of the course is located at the YTC fording basin, which has been used as a water source to allow pipeline or flexible conduit water pumping operations along the length of the 3.7 km (2.3 mi) course; this capability allows for testing deployment and distribution petroleum and water systems. The Patton Wash is an active wash, meaning that heavy rainfall periodically restores the terrain. The layout of the course is shown in Figure 3.1-17 and the typical terrain is shown in Figure 3.1-18.

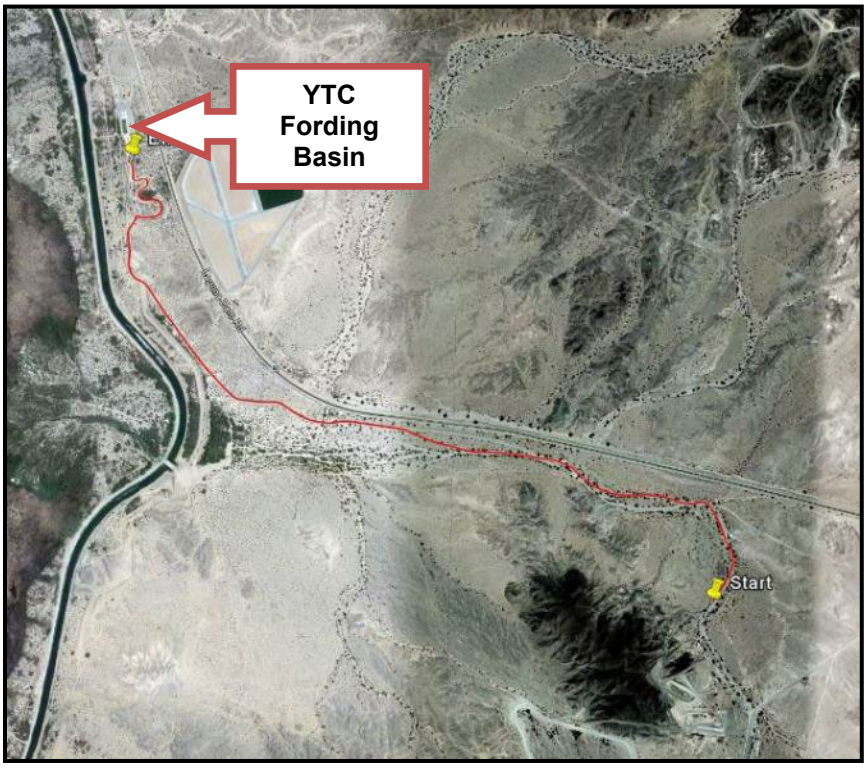


Figure 3.1-17. Overview of Patton Wash Course.

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Figure 3.1-18. Typical terrain of Patton Wash.

r. Patton Off-Road. This course is a severe cross-country course with the steepest grades, approaching 50 percent, of any course at YTC. In addition to the steep grades, severe terrain obstacles are present due to rocky terrain and washout of the material. The course is situated on a basalt hill range site which is located on a series of relic beach terraces. Due to the severity of the terrain, the course is generally used for mobility evaluations of lighter wheel vehicle platforms with significant off-road capability. The 5.0 km (3.1 mi) course layout allows for different routes to be followed through the course to tailor the profile for the system. The grade profile of the course is shown in Figure 3.1-19, and the course terrain and map are shown in Figure 3.1-20.

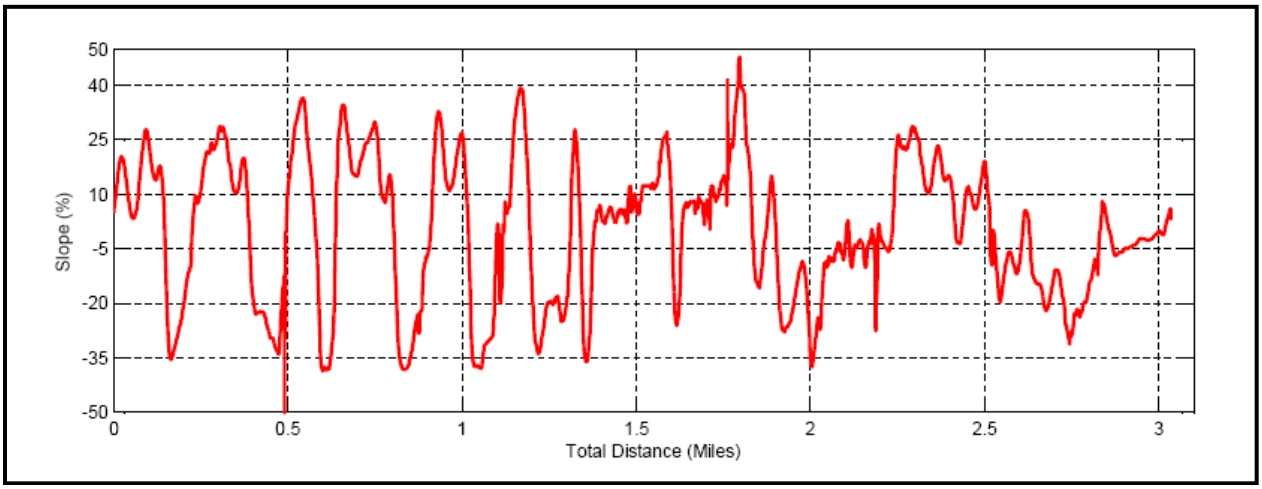


Figure 3.1-19. Patton Off Road Course grade profile.

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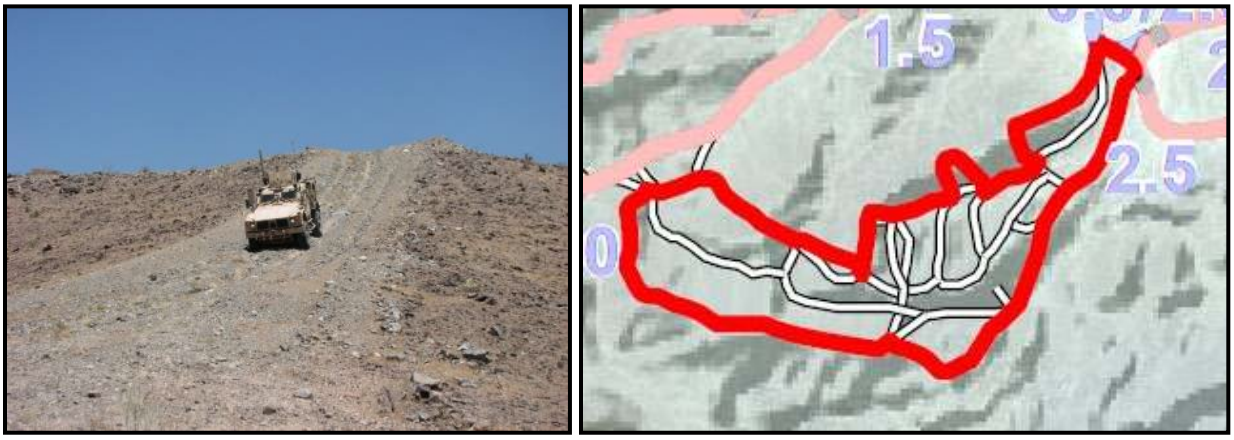


Figure 3.1-20. Patton Off Road Course terrain (left) and course map (right).

3.2 Performance Courses.

a. Longitudinal Grades. At this facility, test vehicles can ascend or descend concrete grades ranging from 5 to 60 percent, as well as demonstrate both service and parking brake hold testing; maintainability of satisfactory lubricant and fluid levels; engine restart capabilities; and proper and satisfactory operation of vehicle component systems. Table 6 shows the dimensions of the longitudinal grades. Figure 3.2-1 shows the 20% through 60% concrete surfaced longitudinal grades.

TABLE 6. YTC LONGITUDINAL GRADE DIMENSIONS

SLOPE (percent)	WIDTH m (ft)	LENGTH m (ft)
5	9.1 (30)	37.8 (124)
10	9.1 (30)	45.1 (148)
15	4.3 (14)	91.4 (300)
20	6.1 (20)	72.5 (238)
30	4.6 (15)	78.3 (257)
40	4.6 (15)	47.2 (155)
60	6.1 (20)	32.3 (106)

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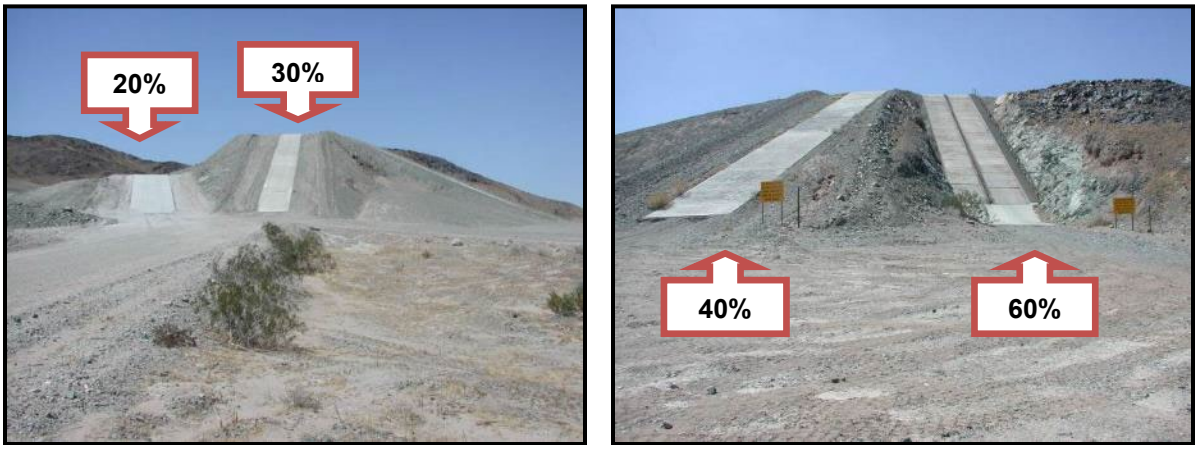


Figure 3.2-1. Longitudinal grades.

b. Roll On/Roll Off Ship Ramps. This facility consists of two metal ramps, one at an approach angle of 12 degrees and the other at an approach angle of 15 degrees, as shown in Figure 3.2-2. Ship loading operations do not occur when the ramp angle is in excess of 15 degrees, whereas the interior deck ramps of the ship are at approximately 12 degrees, which is the basis of the ramp angles. The ramps are used to evaluate adequate power and traction as well as ramp approach and exit clearance and interference. This simulated test can also provide procedural checks for proper negotiation. Both ramps are 3 m (10 ft) wide; the 12-degree ramp is 18 m (60 ft) long, and the 15-degree ramp is 15 m (48 ft) long.

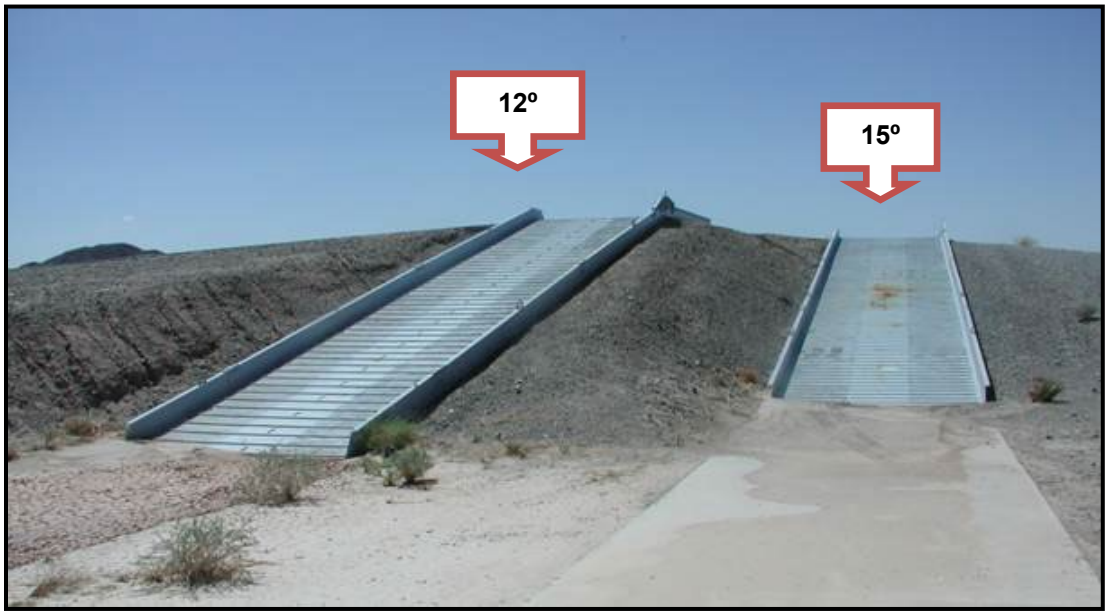


Figure 3.2-2. Roll on/roll off ramps.

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c. Side Slopes. At the concrete side slope facilities, test vehicles can demonstrate satisfactory traverse and stability on side slopes from 10 to 40 percent, as well as the maintainability of satisfactory fluid levels and integrity of seals. Table 7 shows the side slope dimensions. Figure 3.2-3 shows the 30 and 40 percent concrete surfaced side slopes.

TABLE 7. SIDE SLOPE DIMENSIONS

SLOPE (percent)	WIDTH m (ft)	LENGTH m (ft)
10	9.1 (30)	150.9 (495)
15	10.4 (34)	151.2 (496)
20	9.1 (30)	150.9 (495)
30	9.4 (31)	121.3 (398)
40	9.8 (32)	72.8 (239)



Figure 3.2-3. 30-percent side slope (left) and 40-percent side slope (right).

d. Sand Grades. The longitudinal sand grades have nominal grades of 5, 10, 15, and 20 percent. Figure 3.2-4 shows the four grades of the course area, and Figure 3.2-5 shows the 20% sand grade. The course material is soft, loose, dry, wind sorted beach sand that was imported from southern California. The sand grades are prepared prior to test for a uniform condition by disc harrowing. The testable portions of each grade are a different length: 5% grade is 61 m (200 ft), 10% grade is 30 m (100 ft), 15% grade is 55 m (180 ft), and the 20% grade is 37 m (120 ft) in length.

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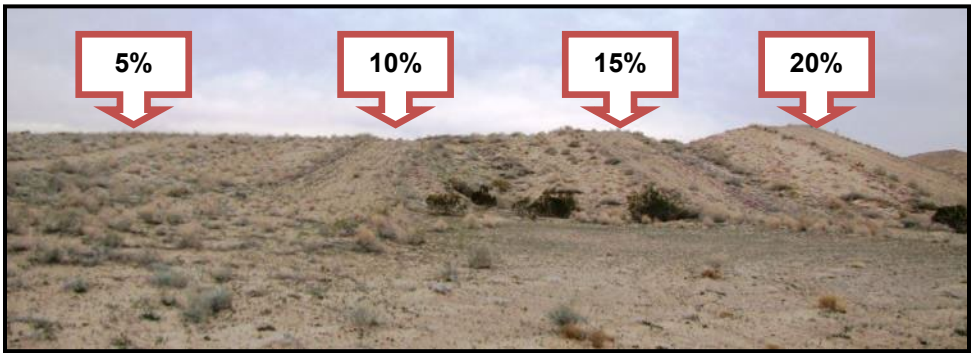


Figure 3.2-4. Sand Grades.



Figure 3.2-5. 20-percent Sand Grade.

e. Fording Basin. Vehicles and equipment are evaluated for the ability to ford deep and shallow water in the fording basin. This facility (see Figure 3.2-6) is approximately 67 m (220 ft) long, 25 m (82 ft) wide, adjustable to a maximum depth of 2.3 m (7.7 ft) and is fully lined with concrete. The basin is filled with water from a nearby canal to the depth required. There are two sides to the fording basin with two different approach and departure ramps described in Figure 3.2-7.

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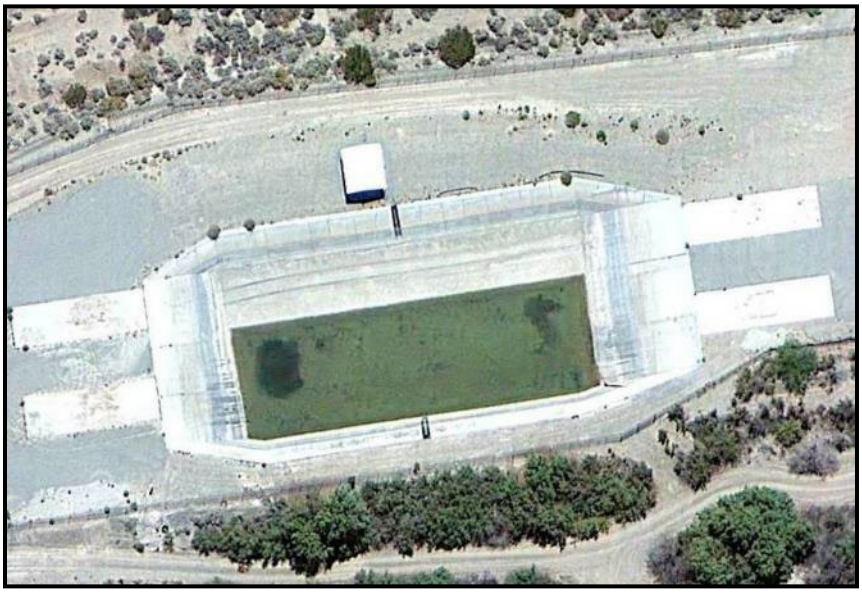


Figure 3.2-6. View of Fording Basin.

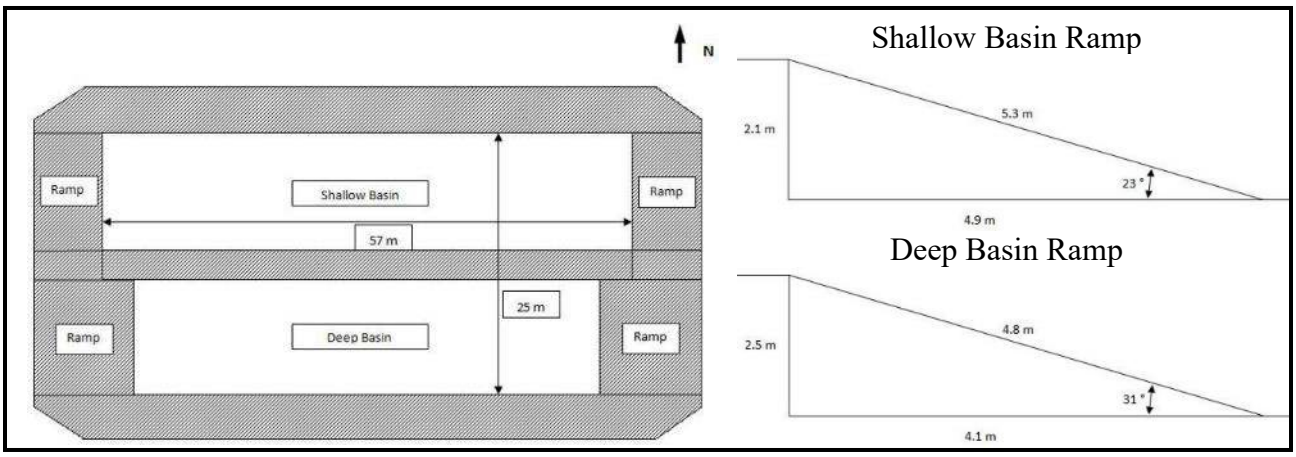


Figure 3.2-7. Fording basin layout.

f. Kofa Dust Course. This course is a 3.2 km (2.0 mi) long circular track through a classical basin floor composed of Gilman Family-Harqua Family, Glenbar Family Complex soils. The terrain is classified as limey fan and is characterized as very fine silty loams, which are easily elevated into the air producing very dense dust clouds which remain suspended for significant periods of time. The particles in these soils are extremely small, in some cases less than 5 microns, and are slightly abrasive. This course is used to test the ability of engine filtration systems to filter out the dust particles. Additionally, the course is used to evaluate the filtration systems and sealing capabilities of the vehicle and crew compartments. Figure 3.2-8 shows a vehicle on the Kofa Dust Course and a map of the course.

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Figure 3.2-8. Vehicle performing non-convoy dust testing on Kofa Dust Course (left) and map of Kofa Dust Course (right).

h. Cibola Mud Course. This course is a prepared pad 91.4 m (300 ft) wide by 152.4 m (500 ft) long with a mud surface consisting of fine-grained clay soils in combination with water to produce muddy surface approximately 1.2 cm (3 in.) deep to perform tire traction testing.

i. Dyno Mud Course. This course is 0.6 km (0.4 mi) long and is maintained at an approximate depth of 46 cm (18 in), over a firm base. The mud is a mixture of sand, clay, and silt. Water is added to the course with a sprinkler array and the quantity of water added to the course will change the consistency of the mud. The course provides a severe test of seals on road wheels, road arms, constant velocity joints, suspensions, brakes and steering components. Figure 3.2-9 shows a vehicle operating on the YTC Dyno Mud Course.



Figure 3.2-9. Vehicle operating on Dyno Mud.

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j. Laguna Mud Course. This course is approximately 0.6 km (0.4 mi) long with a very uniform soil distribution over its entire length. The soil is classified as inorganic clays with high compressibility. The clay/sand surface can be wet to produce a representative muddy surfaced clay road used for maneuverability testing of vehicles. The mud is created by flooding the course from a nearby canal. Figure 3.2-10 shows a vehicle operating on Laguna Mud Course.



Figure 3.2-10. Vehicle operating on Laguna Mud.

k. Sand Dynamometer. This course is composed of primarily Gilman Family, Harqua Family, and Glenbar Family soils which are very sandy silty loams with very fine particles. These soils are easily moved by wind action and tend to build extensive low dunes. The sand dynamometer terrain is described as sandy upland. The course is built upon one of the larger dunes and has adequate space for multiple passes over untracked terrain between surface preparations. The consistency and uniformity of the course surface is maintained by disc harrowing. The course is used primarily to determine vehicle speeds and mobility in deep sand. Figure 3.2-11 shows the Sand Dynamometer Course.

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Figure 3.2-11. YTC Sand Dynamometer Course.

l. Ride Dynamics Course. YTC has five ride dynamics courses developed by the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers Waterways Experiment Station (WES). These courses are used to determine vehicle and human response to a specific, frequency-based road input. YTC's ride quality courses vary in length from 251 to 305 m (825 to 1000 ft) and in surface roughness from 1.0 to 8.6 cm (0.4 to 3.4 in.) rms (Figure 3.2-12).



Figure 3.2-12. RMS 5 Ride Dynamics course.

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m. Fuel Transfer and Test Site Area. This area is designed for fuel truck, tanker-to-fuel truck, and tanker transfer endurance tests inside a 34 m by 61 m (110 ft by 200 ft) fenced area. The area has a 12 m by 37 m (40 ft by 120 ft) concrete parking and fuel spill containment pad. The facility is equipped with a 19,000 L (5,000 gal) fuel spill collection tank. Figure 3.2-13 shows fuel tanks undergoing storage testing and a fuel tanker at the Fuel Transfer and Test Site Area. An additional large-scale fueling site is located in the center of the Dyno complex for fueling systems that do not fit within the confines of the Fuel Transfer Site.



Figure 3.2-13. Fuel tanks undergoing storage test (left) and fuel tanker at the Fuel Transfer and Test Site Area (right).

n. Airfield Delivery Loading Ramp. This site at Laguna Army Airfield (LAAF) is used as a skid pad for steady-state cornering testing. The concrete pad measures 96 by 148 m (315 by 485 ft). Figure 3.2-14 shows a vehicle undergoing testing on the test site.



Figure 3.2-14. Vehicle undergoing testing on the Airfield Delivery Loading Ramp.

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o. Half Rounds and Curb Impact Course. These courses are used to analyze the vehicle's ability to absorb impacts at various speeds and assesses the input into the vehicle operator. The half round course consists of interchangeable 10, 15, 20, 25, 30 cm (4, 6, 8, 10, 12 in.) steel half rounds. Figure 3.2-15 shows the 25-cm (10-in.) half rounds. The curb impact course consists of one concrete curb as shown in Figure 3.2-16. The height of the curb can be adjusted up to 61 cm (2 ft) in height by grading the gravel surface below the curb.



Figure 3.2-15. Ten Inch Half Rounds.



Figure 3.2-16. Curb Impact Course.

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p. C-130 Air Transportability Test Bed (ATTB). This facility, located at the Air Delivery complex, is a C-130A fuselage designed to provide a cost-effective alternative for test loading combat vehicles and logistics systems under development, as shown in Figure 3.2-17. The ATTB allows programs the opportunity to determine if their test items will fit onboard a standard military cargo craft. The cargo compartment dimensions, concentrated cargo/pneumatic tire load limits, and aircraft tiedown points onboard the ATTB (shown in Figure 3.2-18) are fully representative of all C-130 E/H and J model aircraft currently in service. The ATTB is equipped with fully functional electrical and hydraulic systems, cargo ramp and door, ground loading ramps, paratroop doors, cargo winch, aerial delivery system components (excluding static line retrieval winches), A/A32H-4A cargo handling system, pendulum release, static-line cable system, and an internal climate control system. Additional uses of the ATTB include fit/function aircraft interface developmental testing of aerial delivery systems and components and use as an airborne test mission rehearsal simulator.



Figure 3.2-17. Aircraft Transportability Test Bed.

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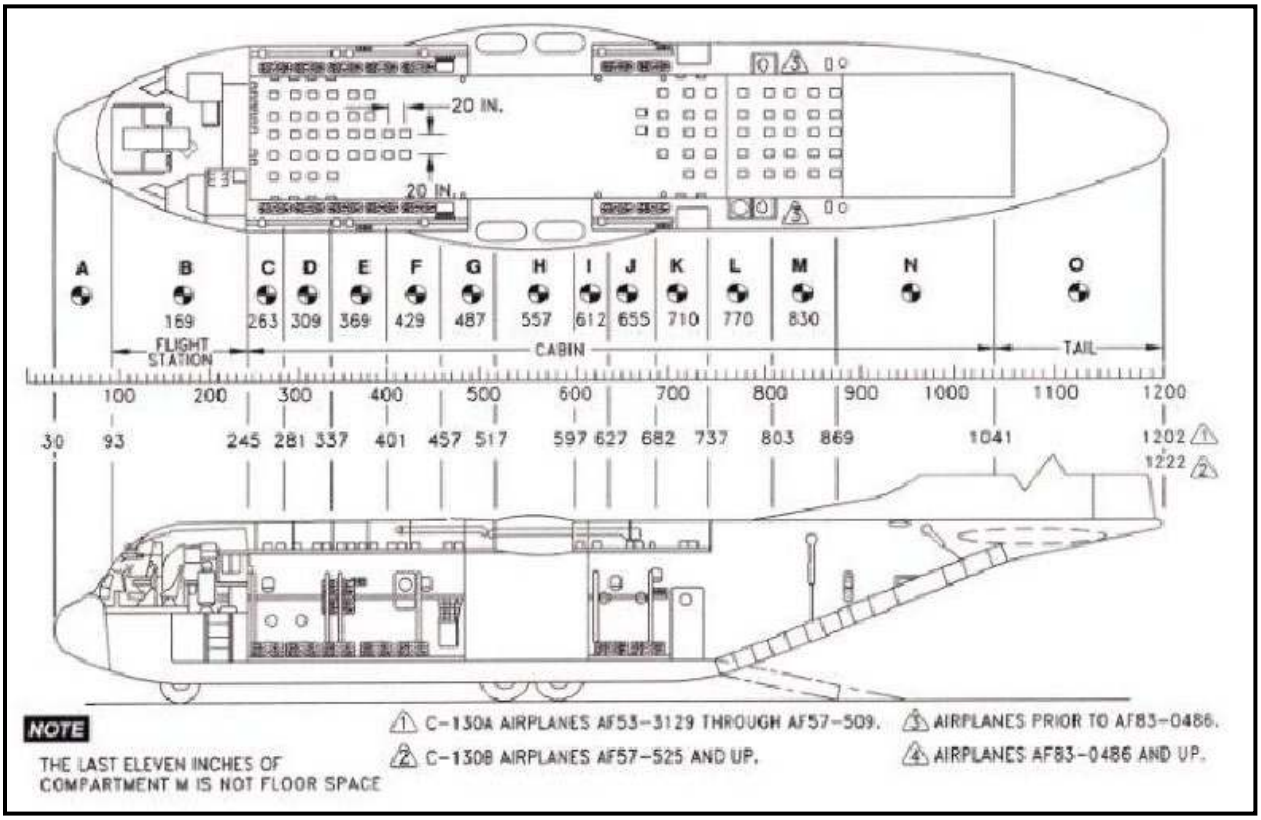


Figure 3.2-18. C-130 ATTB dimensions.

q. Urban Rubble. This course is approximately 30 m (100 ft) in length and 9 m (30 ft) wide. The course consists of large boulders, pieces of concrete, and construction debris spread throughout the length of the course as shown in Figure 3.2-19.



Figure 3.2-19. Urban Rubble Course.

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r. Hot Weather Test Complex (HWTC). This complex is a joint use facility located at YTC comprised of two test complexes: one a series of test courses constructed for the Army, and the other the General Motors (GM) Desert Proving Grounds - Yuma. The HWTC contains the Laguna High Speed Paved Oval, Laguna Paved, Kofa Level Gravel, Kofa High Speed Gravel, and GM Performance Test Courses. The Army HWTC facilities were constructed to give YTC the ability to test the heaviest combat and combat support vehicles at high sustained speeds coupled with the high temperatures experienced in hot desert regions across the world. Figure 3.2-20 shows a map of the HWTC. Testing at the complex allows for the full range of testing to include, but not limited to: maximum and minimum speeds, acceleration, braking (including split friction and low friction), J-turn, steering and handling, drawbar pull, fuel consumption, cooling, rolling resistance, tractive effort, endurance testing of wheeled and tracked vehicles, and evaluation of overweight and over length vehicles.

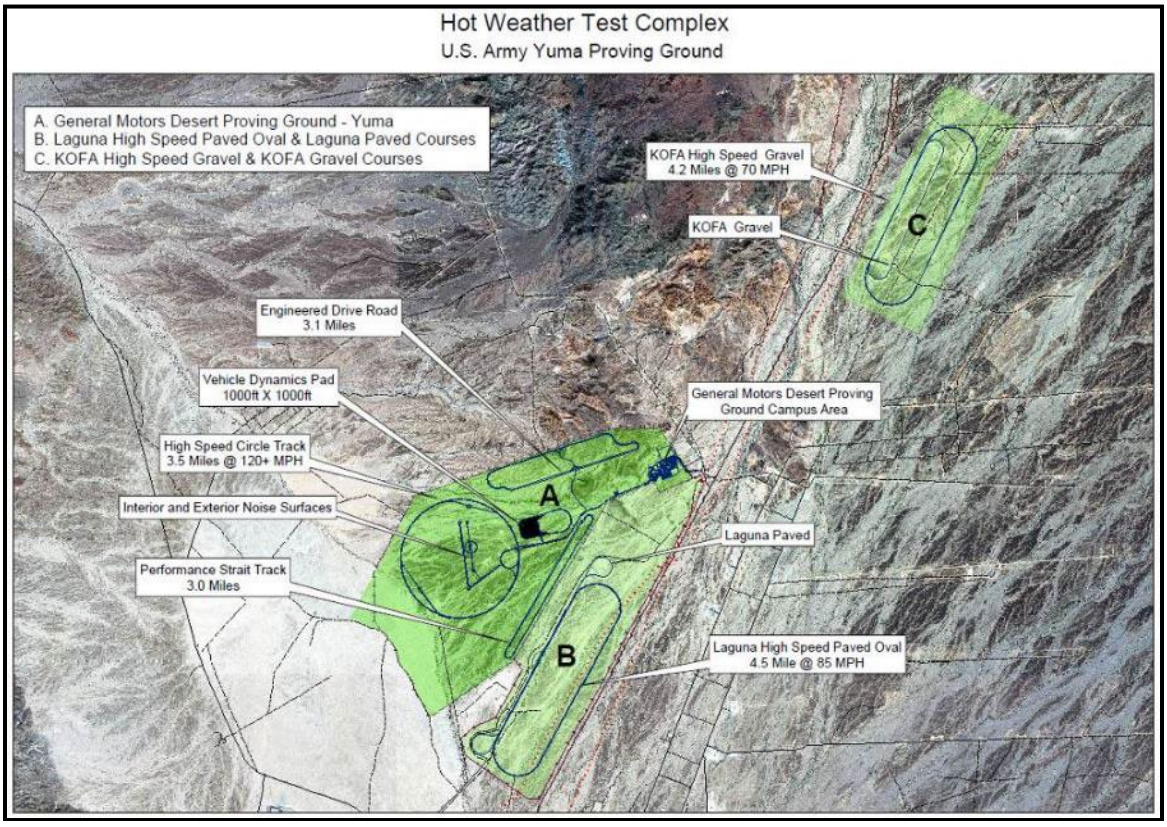


Figure 3.2-20. HWTC map.

s. Laguna High Speed Paved Oval. This course is a 7.2 km (4.5 mi) long, two-lane oval test track with straightaways 2370 m (7,780 ft) in length and cornering radii are 370 m (1,200 ft) as shown in Figure 3.2-21. The course is level with a minimal 0.8 percent grade, is approximately 143 m (470 ft) above sea level, and consists of firm reinforced bed covered with a high-strength asphalt coating. The Laguna High Speed Paved Oval course allows for wheeled vehicles with weights up to 113,398 kg (250,000 lb).

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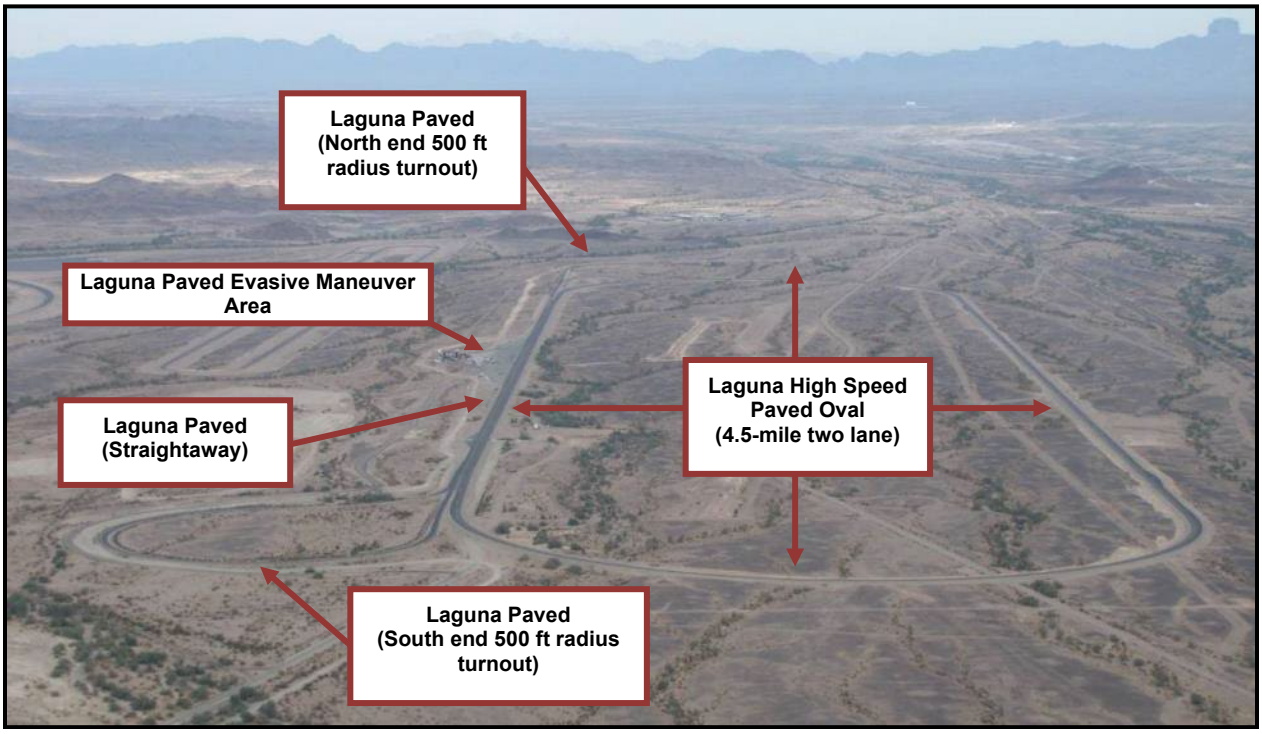


Figure 3.2-21. Aerial view of the Laguna Paved and Laguna High Speed Paved Oval.

t. Laguna Paved. This course is 3.2 km (2.0 mi) in length, comprising of a single lane straightaway and two 152 m (500 ft) radius turnouts at each end as shown in Figure 3.2-21. The Laguna Paved course accommodates both tracked and wheeled vehicles with weights up to 113,398 kg (250,000 lb) for both endurance and performance testing. This course, along with the capability of the YTC Mobile Dynamometers, provides the capability of conducting Full Load Cooling, Tractive Effort, and other performance tests plus paved highway endurance testing. The Laguna Paved course is level with a minimal 0.8 percent grade and is approximately 143 m (470 ft) above sea level. The course consists of firm reinforced bed covered with a high-strength asphalt coating. There is a 305 m (1000 ft) long by 30.5 m (100 ft) wide automotive handling and evasive maneuver testing area co-located with the Laguna Paved course also shown in Figure 3.2-21. The evasive maneuver testing area contains two low friction jennite surface sections for low friction or split friction testing. The first is a straight 122 m by 4 m (400 ft by 12 ft) lane. The second section is a 107 m by 7 m (350 ft by 24 ft) curved section with a 152 m (500 ft) radius of curvature. Figure 3.2-22 shows the layout of the low friction test areas.

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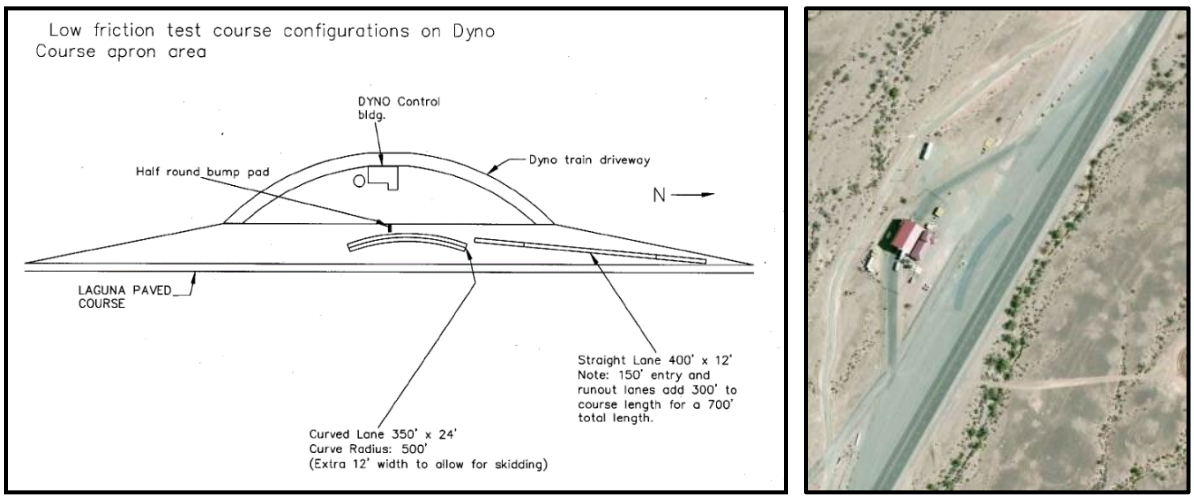


Figure 3.2-22. Low friction areas of the Laguna Paved Test Course.

u. GM Desert Proving Grounds Yuma Courses. As part of the Enhanced Use Lease agreement which developed the Hot Weather Test Complex, YTC has access to the GM performance courses for use in vehicle tests within the weight limits of the facilities.

(1) GM High Speed Circle Track. The track is a three-lane 5.6 km (3.5 mi) asphalt circle with the lanes banked parabolically enabling speeds in excess of 190 km/hr (120 mph) without excessive lateral friction or banking load. Wheeled vehicles with a gross vehicle weight (GVW) of 36,300 kg (80,000 lb) and axle weights of 9,000 kg (20,000 lb) are able to be tested on this test course, primarily for endurance operations or tire testing.

(2) GM Vehicle Dynamics Pad. The pad is a 305 m by 305 m (1,000 ft by 1,000 ft) square of asphalt with two ingress/egress lanes. Wheeled vehicles with a GVW of 36,300 kg (80,000 lb) and axle weights of 9,000 kg (20,000 lb) are able to be tested on this test course. This test course is used primarily for vehicle dynamics testing such as North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) lane change, lateral stability, and National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) J-turn maneuver, steady increasing steer, or sine with dwell maneuvers.

(3) GM Performance Straight Track. The track is 4.8 km (3.0 mi) in length and consists of two parallel 2.3 km (1.4 mi) asphalt straightaways connected with 180-degree curves at either end. Wheeled vehicles with a GVW of 36,300 kg (80,000 lb) and axle weights of 9,000 kg (20,000 lb) are able to be tested on this test course. This test course is used primarily for automotive performance such as acceleration and braking.

(4) GM Engineered Ride Road. The road is 5.0 km (3.1 mi) in length with two or three lanes (depending on the section of the course) of specially constructed asphalt and concrete road sections. Each road section has been specially designed to replicate real world road surfaces that have been found to excite a vehicle's suspension and affect ride dynamics in a unique way. Due to the sensitive nature of the specially constructed road surfaces, testing on this

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course is determined on a case-by-case basis depending on program requirements and vehicle axle weights.

(5) GM Belgian Block and Granite Block. A 76 m (250 ft) section of Belgian block and a 152 m (500 ft) section of granite block is used for ride dynamics and shock and vibration testing. Wheeled vehicles with a GVW of 36,300 kg (80,000 lb) and axle weights of 9,000 kg (20,000 lb) are able to be tested on these road surfaces.

v. Pothole Course. This course consists of six steel fabricated potholes. The potholes range in size from 10 to 30 cm (4 to 12 in.) in depth, 1.2 to 2.4 m (4 to 8 ft) in length, and 1.2 to 1.8 m (4 to 6 ft) in width respectively, sunk flush with the gravel surface. Figure 3.2-23 shows a close-up of a pothole on the course and describes in detail the dimensions and spacing of each pothole. The sides and ends of the two 30 cm (12 in.) deep potholes are sloped 45 degrees, whereas the smaller potholes are sloped 45 degrees on the sides, with one end open and the other end sloped at 90 degrees. The course is laid out to allow vehicles ample room to reach desired speeds and approach each pothole with either the right or left side tires. The potholes are designed to be approached individually, from the right or left sides, with the vehicle entering the course perpendicular to the line of potholes. The potholes are not staggered such that they can be run successively in a straight line.



Figure 3.2-23. YTC Potholes Course (left) and dimensions of the YTC Potholes Course (right).

w. Vertical Steps. This site consists of permanent concrete walls of 15, 30, 46, 61, 76, and 91 cm (6, 12, 18, 24, 30, and 36 in.) in height with replaceable timbers placed at the vehicle approaching end. The replaceable timbers minimize damage to test vehicle components upon contact with the steps. This course is used to determine the test vehicles' capability to climb vertical objects. Figure 3.2-24 shows the characteristics of the vertical steps.

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Figure 3.2-24. Vertical Steps.

x. V-ditch. The V-ditch obstacles consist of a direct approach concrete V-ditch, and an angled approach concrete V-ditch. The direct approach V-ditch is 4.6 m (15 ft) wide, and 7.6 m (25 ft) from crest to crest. The angled approach V-ditch is 12 m (40 ft) wide, and 7.0 m (23 ft) from crest to crest. The angled approach V-ditch can be traversed so that either the right or left side tires drop into the V-ditch first. Both V-ditches feature a 20-degree angle relative to level. Figures 3.2-25 and 3.2-26 show the V-ditches.



Figure 3.2-25. Direct approach V-ditch.

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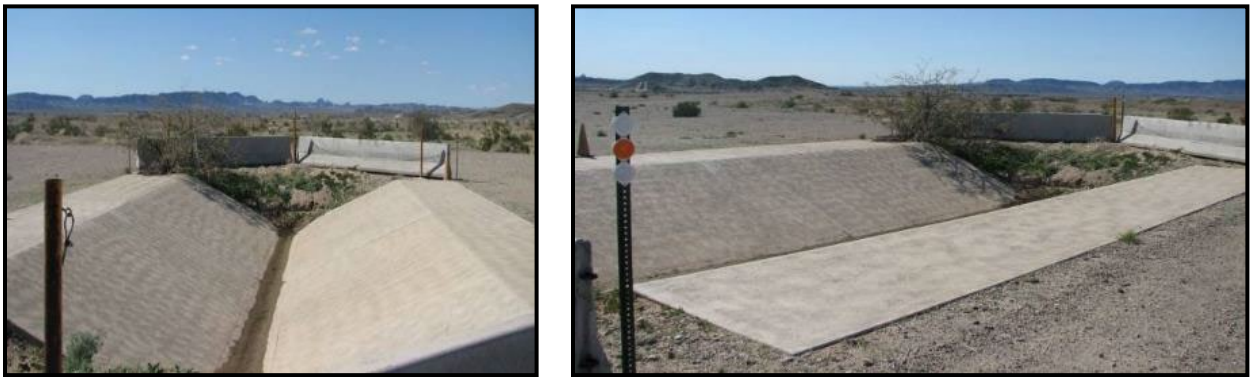


Figure 3.2-26. Angled approach V-ditch side view (left) and 45-degree front view (right).

y. Military Operations on Urban Terrain (MOUT) Obstacle Course. The MOUT course consists of a curbs obstacle, logs obstacle, washboard terrain, 23-cm (9-in.) half rounds, 35-percent longitudinal grade, and staircase obstacle. The obstacles are designed to be run individually or in series as an obstacle course. The curbs obstacle (Figure 3.2-27) is 4.3 m (14 ft) in length and 6.1 m (20 ft) wide and consists of five concrete barriers laying on their sides and sunk into the gravel. The curbs are angled at 45 degrees in one direction and 90 degrees in the opposite direction, and range in height from 15 to 21.6 cm (6 to 8.5 in.). The logs obstacle (Figure 3.2-28) is 9.1 m (30 ft) in length and 6.1 m (20 ft) wide and consists of logs laid side-by-side varying in diameter from 18 to 35 cm (7 to 14 in.). The washboard terrain (Figure 3.2-29) is 6.1 m (20 ft) in length and 4.6 m (15 ft) wide. The half round obstacles (Figure 3.2-30) consist of 7 half rounds, each 23 cm (9 in.) high, and offset so that a vehicle's right and left side tires alternate traversing the obstacle every 3.4 m (11 ft) (center to center). The half rounds cover a span of 16.8 m (55 ft) in length and a maximum track width of 2.7 m (9 ft). The staircase obstacle (Figure 3.2-31) is a series of 17 steel steps with antiskid coating. The stair treads are 38 cm (15 in.) deep and have a rise of 15 cm (6 in.) each (approximately 23-degree longitudinal grade). The staircase is 6.1 m (20 ft) long (hypotenuse) and 4.3 m (14 ft) wide.



Figure 3.2-27. Curbs obstacle.

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Figure 3.2-28. Logs obstacle.



Figure 3.2-29. Washboard terrain obstacle.



Figure 3.2-30. 9-inch Half Rounds obstacle.

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Figure 3.2-31. Staircase obstacle.

z. Winch Test Facility. This facility provides the capability to test the operational characteristics of winches. The winch facility is equipped with a concrete deadman that can be used to secure the vehicle under test, as shown in Figure 3.2-32. The concrete deadman can resist a maximum load of 578,000 N (130,000 lb). Winch testing can also be performed at the Lift and Tiedown Test Facility (LTTF), discussed in Paragraph aa.



Figure 3.2-32. Vehicle undergoing winch testing.

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aa. Lift and Tiedown Test Facility. The LTTF provides the capability to test the strength of lifting and tiedown provisions on military equipment with the purpose of validating compliance with the requirements of MIL-STD-209K and MIL-STD-913A. The LTTF is equipped with hydraulic rams, platform, and deadmen to set up and restrain the test item and apply the required loads to the lift and tiedown provisions. The layout of the facility is shown in Figure 3.2-33. The primary components of the LTTF are a longitudinal-force cylinder with a 1,000,000 N (240,000 lb) maximum longitudinal force capacity, a downward-force cylinder with a 400,000 N (90,000 lb) maximum lateral force capacity, and a downward-force cylinder with a 267,000 N (60,000 lb) maximum vertical force capacity. The longitudinal-, lateral-, and vertical-force hydraulic rams are shown in Figures 3.2-34 to 3.2-36. The LTTF is also equipped with additional items that facilitate the setup and restraining of test equipment. The facility is equipped with a large deadman that can resist a longitudinal force of up to 1,000,000 N (240,000 lb) and a lightweight deadman that can resist a longitudinal force of up to 712,000 N (160,000 lb) as shown in Figure 3.2-37. The deck of the lift and tiedown table has six rows of anchor points for use with chain or clevis attachments to restrain test items, and each anchor can resist a maximum pull of 178,000 N (40,000 lb) in any direction.

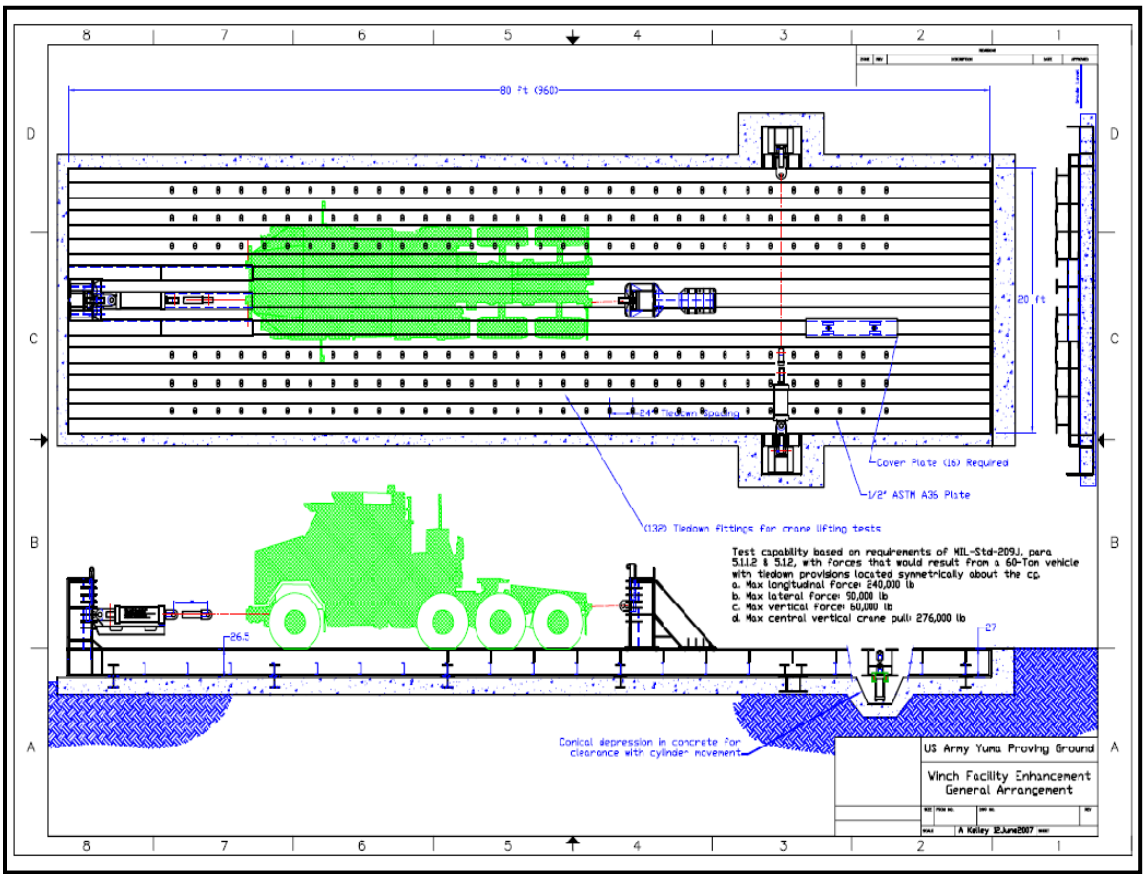


Figure 3.2-33. Lift and Tiedown Facility (LTTF).

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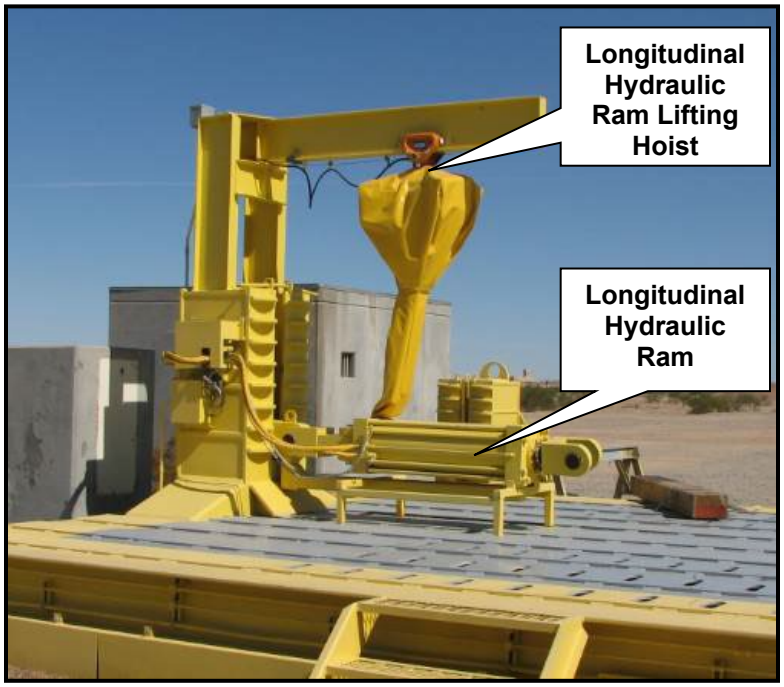


Figure 3.2-34. LTTF longitudinal hydraulic ram.

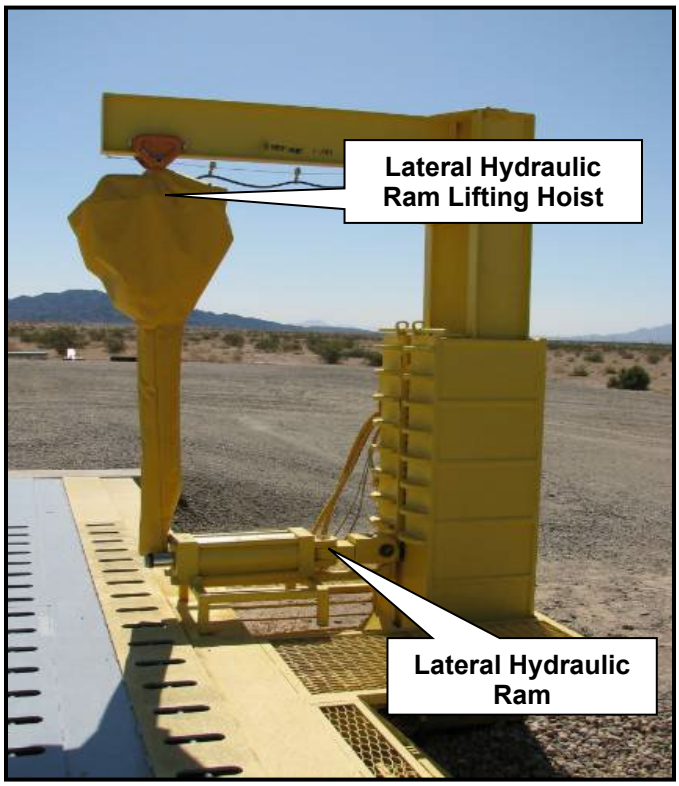


Figure 3.2-35. LTTF lateral hydraulic ram.

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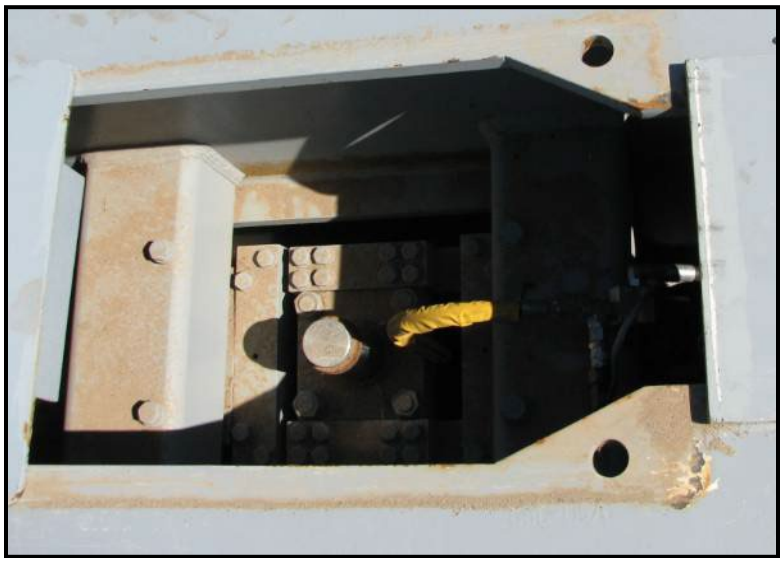


Figure 3.2-36. LTTF vertical hydraulic ram (located under the surface of the LTTF bed).

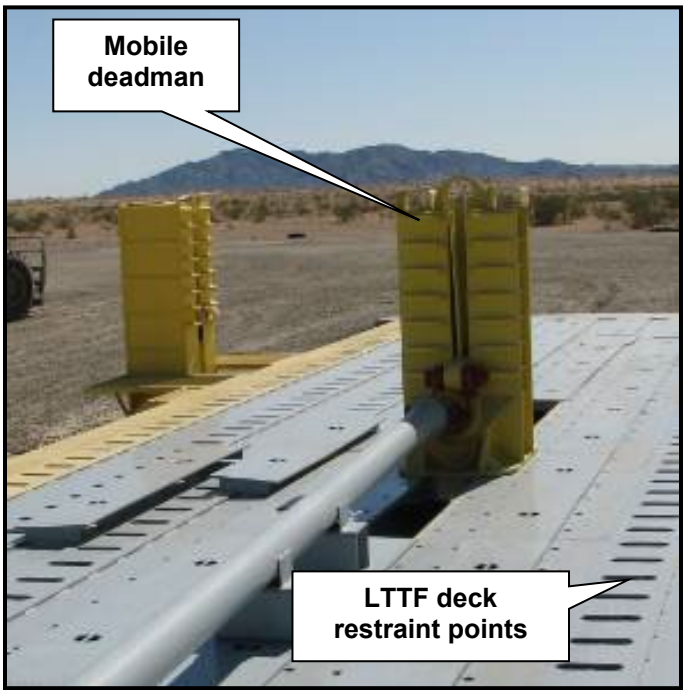


Figure 3.2-37. LTTF deadman and deck restraints.

bb. Bridging Area. Areas are available for testing bridging devices and systems. The area to the north of the concrete 10% side slope has been disturbed by earth moving equipment leaving an assortment of trenches and steps that can be used as obstacles for deploying and

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retrieving bridging equipment. Figure 3.2-38 illustrates a typical 'trench' or ditch feature with a bridging device being deployed. The surface of this area can be altered to suit test scenario needs on a case-by-case basis. For floating type bridging devices (pontoon bridge assemblies) the fording basin and Senator Wash are available for deploying and retrieving trials. YTC can use Senator Wash Reservoir for amphibious testing of vehicles and bridging systems by coordinating with the U.S. Bureau of Reclamation. The reservoir is primarily an irrigation storage facility and is used to modulate water flow in the Colorado River downstream of the reservoir. At normal levels, the reservoir provides water depths of 15 m (50 ft) and over, near the main dam structure. Access to the lake is made via a concrete boat launching ramp, as shown in Figure 3.2-39.



Figure 3.2-38. Bridging device test ditch.



Figure 3.2-39. Senator's Wash Reservoir Swim Test Facility.

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cc. Tilt Table. The facility was designed to determine the static rollover threshold of vehicles following SAE tilt table procedures. The steel table structure has a platform size of 3.7 m (12 ft) wide by 27 m (90 ft) long, accommodating up to the largest Army vehicles, including a fully loaded Heavy Equipment Transporter System. The table provides a maximum tilt angle of 47 degrees, a 0.3 degree per second angle speed, and a lift capacity of 136,000 kg (300,000 lb). The facility includes tiedown provisions on the table and necessary restraints to prevent vehicle rollover from the table. The tilt table facility is shown in Figure 3.2-40.



Figure 3.2-40. YTC Tilt Table Facility.

dd. Boresight Slopes. This location is where most combat vehicles under test start and end daily mission-related operations and is shown in Figure 3.2-41. The boresight pad offers geodetically surveyed points designed to facilitate the testing of Position/Navigation Systems through the verification of vehicle self-location accuracy, target acquisition accuracy and boresight retention. The boresight slopes area provides several targets designed to test target location accuracy and multiple return capability from laser range finders, with permanent targets at ranges from 200 meters out to more than 6,000 meters and the capability to emplace targets at any desired range within line of sight. Typical targets are shown in Figure 3.2-42. Additional useful features of the site include: two separate slopes on either side of the concrete pad, which are designed to allow for measurement/characterization of sight/weapon synchronization at various elevations, a geodetically surveyed point on the concrete pad which is used for waypoint navigation and vehicle Inertial Navigation Unit (INU) calibration, and an area designated for Over The Air (OTA) checkouts of electronic warfare, radio frequency jammer-type devices for programs that require checkouts as part of their RAM testing.

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Figure 3.2-41. Boresight slopes.



Figure 3.2-42. Typical boresight targets.

3.3. Off-Site Courses.

a. Imperial Sand Dunes. Also referred to as the Algodones Dunes, the dunes occupy an area approximately 8.0 km (5.0 mi) wide by 72.4 km (45.0 mi) long located in Southern California approximately about 20 miles west of the city of Yuma. Within the southern portion

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of this area is an 11.3 km (7 mi) marked course utilized by YTC for mobility testing. This area features large areas of sand hills, sand plains, and a variety of dune formations with sand grades up to 60 percent and is classified as sandy upland and sandy bottom, deep. This area also contains areas with slip faces up to 91-122 m (300-400 ft) high, which overlook large flat-floored basins sand free depressions, which are interpreted as exposed parts of the desert floor with a succession of advancing barchans. Use of this course must be coordinated with the Bureau of Land Management (BLM). Figure 3.3-1 shows a vehicle undergoing test at the Imperial Dunes.



Figure 3.3-1. Vehicle undergoing testing in Imperial Sand Dunes.

b. Interstate 8. Part of the U.S. Interstate Highway System, I-8 runs from Casa Grande, AZ at its eastern terminus, passes through Yuma, AZ at about its midpoint, and proceeds to San Diego, CA at its western terminus, for a total length of 560 km (348 mi). This multi lane highway offers a variety of terrain from below sea level to mountain passes over 1,219 m (4000 ft) in elevation. In California, west bound from mile marker 89 to the top of the Mountain Springs/In Ko Pah grade, the route is divided through two separate canyons, as the freeway ascends/descends 1,219 m (4000 ft) vertically in 17.7 km (11 mi). Also, long relatively flat sections Interstate-8 within CA and AZ provide opportunities for un-interrupted high-speed operations. I-8 can be accessed in Yuma, which is about a 20-minute drive from YTC.

(1) Sustained Speed Operations. Beginning at Arizona mile marker 21 and continuing east bound, sustained speed operations of 105-120 km/hr (65-75 mph) can be accomplished for up to 246.2 km (153 mi). The terrain is generally flat with a slight rise over Mohawk pass (1.2% up grade, 2.3 % slope down grade in the east bound direction). As it continues east from

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Mohawk pass, the road averages less than 1% to Gila Bend (exit 119) and then through the Sonoran Desert National Monument it begins a steady climb of 1-1.4% grade until mile marker 161. It maintains a slight down grade/level profile to its eastern terminus at I-10. Diesel fuel can be obtained at Dateland (mile marker 67) and Gila Bend (mile markers 116 and 119).

(2) 5% grade near El Cajon, CA. Located in San Diego County, between mile marker 27 and 30, is a section of roadway with a sustained 5% grade for 1.1 miles in the east bound direction. The test vehicle can exit at mile marker 27 (Dunbar Lane- Harbison Canyon), pass under the freeway, and gather speed on the slight down grade/on ramp east bound. Once at required speed the vehicle then proceeds up the 5% grade to mile marker 30 (Tavern Road). Diesel fuel is available on Tavern Road.

c. Death Valley National Monument. The road network in the Death Valley National Monument is utilized on a special permit basis coordinated by YTC. A 295 km (183 mi) paved test route between Beatty, NV, and Panamint Springs, CA, with grades up to 14 percent is used for tests of wheeled vehicles, engines, and transmission and automotive lubricants. Summertime temperatures on the valley floor frequently reach 51.7 °C (125 ºF) and elevations that can be reached by roads and trails ranging from 85 m (280 ft) below to 2,400 m (8,000 ft) above mean sea level. Beatty, NV, is located 666 km (414 mi) from YTC.

d. Camp Navajo. This area is located near Flagstaff, AZ, and is used as a base of operations for high altitude testing, with nearby roads featuring steep grades and reaching 2,900 m (9,400 ft) above mean sea level.

e. White Mountain Research Center, Barcroft Station. Located in California's White Mountain Range, this area serves as a base of operations for high altitude testing, presenting altitudes of up to 4,300 m (14,200 ft) above mean sea level and steep mountain grades.

3.4 Direct Fire Ranges.

a. Combat Systems Direct Fire Range. The range is an area 2 km by 7 km (3,460 acres) located on the Kofa range approximately 16 km (10 mi) down Pole Line Road. The firing range can be configured with a Stabilization Bump Course in accordance with International Test Operations Procedure (ITOP) 03-2-836 (1.3.2.2) [12]. The Stabilization Bump Course consists of trapezoidal metal blocks that can be moved to specified positions on a straight, level compacted gravel road in a direct line with a stationary target. The layout of the elevation bump courses can be configured according to the performance requirements of the stabilization system. The course is also configurable for Table V Gunnery in accordance with Field Manual (FM) 3-20.21[13] with 14 radio controlled stationary infantry targets (SIT) shown in Figure 3.4-1, 2 moving infantry targets (MIT), 15 stationary armored targets (SAT) shown in Figure 3.4-2, and 2 moving armored targets (MAT). SAT and MAT targets are hit sensor capable for .50-cal up to 120-mm ammunition, and the SIT and MIT targets are hit sensor capable for small arms ammunition up to 25-mm. Targets can be configured with an infrared (IR) signature and are multiple integrated laser engagement system (MILES) XXI adaptable. The characteristics of target pop-up and fall are programmable for firing scenarios. The range is not authorized for high explosive (HE) or depleted uranium (DU) munitions. A map of Combat Systems Direct Fire Range is shown in

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Figure 3.4-3.



Figure 3.4-1. Stationary Infantry Target (SIT) System.



Figure 3.4-2. Stationary Armor Target (SAT) System.

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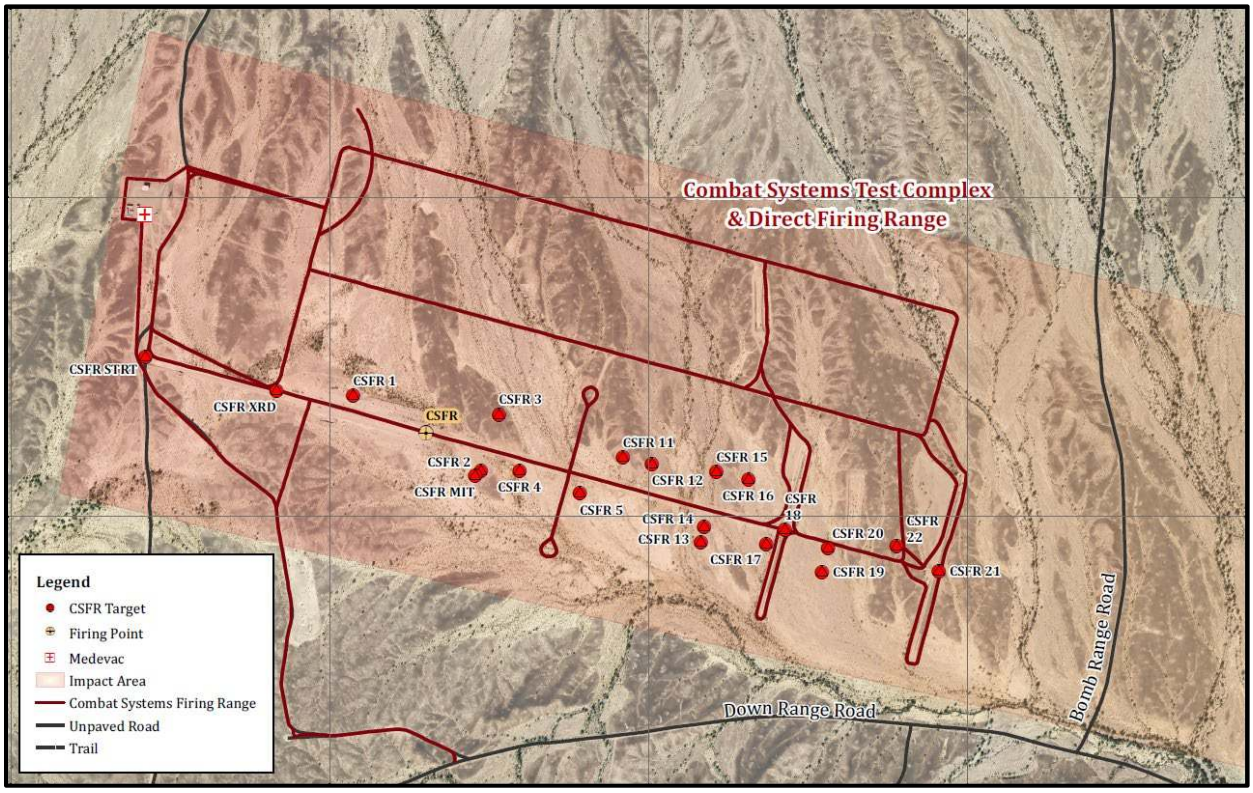


Figure 3.4-3. Combat Systems Direct Fire Range map.

b. Moving Target Range. The range consists of two remote-controlled rail-mounted moving target carriers. The target carriers can be equipped with a pop-up target (cloth or plywood) up to 3 m by 6 m (10 ft by 20 ft) or a 6 m by 6 m (20 ft by 20 ft) target with the Oehler Acoustic Scoring System. The rail mounted target carriers are capable of speeds of 32 km/hr (20 mph). Both configurations are used to test ground vehicle mounted direct fire weapons at ranges of 1500 or 2500 m (to 0.9 or 1.6 mi), depending on which target line is utilized. A characteristic photograph of the two targets is shown in Figure 3.4-4.

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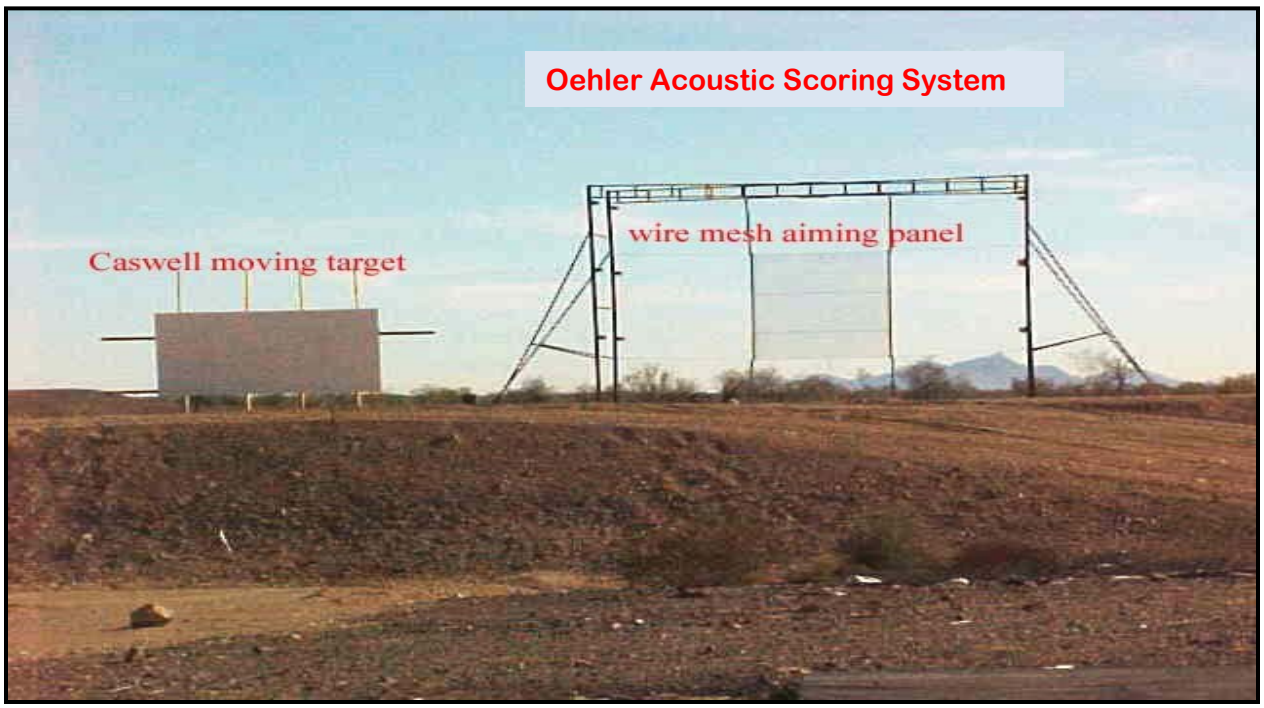


Figure 3.4-4. Remote-controlled rail-mounted carriers equipped with pop-up targets and an Oehler Acoustic Scoring System target.

3.5 Test Facilities.

a. Enclosed Rain Array System (ERAS) and Modular Rain Array Systems (MRAS). These systems provide rain testing in accordance with MIL-STD-810H Method 506.6 Procedure I and Procedure II. See Figure 3.5-1 for an example. The ERAS uses 327 nozzles pressurized to 275 kPA (40 psi) to simulate the effects of wind-driven rain on military equipment and can be adjusted based on the specific needs of the test. The ERAS occupies an 11.2-m by 6.0-m by 4.5-m (37-ft by 20-ft by 15-ft) area to accommodate large vehicles. The facility does not provide any onsite temperature conditioning, so testing is performed under ambient conditions. The MRAS is designed to be transported and set up at a remote test location, providing simulated wind-driven rain using a portable fan producing winds of up to 80 km/hr (50 mph) consistent with Procedure I "Rain and Blowing Rain" testing. The MRAS covers a width of 10.6 m (35 ft) with a height of up to 6 m (20 ft) and is designed to be modular, allowing multiple 6-m (20-ft) lengths to be added to accommodate larger test items.

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Figure 3.5-1. Vehicle inside Rain and Blowing Rain Facility.

b. Blown Air Dust and Sand System (BADSS). YPG has two available environmental simulation apparatuses, referred to as BADSS, as alternatives to sand or dust chamber testing as described in MIL-STD-810H CN1, Method 510, and compliant with the specifications provided in TOP 01-2-621[15]. Testing is generally performed in order to assess the effectiveness of protective covers, cases, and seals; the effectiveness of intake filters; the effects of sand or dust accumulation on the test item and any physical deterioration that may result; and the capability of the test item to satisfy its performance requirements after exposure to the sand and dust environments. It should be noted that the BADSS system is for the static assessment of dust exposure and should not be confused with dynamic sand and dust testing (e.g., vehicle in motion), described in TOP 02-2-819[16]. The BADSS is comprised of a 1.8 m (6 ft) diameter fan with flow guide, and particulate feed mechanism, mounted on a two-axle trailer. Figure 3.5-2 shows the BADSS system in use. The BADSS is capable of producing wind speeds in excess of 96 km/hr (60 mph), with sufficient particulate capacity to perform 90-minutes of uninterrupted testing with an adjustable particulate feed rate. The BADSS is capable of blown dust densities in excess of 2.2 grams per square meter (g/m^2).

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Figure 3.5-2. BADSS System (right) and system under test (left).

c. Environmental Chamber with Weapons Firing Capabilities. The weapons firing chamber is able to subject weapons (up to 203 mm (8-in.) to high or low temperatures and humidity (in any combination required) while providing the capability of the weapon firing (up to an elevation of 60 degrees) under those conditions. The facility can also be closed and utilized as just a hot or cold environmental chamber. The facility's Virtual Private Network (VPN) allows remote access to the control computers, providing 24/7 monitoring even when personnel are not on-site. Extensive instrumentation records the test item's performance throughout the full range of operation, including the ability to measure downrange performance of projectiles with ballistic cameras and radar. The chamber can host a wide variety of test vehicles and items including remote piloted vehicles, artillery, direct fire systems, tactical wheeled and tracked vehicles, and helicopters. The chamber can attain temperature and humidity combinations from -54 to +71 ºC (-65 to +160 ºF) and 5 to 95 percent relative humidity (RH) to simulate worldwide conditions. The hot and dry settings can reach up to +71 C (+160 ºF) with less than 5 percent RH and hot and humid up to 71 ºC (+160 ºF), with up to 95 percent RH. Extreme Cold can reach down to -54 ºC (-65 ºF). The chamber dimensions are 13.7 m long by 8.8 m wide by 4.4 m high (45 ft by 29 ft by 14.5 ft), with the height measured at the center of the chamber (the general shape of the chamber is a hemispherical conduit). The access door to the chamber of 5.2 m wide by 4.0 m high (17 ft by 13.2 ft), and the firing port is 1.2 m wide (4 ft). Figure 3.5-3 shows the exterior and a vehicle inside the Weapons Firing Chamber.

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Figure 3.5-3. Exterior view (left) and vehicle inside the Weapons Firing Chamber (right).

d. Climatic Simulation Facility. This facility enables YTC to perform a variety of environmental tests to individual vehicle components or equipment to national and international Military Standards. These tests simulate the effects of a variety of environmental extremes and climatic conditions, and the facility is customizable to meet any specific requirements. Table 8 lists the different chambers at this facility and their specifications. Figure 3.5-4 shows the Climatic Simulation Facility. Figure 3.5-5 shows a test item after climatic icing test and Figure 3.5-6 shows a test item after salt fog testing.

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TABLE 8. CLIMATIC SIMULATION FACILITY SPECIFICATIONS

CHAMBER TYPE	NO. OF CHAMBERS	TEMPERATURE AND HUMIDITY RANGE	DIMENSIONS
Hot/cold with humidity	4	-57 to +82 ºC (-70 to +180 ºF) Up to 100 percent humidity	3 m (L) x 2.1 m (W) x 2 m (H) (10 ft (L) x 7 ft (W) x 6.5 ft (H)) (3 chambers) 1.2 m (L) x 1.2 m (W) x 2 m (H) (4 ft (L) x 4 ft (W) x 6.5 ft (H)) (1 chamber)
Hot with humidity	6	+4 to +82 ºC (+40 to +180 ºF) Up to 100 percent humidity	3 m (L) x 2.1 m (W) x 2 m (H) (10 ft (L) x 7 ft (W) x 6.5 ft (H)) (5 chambers) 1.2 m (L) x 1.2 m (W) x 2 m (H) (4 ft (L) x 4 ft (W) x 6.5 ft (H)) (1 chamber)
Cold chamber without humidity	1	-57 degrees ºC (-70 degrees ºF)	Not Available
Hot/cold without humidity chamber	2	-54 to +63 ºC (-65 to +145 ºF)	3 m (L) x 2.1 m (W) x 2 m (H) (10 ft (L) x 7 ft (W) x 6.5 ft (H)) (1 chamber) 1.2 m (L) x 1.2 m (W) x 2 m (H) (4 ft L x 4 ft (W) x 6.5 ft (H)) (1 chamber)
Altitude chamber	1	Simulates up to 30,480 m (100,000 ft) Can be used as a cold box with a temperature range of -57 to +74 C (-70 to +165 F)	1.8 m (L) x 1.5 m (W) x 1.5 m (H) (5.7 ft (L) x 5 ft (W) x 5 ft(H))
Salt fog chamber	1	+35 ºC only (+95 ºF)	1.5 m (L) x 1.5 m (W) x 1.5 m (H) (5 ft (L) x 5 ft (W) x 4.8 ft (H))
Immersion (leak) tank	1	NA	Capacity of 113 L (4 cu ft)
Solar chamber	1	Combined solar, temperature and humidity Full solar spectrum (280 to 3000 nm wavelength) +4 to +82 ºC (+40 to 180 ºF), with 5 to 95 percent relative humidity	2.4 m (L) x 2.4 m (W) x 3.4 m (H) (8 ft (L) x 8 ft (W) x 11 ft (H)) room with approximately 0.46 sq meters (5 square feet) of test space

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Figure 3.5-4. Component level climatic chambers.



Figure 3.5-5. Test item after climatic icing test.

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Figure 3.5-6. Test item after climatic salt fog testing.

e. Material Analysis Laboratory. This laboratory has over 650 square meters (7,000 square feet) of internal air-conditioned laboratory and office space with both refrigerated and non-refrigerated external chemical storage space. A mobile van may be utilized for toxic fume gas analysis on site. Equipment is available for determining the physical and chemical properties of a wide variety of materials. The laboratory has an internal local area network (LAN) linking major equipment to the Laboratory Information Management System (LIMS) where laboratory data are stored.

(1) Foremost among the laboratory test capabilities are the analysis of petroleum, oil, and lubricants (POL) and coolants, including such analytical techniques as wear metal, kinematic viscosity, carbon residue, sulfated ash, diesel fuel dilution, oil in fuel, closed cup flash point, American Petroleum Institute (API) gravity, water by distillation, water by Karl Fisher titration, total base number, free water, water reaction with fuel, sediment content, fuel distillation, coolant freezing point, low temperature characteristic, cloud point, arid pour point, low temperature pumping viscosity, sulfur content, insolubles, and particle counting in fluids analyses.

(2) Additional capabilities included analytical techniques such as Fourier Transform Infrared (FT-IR) spectroscopy, Energy Dispersive X-ray Fluorescence (ED-XRF) spectroscopy, granite furnace/flame Atomic Absorption (AA) spectroscopy, Inductively Coupled Plasma Mass Spectroscopy (ICP-MS), Ultraviolet/Visible (UV/NIS) spectroscopy, Gas Chromatography (GC), High-Performance Liquid Chromatography (HPLC), pH and conductivity measurements of aqueous solutions, and melting point determination. The chemical laboratory is shown in Figure 3.5-7, while Figures 3.5-8 through 3.5-11 show laboratory equipment contained within the facility.

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Figure 3.5-7. Material Analysis Laboratory.

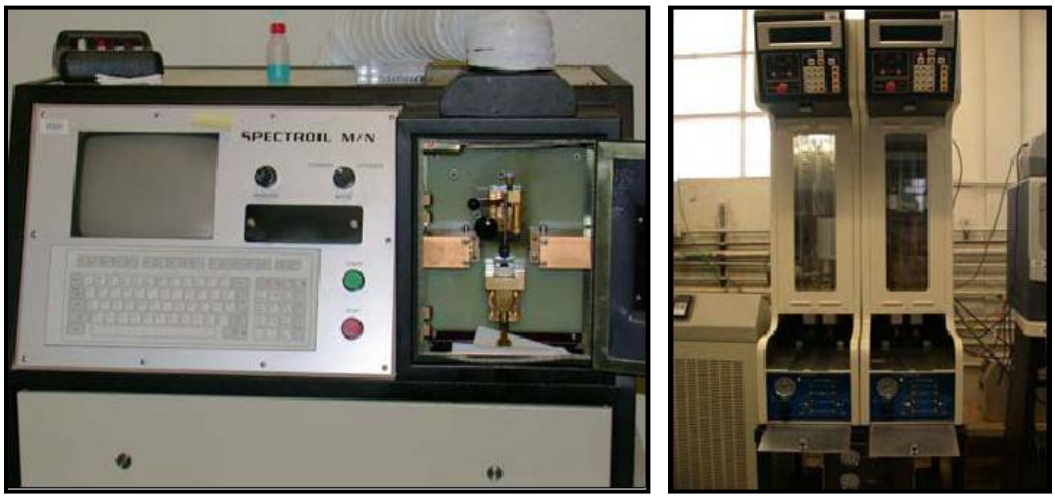


Figure 3.5-8. Spectroil rotating disk optical emission spectrometer used for wear metal analysis (left) and CAV2000 automatic viscometer used for measuring kinematic viscosity (right).

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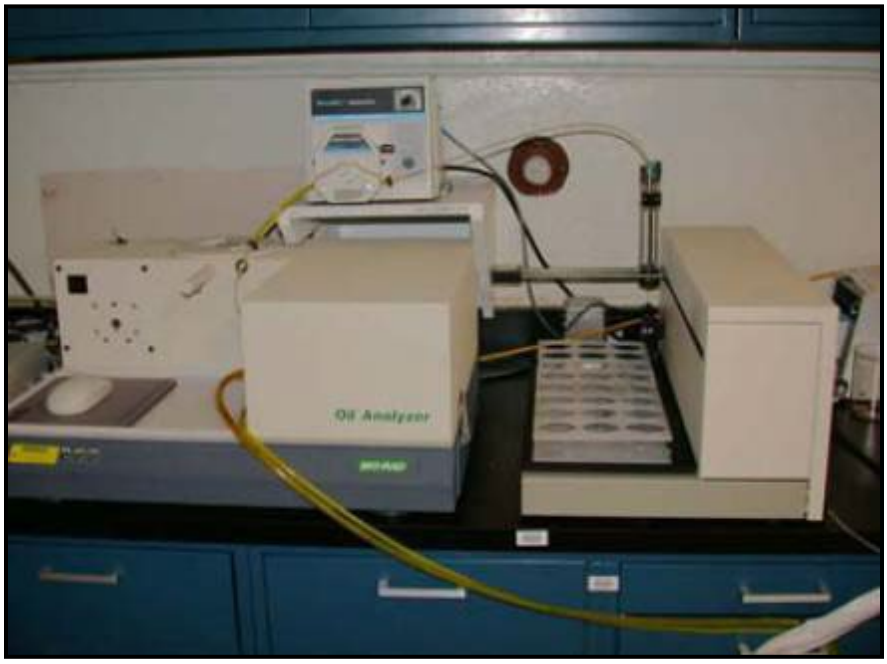


Figure 3.5-9. Advanced oil analyzer platform Fourier Transform Infrared Spectrometer used for molecular analysis of lubricants and hydraulic fluids.



Figure 3.5-10. Gas chromatograph with turbomatrix heads pace sampler used to measure diesel fuel dilution.

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Figure 3.5-11. Automatic distillation unit used to measure fuel distillation (left) and automatic cloud and pour point used to measure low temperature characteristics (right).

f. Starter Test Stand. The ST-24 computerized starter tester checks automotive starters simulating real working conditions of the vehicle, analyzing the device timing to detect solenoid, drive, and spring problems. The test stand is shown in Figure 3.5-12. During the test, the ST-24 automatically recognizes the starter rotation direction and applies a programmable load. The ST-24 returns the mechanical energy produced from the starter back to the power supply to reduce power consumption. The built in separate power supply for the starter and solenoid allows the solenoid function to be tested at a programmable reduced voltage during the test. The ST-24 is able to scan in a set of programmable points for the performance curve in less than 10 seconds, increasing the accuracy and decreasing result variation caused by temperature. The ST-24 provides a precise waveform analysis for accurate armature and commutator diagnostics and has the capability to check the results against preset limits and generate an output report.

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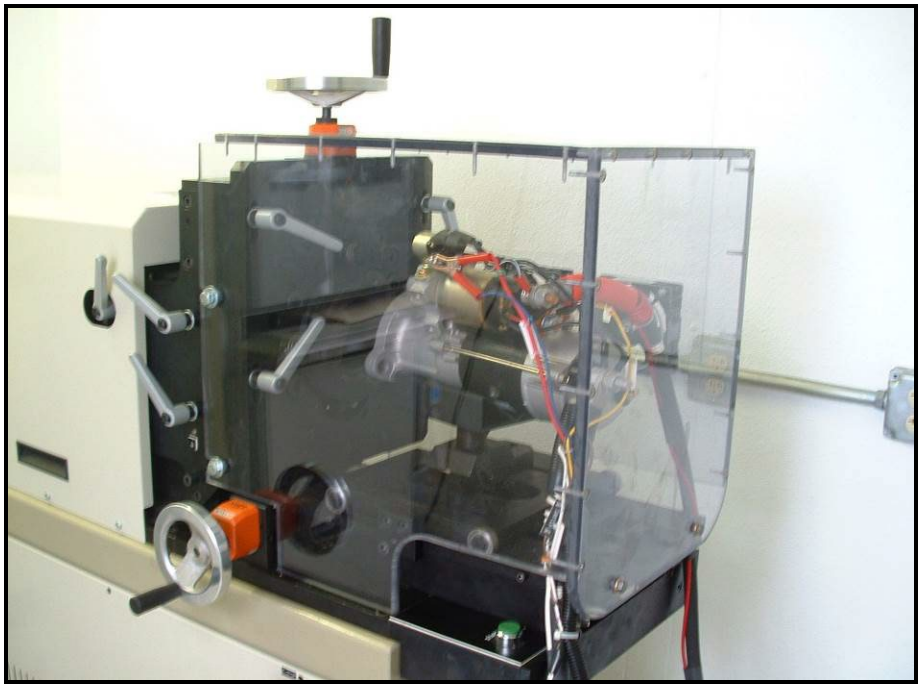


Figure 3.5-12. ST-24 starter test stand.

g. Tire Maintenance Facility. The facility provides equipment for the servicing of tires, including vehicle wheel alignment and tire balancing. The tire testing facility has two run flat machines capable of installing and removing run flat inserts from tires, a tire spreader for exposing tire defects, a tire inflation cage for safely inflating tires, two tire changing machines, and a computerized wheel balancer. Tire ground-pressure footprint data are also gathered.

h. Hybrid Electric Facility. This facility allows for testing of hybrid electric vehicles and onboard power generation systems. The facility is equipped with an AV 900 load bank tied into the electrical grid as well as a smaller ABC 150 load bank. Numerous portable direct current (DC) and alternating current (AC) load banks are available for onboard vehicle installation as well. The load banks allow for power absorption up to 250 kW, and accommodate up to 900 Volts DC and current ranges up to 1000 amps. Extensive instrumentation to load and record the DC power and AC power circuits are available. The facility and AV 900 load bank system are shown in Figure 3.5-13.

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Figure 3.5-13. Hybrid Electric Facility (left) and AV900 Load Bank (right).

i. Vibration Facility. The vibration test facilities are used to improve the reliability of military hardware, avionics instrumentation, and automotive components on a subsystem level. The vibration facility has six electrodynamic vibration systems available for testing, with two shown in Figure 3.5-14. The internal dimensions of the removable conditioning chamber are 2.4 m by 2.4 m by 2.4 m (8 ft by 8 ft by 8 ft), and the testing area is 1.2 m by 1.2 m (4 ft by 4 ft) or 1.5 m by 1.5 m (5 ft by 5 ft). All vibration systems are controlled from remote data acquisition and processing centers capable of immediate data analysis for test control. The capabilities include various tests that specify sine random, shock, sine-on-random, random-on-random, and other complex waveforms as well as replicating data that are collected from real world situations. Testing is conducted in accordance with national and international Military Standards. Custom vibration testing may also be supported.



Figure 3.5-14. T4000 Vibration Chamber (left) and T5000 Vibration Chamber (right).

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j. Physical Test Facility. The facilities are comprised of four major areas: physical measurements, non-destructive inspections, material properties testing, and mass properties measurements. They include a 30-inch optical comparator, a Faro laser tracker, a multi-sensor coordinate measuring machine, a high precision coordinate measuring machine for cannon gun tube measurement and inspection (173 cm (68 in.) long by 302 cm (119 in.) wide by 279 cm (110 in.) high). The Physical Test facilities are equipped with load cells capable of measuring from 9 to 445,000 N (2 to 100,000 lbf), a large capacity 711 kN (160 klbf) Universal Testing Machine, and a small capacity 56 kN (12.5 klbf) Universal Testing Machine. The test area includes a level concrete pad, a 136,000 kg (300,000 lb) capacity platform scale, and mobile cranes up to a 63,500 kg (140,000 lb) capacity.

k. Site 3 Drop Test Facility. The site hosts a drop test tower (Figure 3.5-15) that is capable of dropping up to 454 kg (1000 lb) from varying distances up to a maximum height of 9 m (30 ft); the tower can be used for vehicle component-level or vehicle transported equipment tests. Four different drop surfaces are available: 7.6 cm (3 in.) of steel above 61 cm (24 in.) of concrete; 7.6 cm (3 in.) of steel above 46 cm (18 in.) crushed rock; anvil top; and reinforced concrete. Three digital video recorders are available to capture the test from separate angles, and a video of the test can be provided. Two environmental chambers are available for conditioning items. They have interior dimensions of 2 m (7 ft) wide, 2 m (7 ft) high, and 4.1 m (13.5 ft) deep. One of these chambers is used for cooling and is capable of cooling to -62 ºC (-80 ºF). The second chamber is used for heating and is capable of reaching temperatures in excess of 74 ºC (165 ºF).



Figure 3.5-15. Site 3 Drop Tower and inspection conex (left) with aerial view of Site 3 (right).

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l. 12 Meter Drop Test Facility. The site hosts a tower (Figure 3.5-16) that is capable of dropping up to 1,800 kg (4,000 lb) up to 18 m (60 ft). The drop surface consists of one pad with 7.6 cm (3 in.) thick steel (with a Brinell hardness of 269 - 311) attached to 91 cm (36 in.) of rebar-reinforced concrete reaction mass with high strength epoxy. Two digital video recorders are available to capture the test from separate angles, and a video of the test can be provided. Two CO2 environmental chambers are also available at this site for conditioning items, with interior dimensions of 2 m (7 ft) wide, 2 m (7 ft) high, and 2 m (7 ft) deep with capabilities that allow conditioning to -62 ºC (-80 ºF) to 74 ºC (165 ºF).



Figure 3.5-16. 12 Meter Drop Test facilities.

3.6. Maintenance Facilities.

a. Operations and Maintenance Division Complex. This complex is centrally located to the primary automotive test areas. The facilities sit on a fenced 52,600-square meter (13-acre) compound with lighting for parking of test and fleet support vehicles, and to setup and conduct of tests of individual and troop support equipment such as shelters. The facility contains 892 sq m (9,600 sq ft) of lighted work area with adjacent offices, support shops, and tire repair area. There is a complete tool room and supply function on-site. A fleet of test support vehicles are available, including several types of tactical trucks, M88A1 Recovery Vehicles, M113 Personnel Carriers, tractor-trailer combinations for transport and recovery of test vehicles, generators, and other support equipment. The storage yard holds a 4,500 L (1,200 gal) fuel station for storing and dispensing test fuels, and 30 conex storage units measuring 2.4 m by 2.4 m by 6 m (8 ft by 8 ft by 20 ft), for storing dedicated test items, system support packages, and residue. Test and support facilities located adjacent to the complex include a 136,000 kg (150 ton) platform scale, tilt table, and vehicle wash rack.

b. Main Test Maintenance Facility. The largest building on YTC, which is located on Kofa Firing Range, covers approximately 8,300 square meters (90,000 square feet). Maintenance is performed on tactical vehicles (wheeled and tracked) and weapons systems in the

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southern three-quarters of the building. There are three large bays, two of which are served with overhead traveling cranes. There is a 36,000-kg (40-ton) and three 9,000-kg (10-ton) cranes. The repair of approximately 30 vehicles can be accommodated simultaneously. Compressed air is available to operate multiple air tools and a chassis lift. A unit supply section maintains bench stock, shop stock, and test system support packages; along with a tool room, it supports both the vehicle and artillery maintenance functions within the shop. Common shop tools, such as cutting torch, grinder, hydraulic press, drill press, and injector testers are available for issue to all personnel using the shop. The shop also has access to 208 VAC 3-phase and 440 VAC 3-phase power. An air-conditioned office space and break room are incorporated; however, the main work area is cooled with evaporative coolers, because some of the seven large electrically operated doors are frequently opened. An approximately 12 m (40 ft) wide concrete apron encircles the building. A wash rack with a steam cleaner, an outside shade area for work on approximately four test vehicles, a large 11,300-sq m (2.8-acre) asphalt-covered storage yard with lockable conex containers, a loading dock, an oil and fuel drum holding area, and over 20,000 sq m (5 acres) of gravel parking lot comprise the rest of the facility.

c. Ancillary Test Maintenance Facility. The facility is located adjacent to the main test maintenance facility on Kofa Firing Range. The facility provides organizational and direct support level maintenance and inspections for tactical vehicles, commercial light, medium, and heavy-duty vehicles as well as emergency response and construction grade vehicles and cranes. The facility has access to parts management and storage areas as well as a secure storage area. The shop floor is cooled with an evaporative cooling system in the ventilated indoor work bays. The shop contains nine work bays in a 22-m by 113-m (72-ft by 371-ft) area of the facility. There is access to an 18,100-kg (20-ton) overhead crane and a 36,300-kg (40-ton) overhead crane. The shop features access to 208 VAC 3-phase power and has six portable axle/wheel lifts with a combined 40,800-kg (90,000-lb) lift capacity. A separate section of the facility offers offices, conference rooms, and staff office for maintenance and parts management personnel.

d. MT Test Maintenance Facility. The shop has full maintenance capabilities and equipment. There are six shop bays available that can support up to six test vehicles and two load handling systems. The shop features one 22,700-kg (25-ton) overhead crane, one 4,500-kg (5-ton) overhead crane, and eight portable axle/wheel lifts with a combined 54,400-kg (120,000-lb) lift capacity.

e. Welding and Metal Shop Facility. The facility is located in the west side of the ancillary maintenance facility, and features full machine, fabrication, and welding support in a 5,417 square meters (58,310 square foot) facility. The welding and metals shop facility provides custom metal payloads for both wheeled and track vehicles to meet their test mission weight requirements as well as support vehicle modifications and repairs.

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APPENDIX A. ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS.

AA	Atomic Absorption
ABS	anti-lock brake system
AC	alternating current
API	American Petroleum Institute
APG	Aberdeen Proving Ground
ATC	U.S. Army Aberdeen Test Center
ATEF	Automotive Technology Evaluation Facility
ATTB	Aircraft Transportability Test Bed
BADSS	Blown Air Dust and Sand System
BLM	Bureau of Land Management
°C	°Celsius
cfm	cubic feet per minute
CISPR	Comite International Special de Perturbations Radioectriques
CL	clay of low plasticity
cm	centimeter
cmm	cubic meters per minute
CTA	Churchville Test Area
dB	decibel
DC	direct current
DDS	Drivetrain Durability Simulator
DOD	Department of Defense
DU	depleted uranium
ECU	electronic control unit
ED-XRF	Energy Dispersive X-ray Fluorescence
EMITF	Electromagnetic Interference Test Facility
ESC	electronic stability control
°F	°Fahrenheit
FCC	Federal Communications Commission
FM	Field Manual
ft	feet
FT-IR	Fourier Transform Infrared
g/m^2	grams per square meter
GC	Gas Chromatography
GHz	Gigahertz
GM	General Motors
GVW	gross vehicle weight

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APPENDIX A. ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS.

HBCT	Heavy Brigade Combat Team
HE	high explosive
hp	horsepower
HPLC	High-Performance Liquid Chromatography
hr	hour
HVDS	Heavy Vehicle Durability Simulator
HWTC	Hot Weather Test Complex
Hz	Hertz
ICP-MS	Inductively Coupled Plasma Mass Spectroscopy
in.	inch
IR	infrared
ITOP	International Test Operations Procedure
kHz	Kilohertz
km	kilometer
km/hr	kilometer per hour
kN	kilonewton
kPa	kilopascal
kW	kilowatt
LAAF	Laguna Army Airfield
LAN	local area network
lb	pound
LHS	Load Handling System
LIMS	Laboratory Information Management System
LMPEC	Large Multipurpose Environmental Chamber
LTTF	Lift and Tiedown Facility
LUGV	large unmanned ground vehicle
m	meter
MAT	moving armored target
MH	silt of high plasticity
MHz	Megahertz
mi	mile
MIL-STD	Military Standard
MILES	multiple integrated laser engagement system
MIT	moving infantry target
ML	silt
mL/hr	milliliter per hour
MOI	moment of inertia
MOUT	Military Operations on Urban Terrain
mph	miles per hour

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APPENDIX A. ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS.

MTA	Munson Test Area
MTS	moving target simulator
N	Newton
NA	not applicable
NaCl	sodium chloride
NATO	North Atlantic Treaty Organization
NHTSA	National Highway Traffic Safety Administration
PAAF	Phillips Army Airfield
POL	petroleum, oil, and lubricants
psi	pounds per square inch
PTA	Perryman Test Area
RAM	reliability, availability and maintainability
RH	relative humidity
rms	root mean square
RPC	remote parameter control
RWS	Roadway Simulator
SAE	Society of Automotive Engineers
SAT	stationary armored target
SC	clayey sand
SIT	stationary infantry target
SM	silty sand
SNCTA	Scalable Net Centric Test Area
SP	poorly graded sand
SUGV	small unmanned ground vehicle
TOP	Test Operations Procedure
TW	Trench Warfare
UGV	unmanned ground vehicle
USCS	unified soil classification system
UV/NIS	Ultraviolet/Visible
V/m	volts per meter
VDA	Vehicle Dynamics Area
VDS	Vehicle Durability Simulator
VPN	Virtual Private Network
WES	U.S. Army Waterways Experiment Station
YPG	U.S. Army Yuma Proving Ground
YTC	Yuma Test Center

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APPENDIX B. REFERENCES.

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APPENDIX C. APPROVAL AUTHORITY

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
UNITED STATES ARMY TEST AND EVALUATION COMMAND
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ABERDEEN PROVING GROUND, MD 21005-5001

TEWS-CG (73-1f)

MEMORANDUM FOR SEE DISTRIBUTION

SUBJECT: Test Operations Procedure 01-1-011D Vehicle Test Facilities at Aberdeen Test Center and Yuma Test Center

1. Test Operations Procedure (TOP) 01-1-011D Vehicle Test Facilities at Aberdeen Test Center and Yuma Test Center has been reviewed by the U.S. Army Test and Evaluation Command (ATEC) Test Centers, the U.S. Army Operational Test Command, Army Public Health Command, and the U.S. Army Evaluation Center. All comments received during the formal coordination period have been adjudicated by the preparing agency.

2. Scope of the document. This Test Operations Procedure (TOP) describes the vehicle test facilities of the U.S. Army Aberdeen Test Center (ATC) at Aberdeen Proving Ground (APG), Maryland, and the U.S. Army Yuma Test Center (YTC) at Yuma Proving Ground (YPG), Arizona

3. This document is approved for publication and will be posted to the ASSIST website. The ASSIST website can be accessed at https://assist.dla.mil/.

4. Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to U.S. Army White Sand Missile Range (TEWS-CG), 100 Headquarters Avenue - Suite 231 White Sands Missile Range, NM 88002-5000; or e-mailed to usarmy.apg.atec.mbx.atec-standards@army.mil.

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